POPULAR NON-FICTION

THE MIND OF THE FUTURE

How Artificial Intelligence Is Changing Our World

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Preface — A Letter to the Reader

Hi! I'm Dasha. And I'm glad you're here.

I wrote this book for you. Not for an "audience" or an impersonal mass of readers, but for one specific person holding this book right now and looking for answers.

Three years ago, I was afraid of artificial intelligence. It seemed complicated, distant, "for the chosen few." Then, simply out of curiosity, I opened a text assistant. And my life changed. AI became my assistant, conversation partner, and creative collaborator: it helped me write this book, launch a project, and find time for what mattered.

And I want the same to happen for you—not because AI is magical, but because you will learn to set tasks, check answers, and keep the most important things in your own hands: choice, responsibility, and meaning.

Why This Book

Many books about AI are written in language that is too complicated, too dry, or too far removed from real life. I decided to write differently: with warmth, in simple words, and with examples.

- We'll use the informal "you"—because this is a conversation between people who are close.
- I'll be honest about both its possibilities and its limitations.
- Every word will work to your benefit.

What's Inside

Seven chapters—seven steps on your journey:

1. **Awakening** — seeing AI all around you.
2. **Understanding** — learning how models process information.
3. **Mastery** — learning to formulate tasks.

4. **Creation** — applying AI to projects and business.
5. **Creativity** — expressing ideas through text, images, sound, and video.
6. **Education** — learning with a digital assistant, but not instead of a teacher and your own practice.
7. **Wisdom** — using technology responsibly.

By the end of the book, you won't become "invincible," and you won't receive any guarantees of success. But you will better understand where AI is genuinely useful, where it makes mistakes, and how to take your first sensible step.

An Important Reading Rule

This book is not medical, legal, or financial advice. Do not share sensitive data with services without understanding their data-processing terms. Verify any information that affects health, money, rights, safety, or another person's fate against the original source, and discuss it with a specialist if necessary.

The Future That Has Already Arrived

We are living in the future. It arrived unnoticed—not with robots in the streets and not with flying cars, but through the apps on your phone, search, email, taxis, music, and maps. The future dissolved into the present and became ordinary. We stopped noticing it—but it continues to change the way we work, learn, and create.

You can ask a machine anything—and it will answer in your language. You can describe a picture in words—and a generative model will create an image. You can ask for help with the structure of a text, a study plan, or ideas for a project. But there is an important distance between possibility and a good result: the quality of the prompt, the source data, and your verification.

If you had told someone from 1990 about this, they would not have believed you. But it is reality—your reality, right now.

And here is the question where it all begins: if the technology is already here, why aren't you using it consciously yet? Maybe you don't know how? Maybe you're afraid? Or perhaps you simply haven't noticed it?

This book is not a promise of a "new life in two hours." It is a route. You will see

the possibilities, try the tools, learn to ask questions, and understand where human oversight is needed.

Where We’re Going

Routine tasks are increasingly being automated: reports, searches, drafts, analysis, and simple correspondence. People are left with creativity, strategy, communication, and complex decisions—although these areas are gradually changing too. If you master AI, you will gain an additional tool. If you don’t, that doesn’t make you “worse”: it simply means that others will have a different set of tools.

The pace of change is accelerating. Competition is becoming global. New roles and ways of organizing work are emerging. But along with the opportunities, the risks are growing too: disinformation, dependency, data leaks, bias in automated decisions, and unequal access to technology.

We’ll talk about all this honestly. I won’t claim that AI will replace everyone, save every business, or guarantee that you become more efficient. The result depends on the task, the context, the quality of the data, the tool, and your actions.

I’ll explain complex things simply, show you the possibilities, warn you about the risks, and share practical approaches. You will read, try things, check them, and draw your own conclusions.

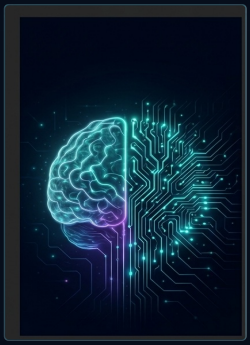
How to read this book: slowly, with practice after each chapter and with respect for your own boundaries. You don’t need to master everything at once. One tested experiment is better than ten promises.

A hug. See you in the first chapter.

PART ONE. AWAKENING

Chapter 1. Awakening — Discovering the Invisible World of AI

“The AI revolution has already happened. Quietly. Unnoticed. While we were arguing about the future, the future had already moved into our pockets.”



1.1. The Study That Shook Me

The Moment Everything Changed

You know, there are moments in life when everything changes. Not suddenly, not loudly. Quietly. Unnoticed. You don’t always understand it right away.

One such moment happened to me on a cold November evening in 2023.

I had a quiet moment, poured myself some tea, and, as I love to do, browsed scientific publications—yes, I’m one of those people who find research more enjoyable in the evening than any TV series. And I came across an article from MIT Media Lab—its title promised boredom: “An Analysis of Human Interaction with Artificial Intelligence in Everyday Life.”

So what? Some scientists had counted something. It seemed far removed from my life.

But I started reading. And with every paragraph, my mouth opened wider in surprise.

The Experiment

The scientists asked a simple question, one that seemed to have implications for everyday life:

> *How many times a day does an ordinary person—not an IT specialist, not a*

> *geek, but an ordinary person, like you and me—come into contact with artificial intelligence?*

They invited a thousand people like that and gave them an app that discreetly tracked every interaction with technology for several days:

- recommendations — music, films, products;
- autocorrect and typing suggestions;
- voice assistants and speech recognition;
- navigation and estimated travel times;
- personalisation in apps and feeds;
- content, spam and news filtering;
- and a dozen other little things we don't notice.

The participants went about their normal lives. The app simply counted. And at the end, the researchers added everything up — and got a figure that genuinely shocked me.

I couldn't find an exact publicly available study using this methodology and figure, so I won't present the number as a scientific finding. It is a **composite illustration**: AI can cross our paths many times a day — in recommendations, navigation, autocorrect, filters and voice features. The important thing isn't to count the "correct" number, but to notice how many of these encounters are already woven into an ordinary day.

I read that thought three times. Could AI really be around us that often?

So I decided to test it for myself. Just from memory, over the course of one ordinary day:

- a smart alarm clock that adjusts to your sleep phases — one;
- a music service with a personalised playlist — two;
- the sat-nav on the way to work — three;
- an algorithmic social-media feed — four;
- autocorrect in messages — five, six, seven…

By evening, I had reached 52. Even more than in the study!

The paradox of digital blindness

But this is what amazed me most. At the end of the experiment, the participants were asked a simple question: *“How often do you think you use artificial intelligence?”* — with options ranging from “constantly” to “never”.

Can you guess what most of them answered? **“Rarely” or “never.”**

People interacted with AI dozens of times every day — and almost none of them noticed. It’s like breathing air and saying, “I’m not breathing,” or standing on the ground and insisting, “I can’t feel gravity.”

The researchers called this the **phenomenon of digital blindness**. And it has three causes.

The first reason: the technology works too well

When something works flawlessly, it becomes invisible. You don’t think about electricity when you flick a switch — it simply works. AI is the same: it is integrated so smoothly that you don’t feel its presence.

The second reason: AI is hidden inside familiar things

AI doesn’t come to you in the form of a robot with light-bulb eyes. It lives inside your favourite apps. A music service picks your tracks — that’s AI inside. A social-media feed decides what to show you — that’s AI inside. A sat-nav plans your route — that’s AI inside. You use these apps without thinking that artificial intelligence is working “behind the scenes”.

The third reason: AI has become the norm

Personalised recommendations? Well, that’s normal, isn’t it? A smart camera? Of course — everyone can do that. Autocorrect? An obvious feature! But ten or fifteen years ago, none of this existed. We’ve simply forgotten what life looked like without these “little things”. AI has quietly become the new air we breathe.

What changed in me

After reading the article, I couldn’t sleep. I lay there thinking: how could this be? I consider myself someone who is interested in technology — and yet I hadn’t noticed that I was using AI dozens of times a day.

It was like living in a single-storey house all your life, then suddenly discovering a staircase to an upper floor full of rooms you never knew existed. I felt like a blind person who had suddenly regained their sight.

And I wanted to give other people that same moment of revelation. That's why I'm writing this book — to give you that very "AI vision": the ability to see what is hidden from most people.

Your moment of revelation

Now it's your turn. Once again: forty-seven times a day. Think about your day today, the most ordinary day — how many times did you talk to AI without even noticing?

Don't rush to name an exact number — first, simply remember your morning: what you opened first, where you looked, what you typed. Then add lunch, the journey, the evening. Surprising, isn't it? Most of us genuinely have no idea how deeply technology is already woven into the most ordinary day.

And in the next subsection, we'll go through your day minute by minute — and you'll see all the invisible companions surrounding you. Ready to open your eyes?

1.2. The Symphony of Invisible Companions — Your Day with AI from Dawn to Dusk

We stopped at a few minutes of your morning. Let's continue. The whole day — minute by minute. You'll be surprised by how many invisible assistants already surround you.

The First Half of the Day

8:00 — smart camera. You take a selfie for your story. You press the button, and within milliseconds AI has recognised your face, found the best angle, adjusted the lighting, blurred the background and enhanced the colours and contrast. Five operations instantly, and the photo comes out looking professional. Companion No. 5 on your journey — your personal photographer.

9:30 — smart search. You ask, "How do I remove a stain from a white blouse?" — and instead of a list of websites, you get a precise answer in a card at the top: soak it in a hydrogen peroxide solution… AI understood the question, analysed a vast number of pages, chose the best answer and rephrased it clearly. In a fraction of a second. Companion No. 6 — an instant expert on any question.

12:00 — smart email. You open your inbox. There's no spam: it has already been filtered out, your emails have been sorted by importance, and ready-made phrases have been suggested for quick replies. AI removed the clutter before

you even saw it. Companion No. 7 — your digital secretary.

The Second Half of the Day

14:00 — smart recommendations. It's your lunch break. You open a video service — and the first video in your feed is exactly what you wanted to watch. How did it know? AI studied your viewing history, the time you watched each item, your likes, what you skipped and even the time of day. The result is personalised "television", where every video seems to have been made just for you. Companions Nos. 8–12 and beyond…

18:00 — smart home. You come home and say, "Turn on the lights and the music." AI recognises your voice, understands the command, turns on the lights and chooses music to suit your evening mood. Companion No. 13 — a home that understands you.

22:00 — smart suggestions. You're writing to a friend: "Hi! How are th…" — and your phone suggests: "things?", "the day?", "to get there?". Autocorrect and predictive text are AI too. It has learned your style, your most common phrases, and predicts the next word. Companions Nos. 14–20 — and beyond, right through to the end of the day.

By evening: 47 times

Remember the figure from the story about the study? This is where it came from. The alarm clock, music, navigation, feeds, search, email, camera, recommendations, voice assistant, autocorrect… and that's only what we counted. In reality, it's more. Much more: every "smart" feature on your phone is AI.

The phenomenon of invisibility

Is it clearer now why most people don't notice? AI has become air. You don't think about air while you're breathing — it's simply there, everywhere and always. AI has dissolved into your life and become so natural that it has turned invisible. We don't see it because it works too well, too quietly, too seamlessly.

But now you know. You can see your invisible companions. You have awakened.

Why being attentive isn't paranoia but freedom

Let me say this upfront so I don't leave you with a false aftertaste: the aim of this chapter is not to scare you or tell you, "They're watching us." Most of these systems work for our benefit and are used with your consent —

recommendations, autocorrect, filters, smart cameras. Their invisibility is not a trick but a sign of mature technology: when a tool is so good that you don't think about it, that is, by and large, its victory.

But there's a difference between "not thinking about something because it's convenient" and "not knowing it exists at all." The first is comfort. The second is vulnerability: you can't consciously choose how to use something whose existence you don't even suspect.

The attentiveness we're practising now is not anxiety but awareness. You gain the right to decide: where to allow recommendations and where not to; what to trust automatically and what to check manually; where "smart" technology helps you and where it quietly replaces your choice. To see is to choose. Blindness means silently surrendering that choice. That's why "AI vision" in this book is not about fear, but about freedom and greater control over your own life.

And there's one more practical bonus. When you begin to *notice* technology, you begin to *understand* it — and understanding dispels awkwardness and the aura of "science." Before you master subtle communication with AI in Chapters 2 and 3, it's important simply to see that it doesn't appear "out of nowhere": there is a specific logic behind it, and anyone can understand it. Not because you're an IT specialist, but because it's a simple kind of curiosity — like taking apart a pair of headphones to find out where the sound comes from.

1.3. The "AI Detective" Experiment — Find All Your Invisible Helpers

Want to truly see all your companions? Let's play detective.

The aim of the game: find every interaction with AI in a single day. **The prize:** AI vision. Forever.

The Rules of the Game

What you'll need: a notebook or notes app on your phone, your attention, one free day, and a desire to see the truth.

What to count:

1. **Recommendations** — anything "selected for you": music, films and TV series, products, content, news.
2. **Automation** — anything that works on its own: autocorrect and T9, smart cameras (facial recognition, HDR, portrait mode), voice assistants, automatic

translation, speech recognition.

3. **Predictions** — systems that forecast: travel times in navigation apps, weather forecasts, autocomplete in search, “you may like,” “people also search for.”
4. **Filtering** — AI that decides for you: email spam filters, comment moderation, priority notifications, relevant search results.

How to Play, Step by Step

In the morning (5 minutes). Take a notebook, write “Day [date] — AI Detective,” and draw four columns: time — what I did — where AI was — note.

Throughout the day. Every time you notice AI, put a check mark beside it. You can add a description: “10:23 — the video service recommended a clip,” “12:15 — autocorrect fixed ‘hihhello’,” “14:30 — the store suggested something I ‘might like,’” “18:45 — the voice assistant played music.” Don’t skip the small things: every “smart” feature is AI.

In the evening (10 minutes). Count the check marks, write down the result, and think: what surprised you?

Where to look in advance: a time-of-day cheat sheet

So the detective doesn’t end up saying, “I didn’t notice anything,” here’s where AI hides at different times of day.

- **Morning:** alarm clock (adjustment based on sleep phases), weather forecast, background news-feed alerts, a “route summary” for getting to work.
- **Daytime:** search engines with answer cards, autocorrect in messages, feed recommendations during breaks, email spam filters, smart recognition of documents and photos, text suggestions.
- **Evening:** voice assistant, smart home, TV series and video recommendations, “you may like” suggestions in an online store, automatic updates and smart charging.
- **Night:** smart sleep trackers, automatic photo libraries, synchronization and personalization working without your involvement.

With this cheat sheet, you won’t miss a single “smart” neighbor.

What It Looks Like in Practice

Here’s what a completed diary by one participant might look like (a composite example) — so you understand what level of detail is useful and what is excessive:

Time	What I did	Where AI was	Note
07:30	checked my sleep	sleep tracker, alarm clock	the report says “deep sleep”
08:05	read the news feed	personalized feed	selected “for me”
09:40	wrote to a colleague	autocorrect + suggestions	corrected “hihhello”
12:15	looked up a recipe	answer card in search results	answer without visiting the site
18:30	watched a video	feed recommendations	the first one was my favorite
21:10	ordered groceries	“you may like”	added to the cart
22:50	said “lights”	voice assistant	the command worked

You don’t need to record every second — just note the fact and add a brief comment. What matters is not the neatness of the log, but the act of paying attention.

What You’ll Most Likely Find

- **10–20 interactions** — a good start; you’re beginning to see. Look more closely tomorrow: there are more than it seems.
- **30–50** — you noticed many invisible digital helpers and can already see what usually remains in the background.
- **50–70** — wow, you’re either very attentive or a very active user.
- **Fewer than 10** — two possibilities: either you voluntarily disconnected from the digital world for a day, or AI works so unobtrusively that you didn’t recognize it. Try again tomorrow — and pay attention to every “smart” feature.

Why Do This Experiment

The exact percentages aren’t important here. What matters is the idea behind the experiment, which fits well with the psychology of attention: **awareness alone changes behavior.** We don’t notice what we aren’t tuned in to. Once you adopt the mindset “look for AI around you,” you begin to see it — and therefore make conscious decisions about it rather than running on autopilot.

That's precisely why this experiment is useful in its own right.

Bonus Level

Want to make it harder? For one day, try living *almost without* AI: listen to the radio instead of a personalized stream, drive from memory without a navigation app, read only your subscriptions, and turn off autocorrect. See how long you last. Most people give up after a couple of hours — and that's fine. The experiment will show you how deeply technology has already entered your routine. After all, we depend on electricity, the internet, and smartphones too. AI is simply the next level of the same habit, and there's nothing shameful about that.

What Happens After the Experiment

Once you've counted your interactions, something irreversible happens: you can no longer "unsee" them. You'll start noticing AI in every "smart" app, every recommendation, every automated decision.

It's permanent. And that's a good thing: those who can see can use it consciously, and therefore more effectively.

Share Your Discovery

One final but important step: tell at least one person. A friend, relative, or colleague: "You know, I counted how many times I interacted with AI in one day. Guess how many? Forty-seven times! Can you believe it?" Don't keep your knowledge to yourself — open someone else's eyes just as someone once opened yours. It needs to dawn on someone else too.

And here's one more "share" bonus: by saying out loud exactly what you saw, you understand it more deeply yourself and reinforce it. Knowledge that you share lives longer — and stops being abstract theory, becoming your personal practice.

1.4. Marina's Story — When a Discovery Changes Your Life Forever

Meet Her

[MARKER: Composite example.] What follows is a story in which the feelings and figures are deliberately composite: a portrait that brings together the stories of many people who went from "I couldn't care less about AI" to "AI is my partner." The names, city, and specific numbers are fictional and combine the

experiences of many readers; don’t look for a specific real-life woman in her — look for yourself.

Our heroine is Marina, 34, a sales manager at an IT company. An ordinary life: work, home, two children, an endless race against time. Exhaustion, the feeling that there simply aren’t enough hours in the day, being pulled in every direction by a dozen tasks. Sound familiar?

One day she came across an article about that very study — those very interactions with AI dozens of times a day. “Nonsense,” she thought. “At most, I use it maybe five times: a search engine, and sometimes a navigation app.” But she decided to check, simply out of curiosity. Three days that changed everything.

Day 1: Blindness

In the morning, Marina took a notebook, wrote “AI Detective, Day 1,” and marked every interaction throughout the day. By evening, there were 12 checkmarks. “Well, that’s not much,” she reassured herself. “The study didn’t exaggerate after all.” She went to bed feeling calm.

Day 2: Revelation

In the morning, a thought crossed her mind: “Maybe I just wasn’t paying attention?” She decided to be more attentive, to notice every little thing. And she started finding them:

- autocorrect in the messenger app — AI;
- the smart camera on her phone — AI;
- “you might also like” recommendations in the store — AI;
- the spam filter in her email — AI;
- typing suggestions — AI.

By evening — 28. “Now that’s more like it. Much more than I thought.” But the main revelation was still to come.

Day 3: Shock

Now Marina saw AI literally everywhere. Search suggestions — AI. Page translation in the browser — AI. Music recognition — AI. “Smart” charging — AI. Keyboard suggestions — AI. By evening — 52. She sat there with her notebook, grinning from ear to ear: “Oh my God, it’s everywhere! How did I not see this

before?”

What Changed Next (in summary)

After that, it was no longer about a single day, but about months of practice. Alongside her own experience and that of hundreds of people like her, she began to approach AI not as a random tool, but systematically.

At work. Before: she prepared presentations manually — four hours at a time, wrote reports for three hours, and spent an hour searching for information. Later, with the help of AI chats: she built a presentation structure in forty minutes, prepared reports in half an hour, and found relevant information in ten minutes. By her estimate, the time saved amounted to many hours a week; she spent some of it doing her work more deeply and better. It was precisely this improvement in quality, not just speed, that raised the level of her results — and that affected how management viewed her and advanced her career.

In her personal life. Evenings for her family returned: two free hours a day that she hadn’t had before. Some of the routine disappeared, and with it some of the exhaustion and guilt. One day her husband said, “Marina, you’re glowing. What happened?” “I learned to see the helpers who had always been рядом,” she replied.

What Changed Inside

A few months later, over coffee, she shared something more important than any figures:

> *“I used to be afraid of new technology: I thought, ‘This is complicated.’ Now I think, ‘Oh, another helper.’ The chat is my colleague and creative partner, the voice assistant is my secretary, and the navigation app is my navigator. I’m not alone. I’m the captain of a team of digital assistants, and together we can do more.”*

She didn’t become a “technology genius.” She simply paid attention one day.

Small Tips She Would Give You

If we were sitting over coffee, Marina and I, I would invite her to share the things she says most often. I’ll gather those thoughts here — they’re short, but substantial.

- **Don’t start with big goals.** Not “I’ll learn all about AI,” but “Today I’ll count how many times I use it.” A small first step sets everything else in motion.
- **Don’t be afraid of looking awkward.** Everyone once had no idea what to ask a chat. Start with something simple: a recipe, a letter, a plan. Confidence comes with experience, not before it.
- **Trust, but verify what matters.** (This is covered in detail in Chapter 3.) Marina simply got into the habit of checking the most important things herself — and that saved her from awkward situations.
- **Don’t compare yourself.** Someone else may “get it done faster” — it doesn’t matter. You have your own curve, and it rises with every day of practice.
- **Share.** When you tell someone about what you noticed, you don’t just help others — you reinforce your own knowledge.

These tips are useful not only for AI. But they work especially well with AI because the tool produces a tangible result instantly — and motivates you to keep going.

Your Moment of Transformation

[MARKER: composite example.] Marina’s story is not an isolated case, but a typical journey. Many people — not only those I know personally, but also the subjects of dozens of posts, interviews, and books on the topic — have gone through the same process: they didn’t see AI → they ran an experiment → their eyes were opened → they began using it consciously.

You could be next. Simply run the experiment: one day, twenty-four hours, count your invisible companions. Once acquired, AI vision doesn’t fade. It’s free, it’s forever — and it changes the way you look at the world.

What You Covered in Chapter 1

1.1 — learned about the study and the figure “47 times a day”; 1.2 — went through your entire day with AI and saw your companions; 1.3 — received a tool: the detective experiment and practical exercises; 1.4 — heard a story of transformation.

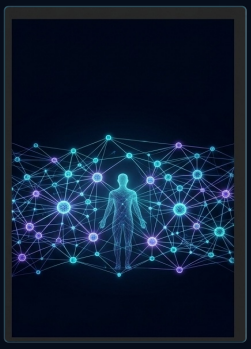
Transition to Chapter 2

You see AI all around you. But how does it “think”? Why does it sometimes understand you better than a real-life conversation partner? Chapter 2 reveals

the secret. We have a neuroscientist's story ahead of us, the story of two musicians, and the most important question: in what ways are we like machines, and in what ways are we fundamentally different.# PART TWO. UNDERSTANDING

Chapter 2. Understanding — a Mirror of Human Consciousness

"AI is not an alien mind. It is another way of embodying information processing. And when you understand that, you stop being afraid of it and begin to see it as a partner."



2.1. The Woman Who Didn't Believe: Anna and "Similar Patterns"

Meet Her

[MARKER: composite example.] The heroine who follows is a composite portrait of a neuroscientist; her thoughts, doubts, and revelation are drawn from the experiences of many scientists working at the intersection of neuroscience and AI. Her name, institute, city, and the specific details of the experiment are fictional and serve the story, not a documentary account.

So, Anna is a neuroscientist with a doctorate who has spent a decade and a half studying the human brain: how we think, make decisions, and generate ideas. Hundreds of papers, conferences, recognition in her field.

And she was absolutely certain that machines would never think like humans.

"They have no emotions," she told her students. "No intuition, no consciousness, no soul. They're calculators. Very fast, very complex—but still calculators. They calculate. We think. That's the fundamental difference."

Her colleagues nodded—she was an authority, and she believed it herself.

The Invitation

One cold January, she received a letter from her British colleagues at an artificial intelligence laboratory:

> *“Anna, come. We’ve discovered something—something that concerns the nature of thought, human and machine. It will overturn everything you know about the mind. You have to see it with your own eyes.”*

“What have they come up with this time?” she wondered with a frown. “Probably another round of hype about chatbots being ‘almost human.’” But the scientist’s curiosity won out. A week later, she was in London—in the very laboratory that had created the AI that once defeated the world champion at Go and solved what had seemed to be an impossible scientific problem: predicting protein structures.

A professor met her—a neuroscientist and AI specialist, with gray hair and a kind smile. “Amaze me,” Anna said skeptically. “Oh, I will,” he promised, leading her into the laboratory.

The Experiment

[MARKER: the experiment is a plot illustration, not a study documented in a publication. The description below is metaphorical rather than a measurable fact.]

A large room, two screens, equipment. At one screen sat a volunteer, a young mathematician wearing a helmet that scanned his brain activity in real time. At the other was a computer running a chatbot; its screen was split: a chat on the left, and on the right a visualization of which parts of the neural network activated as it solved the problem.

They were given the same logic problem—about houses, dogs, and cats, in which they had to calculate the minimum and maximum number of houses containing both kinds of animals. “Begin!” And activity flashed on both screens.

And this was what astonished Anna.

On the left was a human brain; on the right, a neural network. And the stages were similar: first, areas responsible for parsing the conditions lit up in both; then areas looking for patterns and solutions; then areas checking the result; and finally, areas producing the answer. Human and machine performed the same dance: understand, find a pattern, test a hypothesis, make a decision.

David looked at her. Anna stood silent, her eyes wide.

“It’s not a coincidence,” he said gently. “A similar way of processing information. Thousands of very different people and a wide range of models—and every time,

the same architecture: input → search for patterns → verification → output.”

This scene is a **composite thought experiment**, not a description of one specific study. Directly comparing brain fMRI activity with the operation of a neural network would be scientifically incorrect. It would be more accurate to say this: **when solving problems, humans and modern AI systems can exhibit structurally similar stages**—receiving input data, finding a pattern, testing a hypothesis, and forming a conclusion. It is a useful analogy, but not proof that the brain and the machine are identical.

The Moment of Insight

“It’s not that we’re alone,” Anna said quietly, speaking first. “It’s just that… the mind can be embodied in different ways. Biologically—in us. Digitally—in a machine. And these embodiments solve problems in similar ways.”

That evening, she could not calm down in her hotel room. Everything she had believed for years needed to be reconsidered. This did not mean that machines were “exactly like us”: they had no emotions or consciousness in the biological sense, while the question of a soul was philosophical. But the process of solving a problem—understanding, searching for a pattern, checking, drawing a conclusion—turned out to be organized in a similar way. Thinking as a process is not the sole preserve of biology.

Later, she wrote an article with a title that sounded something like this: **“Rethinking the Nature of Mind: Thinking as a Property of Complex Information-Processing Systems.”** In it, she argued that the human brain was one realization of such a process, while AI was another; the essence was the ability to take in data, find patterns within it, and produce an output. Some applauded, some argued, and some did not believe her. Scientific debate is normal and useful. But for her, the heart of the story was this: fear of an “alien mind” gives way to familiarity.

And notice: this story does not claim anything impossible. It says “the problem-solving architecture is similar,” not “the machine experiences things as a human does.” This very modest and honest conclusion turns out to be genuinely transformative: to stop being afraid, you do not need AI to be “like you.” It is enough to see that it is structured in an intelligible and logical way—and then your mind does the rest on its own: it replaces anxiety with curiosity and turns the “alien” into a “partner.”

Why This Matters to You

You are not a neuroscientist. And you are not required to be interested in this. But the simple feeling that “AI is not built like a stargate; it is understandable, and similar to me” changes everything:

- you stop being afraid of it—it is not “magic,” but logic;
- you begin to see it as a partner rather than an alien mechanism;
- you learn to communicate with it—as you would with a very logical, very well-read friend;
- and, most importantly, you understand how to get the maximum benefit from it.

Calm Instead of Fear

Have you noticed? Almost all the fear that “AI will take over, defeat us, replace us” grows out of the feeling that it is alien and unknowable. As soon as you discard the mystery—“it is logic like mine, only in a different shell”—fear gives way to curiosity. You do not have to understand every formula behind it; a general picture is enough to make you feel confident. In much the same way, you use a smartphone without assembling it from individual microchips.

And there is one more thing this knowledge gives you: a calm attitude toward “sensational” headlines. When the news says that “AI has surpassed humanity,” you already know that this is noise: behind the pretty phrase stands a specific tool that is strong at some tasks and weak at others. Superiority “overall” is meaningless—what matters is suitability for the task. A machine may count faster than anyone, but it cannot feel which of two proposed paths is right for you. This clear-eyed perspective is also part of AI literacy.

2.2. Two Musicians—A Simple Explanation of Something Complex

Anna’s story is impressive, I admit: but the terms, experiments, concepts… Let me explain it all more simply. Without the science. Through an image.

Imagine Two Musicians

Evening. A concert hall. Onstage are instruments that must perform the same melody.

The first instrument is a concert grand piano: wood, hammers, strings. A mechanical, “warm,” living sound.

The second is a digital piano: chips, wires, speakers. An electronic, precise, clean

sound.

But the melody is the same—let's say a popular march. The listener closes their eyes and hears the same piece of music. It does not matter what they play it on. What matters is *what* they play.

The Parallel: The Brain and AI—Different Instruments, Similar Process

The human brain is a "biological instrument of thought": approximately 86 billion neurons, electrical impulses, chemical substances, the result of millions of years of evolution, weighing about one and a half kilograms, while consuming, by various estimates, only around twenty watts of energy—less than many light bulbs.

Modern AI is a "digital information-processing tool": a large mathematical network with an enormous number of parameters, running on servers and requiring significant computing resources and energy.

The tools are different. But the way they process information is similar. Both:

1. **Analyze input data.** You see text—the brain assembles letters into words and meaning. AI receives text—the network processes fragments and extracts meaning.
2. **Find patterns.** From experience, you know: dark clouds mean rain. AI knows from a vast body of training examples: when pattern X appears, Y is likely to follow.
3. **Learn from experience.** You made a mistake, remembered it—and do things differently next time. AI adjusts based on errors during training—and answers more accurately next time.
4. **Create something new based on what they have learned.** You have read many books and write your own, combining ideas. AI, trained on millions of texts, generates something new by combining learned patterns.

If you like, this is what "thinking" is: taking in data, finding patterns, drawing conclusions. The only difference is that one embodiment is biological, while the other is digital.

So what is the difference?

And this is where it is essential to name the differences honestly. They are fundamental, and your strength is built precisely on them.

Speed. You think at the speed of nerve impulses— that is fast, but limited. AI calculates almost instantly: what takes a person seconds, a machine does in milliseconds. But speed is not the same as intelligence—it is simply speed. A fast calculator is not necessarily a wise person, while a slow-thinking human may see what no amount of speed will find without direction.

Energy. Your brain is phenomenally efficient: it runs on the “power of a light bulb” while doing astonishing things. Large models require entire data centers. Nature optimized your brain over millions of years; AI has existed in anything like its current form for only a couple of decades. It has plenty of room to grow.

Emotions and intuition. You have feelings, moods, and that “gut feeling that this is right”—and they help you make decisions and see the nuances between the lines. AI has no emotions: it has pattern analysis. This is both an advantage—it is objective, does not lose its temper, and is not affected by fatigue—and a disadvantage: it lacks empathy and will not pick up on the subtleties of feelings and moods.

Creativity. You are capable of flashes of insight—of creating something that no one has created before. AI combines what it has learned brilliantly, but that is exactly what it does: combine. Brilliantly, freely—and based on what it has already seen.

Conclusion: together, you are stronger

It is not about “who is smarter,” but “who does what better.” Give AI the routine tasks (it does not get tired), the analysis of large volumes of information (it is fast), and the generation of many options (it is generous). Keep the final decisions for yourself (your intuition), everything involving emotions and people (your empathy), and strategy (your vision). A formula worth repeating to yourself: **speed and volume belong to machines; taste and direction belong to you.**

And yet: this is not “consciousness”

Let me state this clearly, so you do not leave with the wrong picture. “AI thinks similarly” must not sound like “the machine has a soul, feelings, and plans.” Modern models are computational systems that excel at *processing information*, but they have no experience, intentions, or consciousness in the sense that we know them from ourselves.

Why is it important to distinguish this? There are a couple of reasons. First, a false comparison leads either to fear—“it is plotting something”—or, conversely,

to naïve trust—“it cares about me.” Both extremes are harmful. Second, an honest picture makes you stronger: you use the power of the *tool*, rather than expecting from it something it does not have (compassion, a conscience, personal choice). The analogy with a grand piano and a piano works all the way through: both produce music, but neither “listens” to it or takes pleasure in it. You are the one who listens and takes pleasure—and that, rather than “the machine thinks like I do,” is what makes you indispensable in the partnership.

Where this leads you

Understanding the similarities and differences is not a theoretical luxury. The entire next chapter is built on it: if you know that AI can process context and look for patterns, but cannot read minds and does not know your life, it immediately becomes clear how to talk to it. Give it context, be specific, set a format—and check the result. These simple conclusions from the “two musicians” are the foundation of the practical skill we will explore in chapter 3.

2.3. The language of partnership: how AI understands words

Now that you know AI “thinks” similarly, let us look at how it understands your words. We will look under the hood using a simple example.

You write to a chatbot: *“Write an email to my manager asking for a pay rise”*. What happens inside?

Step 1—analyzing words and context. AI looks at each word: “email” → a formal, structured genre; “manager” → a formal, respectful tone; “request” → delicate wording, not a demand; “pay rise” → a specific and sensitive subject. It responds not only to vocabulary, but also to context —because it was trained on a vast body of texts in which it saw thousands of similar emails.

Step 2—looking for patterns. AI “remembers” how such emails are usually structured: a greeting, an explanation of your value, a delicately worded request, arguments, and a call to action. In a fraction of a second, it finds what the examples have in common.

Step 3—assembling the response. By combining these patterns, it assembles text that sounds natural and professional—as if it had been written by an experienced specialist.

That is why people talk about “AI” as a “conversation partner”: it does not “take an answer from a database of ready-made emails”; it *creates* an answer based

on what it has learned. And this leads to the main practical conclusion.

Important limitations

I will also be honest about what AI **cannot** do (yet):

- understand your unique situation until you describe it yourself;
- truly feel emotions—it only recognizes what people usually feel in similar situations and chooses appropriate wording;
- take into account cultural, contextual, or personal nuances that you have not mentioned.

What it can do: combine what it has learned, adapt to the context you provide, and generate different phrasings at your request.

This leads to a simple and very important rule—**the more useful context you provide, the better the result.** The model does not “get upset” or “guess based on your mood”; it simply draws conclusions from what it receives as input. Give it as complete and accurate a picture as possible—and you will get text relevant specifically to you.

Let us be precise: about the word “understands”

When people say “AI understands language,” it is easy to imagine something with a soul and compassion. The honest picture is different and, in my view, no less astonishing. The model does not “reflect on your feelings” or “know” the world as you do. It has learned from a gigantic volume of human texts to recognize which words and meanings usually go together, which formulations are appropriate in which situations, and how different genres are structured. This is not “understanding” in the human sense, but an exceptionally powerful statistical model of language.

And yet this statistic is remarkably useful—because human speech has captured an enormous number of meanings and connections over thousands of years. By learning from publications, books, letters, and dialogues, the model “absorbs” not only words, but also how people think, reason, object, joke, and comfort one another. That is why it can produce appropriate, warm, and precise wording—even though “behind the scenes” there is no lived experience, only the calculation of probabilities for the next fragment.

Why am I writing about this? So that you neither overestimate nor undervalue it. Don’t attribute feelings to it—and don’t dismiss it as “just word autocomplete.”

Both extremes will prevent you from using it well. The right attitude is closer to viewing it as a “highly capable, widely read, but *without life experience* assistant”: respect for its abilities and a clear understanding of its limitations. With this mindset, you’ll get maximum benefit and minimum disappointment—and you should interpret its mistakes not as maliciousness, but as the limits of its training.

Try it yourself

Open a chatbot and give it the same request in two ways: “Write copy for a café” and a detailed version—“Write copy for a cosy coffee shop in the city centre for regular customers aged 25–40; warm tone; a short paragraph for the display window; mention the weekday morning discount.” Compare the answers. You’ll literally feel with your own hands how context changes the result—and why Chapter 3 will teach you to get the most out of it.

2.4. Four Rules for Communicating—and Sergey’s Story

The Four Golden Rules

Let me remind you that all four rules are really one rule, formulated from four different angles. AI is only as good as the picture you give it is complete and accurate.

- *Be specific* → it doesn’t have to guess what you need;
- *give context* → it doesn’t invent your situation;
- *specify the format* → it doesn’t choose the form for you;
- *ask it to explain* → you move towards the goal together instead of getting stuck in misunderstanding.

Keep these four as a single principle: **think first, then type.** Even half a minute spent thinking through your goal—before sending the request— will save you minutes and frustration afterwards.

Now that you know how AI processes your text, here are four simple rules that will immediately improve your prompts.

Rule 1. Be specific. The clearer the task, the more accurate the answer. *Bad:* “Help me with my work.” AI doesn’t know who you are, what you do, or what exactly you need. *Good:* “I’m a sales manager. I need an outline for a presentation about our new services for potential clients—10 slides.”

Rule 2. Give context. AI isn't telepathic and hasn't seen your life. Tell it who you are and what situation you're in. *Bad:* "What should I do?" *Good:* "I'm a marketer at an IT company. We need to increase sales by 30% this quarter, and the budget is limited. What can we do to attract customers without spending a lot?"

Rule 3. Specify the format. AI can answer in different ways—tell it how you want the answer. *Bad:* "Tell me about AI" (a ten-page article? a list of five points? an explanation for a child?). *Good:* "Explain what AI is in simple terms, using specific examples from everyday life—five short paragraphs, each with its own example."

Rule 4. Ask it to explain and clarify. If you don't understand, say so: "explain it more simply, as if to a child," "give me an example from real life," "tell me step by step what I should do," "show me using my situation as an example." AI has no pride. It won't be offended or reproach you. It will rephrase things until you understand.

Sergey's Story: from Search Engine to Conversation Partner

[MARKER: composite example.]What follows is a typical developer's story; the name, details, and specific figures for timelines and income are hypothetical and combine the experience of many people who changed their approach to AI in their work.

Sergey is a programmer with several years of experience at a conventional company. He used to think of a chatbot as an "improved search engine": short queries such as "how to create a website," "what is an API," or "an error in my code." And he got short, general answers. It helped, but not much.

Then he read about *how* AI processes a prompt—and most importantly, that he could communicate with it like a colleague: provide context, set a goal, and specify the format.

Before: *"How do I create a website?"* After: *"I'm a programmer with experience in Python. I want to build an online bookshop for young people aged 18–25: fast loading, a mobile version, and convenient payment. Which technology should I choose, and why? Give me a step-by-step plan"*.

He compared the result himself to "a consultation with an experienced developer": a detailed plan, the reasoning behind every choice, code examples for key functions, advice on design and security, and a list of pitfalls. Instead of a

couple of general paragraphs, he got a complete working guide. He built the site in a matter of days instead of the usual weeks.

“When I realised that AI wasn’t a search engine but a conversation partner that processed information in a way similar to mine, everything changed,” he says. “I started asking questions as I would ask an expert colleague: I provided context, clarified what I wanted to get, and received answers that were many times more useful.”

Higher efficiency → better solutions → greater employee value. In his case, this was also reflected in his income—although, as with Marina, the point isn’t the money but that work stopped being a “struggle with text.”

Your Practical Assignment

Enough theory. Right now:

1. Open any chatbot (ChatGPT, YandexGPT, your assistant).
2. Think of a task you’ve been putting off for a long time: a letter, a plan, or solving a problem.
3. Write a prompt using the four rules—who you are (context), what needs to be done (specifics), what result you need (format), and what conditions apply.
4. Send it and compare the result with what you would have got by asking “any old way.”

Example of a ready-made prompt:

> *“I’m a mother of two, and I work remotely as a marketer. I want to introduce my seven-year-old daughter to the basics of programming, but I’m not an expert myself. Create a one-month plan: 20 minutes a day, in a playful format, without complex terms, using specific services. Format: a table with days, topics, and activities.”*

The Most Important Points from Chapter 2

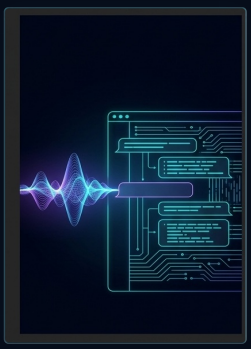
- AI processes your prompt as an algorithm *trained on vast amounts of* data: it recognises the context and assembles an answer from learned patterns;
- it does not “take something ready-made from a database,” but **creates** it for your task—which is why context and specificity matter so much;
- the architecture of problem-solving in humans and AI is structurally similar—

once you see this, you begin to see it as a partner rather than something alien;

- the four rules—specificity, context, format, and “explain it more simply”— will improve every prompt you write right now.

PART THREE. MASTERY

Chapter 3. Mastery —the Art of Communicating with AI



“The ability to talk to AI—or, more precisely, the ability to think together with it— is one of the most practical skills today.”

Take a breath: this chapter is easier than the previous ones. No complicated science or philosophy— just practical advice and specific tools you can apply today. And unlike many other things, the result is visible immediately, in the very first minutes. Let’s get started.

3.1. The formula for a strong prompt: objective, context, constraints, criteria, format, verification

The Story of Two Prompts

[MARKER: composite example.] Two people — let’s call them Alex and Boris. One task: write an article for a company blog. Both use the same chatbot. Both, let’s assume, are intelligent and well educated.

Boris wrote, “Write an article about cloud technologies,” and got a generic, dry text that was not suited to his audience. Then the revision carousel began: “make it simpler,” “add examples,” “no, use a different tone,” “make it shorter,” “add figures”… a dozen iterations, fatigue, irritation. An hour spent, and no satisfaction.

Alex spent a minute thinking before writing a detailed prompt: who the article was for, what tone and length it should have, and what response it should elicit at the end. The very first answer hit the mark, leaving only a little adaptation to do.

The difference is not intelligence or “magic.” The difference lies in the **quality of the prompt**—in the exact task specification the model received and the form in which it received it. A good prompt is not a spell but a good technical brief. Like any sensible worker, AI needs clear boundaries, not “make it look nice.”

Six Elements of a Strong Prompt

Instead of the short abbreviation “role + context + task + format,” I’ll offer a more honest and more powerful six-part framework. It explains *why* it works and covers cases that the simple formula misses.

1. Objective. What exactly do you want to achieve? What will the person (including you) who receives the result do with it next—publish it, make a decision, understand the topic? *An article for a client who makes budget decisions* and *an article for yourself to understand the issue* are two different “tasks,” and AI needs to know which one it is handling.

2. Context. Who are you in this situation, what is already known, what data is available, who is the intended recipient of the result, and what tone is appropriate? AI has not seen your life—describe it as fully as is useful. The fuller the picture, the more relevant the answer.

3. Constraints. What must it *not* do: no links to unverified figures, no jargon, no longer than a specified number of characters, do not offer services that do not exist, use only certain sources. Constraints are often more important than preferences: they cut off the obvious “stupid” options that the model would otherwise suggest by default.

4. Quality criteria. How will you know that the result is good? “The text is easy to read,” “every claim is supported by a source,” “three headline options for social media.” Explicit criteria turn the vague “make it good” into a verifiable task.

5. Format. What should the result look like: length, structure, style, a table or a list, examples, steps? Say so right away and you’ll get what you need the first time, rather than after ten rounds of revisions.

6. Verification. The most underrated of the six. Don’t take the model’s word for it: ask it to cite the source of the data where necessary and, most importantly, check the facts and figures yourself if the task requires it. I’ll say this plainly—I’ll explain it in the section on advanced techniques, but remember it now: **AI is confident, but not always accurate.** The more important the decision, the more carefully you should check it yourself. This is not “distrust,” but normal practice when working with a serious tool.

The Formula in Action

The task: a social media post about your product.

Weak prompt: “Write a post about our product” → generic, saying nothing, and

not selling anything.

Strong prompt:

> ***Objective:*** *sell through a Story so that female followers become interested and visit the profile.* ***Context:*** *an eco-cosmetics store; the audience is women aged 25–40 who care about health and the environment and are active on social media.* ***Constraints:*** *no "chemicals are evil" and no manipulative "today only" claims; keep it short.* ***Criteria:*** *a catchy opening frame caption, one specific benefit, and one clear call to action.* ***Format:*** *up to 200 characters, conversational tone, one or two emojis, ending with a prompt to view the profile.*

The difference between the two versions is precisely the difference between "spending an hour on revisions" and "sending it almost immediately."

Three Types of Tasks—Three Framework Examples

The same principle looks different depending on the objective. Let's look at three common cases so that you can recognize the pattern on the fly.

"Letter / text" task. The objective is a result for the recipient; the context is who is writing, to whom, and about what; the constraints are tone, length, and what to mention or leave out; the criteria are clarity and naturalness; the format is the structure of the letter; verification means rereading it through the recipient's eyes to check that no clichés remain.

"Plan / analysis" task. The objective is to make a decision; the context is the input data and type of task; the constraints are budget, deadlines, and prohibitions; the criteria are the soundness of every step; the format is stages and assumptions, so that they can be checked; verification means recalculating the key figures yourself.

"Ideas / creativity" task. The objective is to obtain a range of options; the context is the topic and inspiring examples; the constraints are feasibility requirements; the criteria are originality and relevance; the format is several options of different types, not just one; verification means choosing the best one and refining it through iterations.

Notice? The same framework, with different emphases. Once you master it, you can apply it to anything—from a letter to a business plan.

Why It Works

Because language is an interface to vast “knowledge” for large models, but without your boundaries, the model does not know *which part* of that knowledge to retrieve or *how* to use it. A good prompt is like a good technical brief for an executor: the more precise the boundaries and the clearer your definition of success, the fewer costly reworks you need. This is neither magic nor a promise of a fixed improvement, but simple logic: fewer guesses → fewer misses → faster results.

Your First Assignment

Think of a task you need to solve—a letter, post, plan, report, anything. Compose a prompt using the six points and send it. Compare it with what you would have got without the structure. I bet the difference will surprise you.

Common Beginner Mistakes (and How to Avoid Repeating Them)

Make a list of typical mistakes so that you can recognize them in advance.

Mistake 1—everything at once, without an objective. A request such as “make it beautiful” or “write about marketing” gives the model too much freedom, so it chooses a “default” answer—generic and therefore useless. The remedy: define the objective and the intended recipient before you sit down to type.

Mistake 2—confusing context with length. More text is not always better; sometimes a detailed prompt buries what matters under secondary information. The remedy: include only what *affects the result*—who the recipient is, what you need to obtain, and what is forbidden.

Mistake 3—forgetting verification. The model confidently generates both what is true and what merely sounds convincing but is inaccurate. The remedy: do not treat the answer as infallible; double-check figures and facts on which the decision depends.

Mistake 4—perfectionism on the first try. Expecting perfection immediately means wishing for something that does not exist. The remedy: iterate. The first draft is material; refinement is its processing—the “iterative improvement” technique from 3.3.

Error 5 — “The model didn’t understand me; it’s malicious.” Most often, the problem is that we haven’t given it enough boundaries. The remedy: when

you get something other than what you wanted, clarify exactly what is wrong and agree on the details instead of taking offence.

3.2. What this looks like for real people: three stories

[MARKER: composite examples.] All three of the people below are composite portraits: their personalities, tasks, and results are typical, while the names and specific figures are illustrative, to show how the formula works in real life without claiming documentary accuracy.

Maria: a routine that stopped being hell

A marketer with three children, constantly racing between work and family. Every month, it was the same thing: a content plan for the company's social media, twenty posts, different formats, copy, ideas, and visuals. Hours of pure routine every month. "Creativity under pressure is hell," she admitted.

She tried a new formulation. Instead of "help me with some posts," she gave a detailed assignment: an experienced content writer for an IT company; the audience is small-business owners who are intimidated by complex technology; twenty posts for the month, balancing educational, case-study, and sales content, each with copy, a visual idea, and hashtags, in a friendly tone with an emphasis on simplicity and saving time.

The result pleasantly surprised her: almost everything "arrived" in the first draft —the plan structure, topics for each day, copy that needed only slight adaptation, visual ideas, and selected hashtags. The routine that used to take hours was reduced to a relatively short pass with AI. After repeating the approach for other tasks—emails, scripts, client responses—she freed up a noticeable part of her week and, most importantly, stopped hating the routine side of her work.

"I stopped trying to break through a wall with words. Now the algorithm handles the boring stuff, and I focus on what really requires me—taste and decisions," she says.

Igor: launching a business without a copywriting budget

A programmer who had worked "for the man" for years, he dreamed of starting his own business—a healthy-food delivery service. At last he took the plunge, quit his job, took out a loan, and launched the project. Then he hit a wall: he needed website copy, email campaigns, social media posts, dish descriptions, and scripts for managers. Writing was not his strength, and he had no money to

hire a freelance copywriter for all of it.

At first, “writing with a bot” did not work—the result was generic and impersonal. Then he tried a different approach: describing who he was writing for (busy professionals aged 25–35 with no time to cook), what mattered to the audience (saving time, quality, and variety), what the text needed to do (spark interest and lead to a first order), and what it should be like—friendly and energetic, with a couple of appetising dish descriptions and a clear call to action.

He compared the very first text with the work of a professional copywriter. From there, everything fell into place: all the launch copy was ready in a matter of days instead of months, and at no cost. **[MARKER: result figures are illustrative]** A few months later, the service was operating, customers were coming in, and he managed to pay off the loan earlier than expected. “Without this approach, I simply wouldn’t have launched with the money I had,” he says.

Olga: genius that was finally understood

A freelance designer whose work is art. There was just one drawback: she could not translate visuals into words. Clients were constantly asking her to “describe the concept,” “explain why you chose these colours,” or “write a project presentation.” She spent hours struggling with the copy, but it came out dry and failed to convey the idea. Clients could not see her talent because she could not explain it in words.

A friend suggested, “Tell the bot in detail what you see. Don’t just say ‘write some copy’; describe what the project looks like and who it is for.” Olga did exactly that: the style, palette, materials, and atmosphere; who the presentation was for (a café owner who valued tradition and wanted a modern look); and what was important to convey (why minimalism was used, how cultural elements were integrated, and what feelings visitors would experience).

She described the result as bringing her tears of joy: “It described what I felt but could not put into words.” From then on, AI became her “translator” from visual to verbal: for concept descriptions, presentations, and portfolio posts. Clients finally understood her vision—her number of commissions and average fee grew, while her stress disappeared. She did not change as a designer. She learned to *speak*.

What they had in common

Three professions, three tasks—and one framework: set a goal, provide context, define constraints and format, and name the success criteria. For all three of

them, the result was the same: time saved, less stress, and more attention available for what requires a human being. The formula is not a “magic button for success”—it is a way to spend less effort on routine and more on real work. Proven in practice.

Your turn

Choose one task—work-related (an email, report, or presentation), creative (a post, article, or ideas), or personal (a plan, decision, or piece of advice)—and run it through the six points from 3.1. Then compare it with the result of doing it “any old way.” I’m sure you’ll quickly see the difference.

It is important to choose not an “ideal” task, but a *real* one that you were going to do anyway. The big secret to progress is that you practise on real work rather than apart from it: a skill applied immediately to something practical stays with you, while something you merely “play around with” is forgotten within a week.

3.3. Advanced techniques: an honest look at “mastery”

The basic framework is enough for most tasks. But there are techniques that make you stronger on complex cases. And first, an important correction to something you see written in many places today.

> ***An honest framework instead of “secret techniques.”*** *Some courses teach you to “make the model reveal its hidden chain of thought” in order to get a “more accurate answer.” I do not teach that here—and this is why. First, the model’s internal steps are generally not “visible” to anyone, while what it presents “step by step” is a reconstruction it builds in response to your request; it may sound convincing, but it does not necessarily reflect its actual logic. Second, it is far more reliable and useful not to “ask the machine to explain itself,” but to ask it to produce an analysis that can be checked, and—most importantly—to check it yourself. Mastery means checking the result, not merely making it sound confident.*

So instead of a “magical chain of thought,” here are practical techniques worth mastering.

Technique 1. “Break it down and show the steps” (structured analysis). For complex tasks, ask not for an “answer” but for *the process in the output*: a breakdown into stages, assumptions, how point A leads to point B, and what can be checked. This makes the answer transparent and convenient for you to verify

yourself, rather than a “secret train of thought.”

> *Weak: “Calculate the budget for launching an online clothing store.”*
> *Strong: “Give me a budget for launching an online clothing store: divide it into the main expense categories, give a price range and assumptions for each, and mark what is essential and what can be postponed. Show the calculation logic so that I can check the figures myself.”*

Now you no longer have a “number out of nowhere”, but a calculator with its assumptions out in the open—one you can recalculate.

Technique 2. “Different roles” — to spot blind spots. Ask it to look at the question from several perspectives: investor, marketer, potential customer. You’ll get not just one opinion, but a range of angles — and notice what isn’t visible from your own standpoint. Here’s a typical composite example from practice: our heroine evaluated the idea of online drawing courses from three perspectives. The investor warned about a saturated market, the marketer advised choosing a niche, and the “customer” admitted they would buy only if the result came quickly and was clearly visible. This is how the three-way analysis turned a vague idea into a specific one: not “courses for everyone”, but the niche of “drawing as stress relief”, with a promise of a fast, visible result. One technique saved months of likely mistakes.

Why do “different roles” work at all? Because each role has its own assumptions and its own blind spots. The investor looks at risks and return on investment, the marketer at demand and positioning, and the customer at “why do I need this, and what will I get?” On your own, like anyone else, you see a task from a single point of view; by asking for several roles, you simply switch on several “filters” and get a more three-dimensional picture. It isn’t magic—it’s a change of perspective, useful both on your own and with a colleague or alongside AI.

Technique 3. “The strict reviewer” — honest criticism. By default, the model is polite. If you want real feedback, give it the role of a strict but constructive editor and ask for specifics: what works (with examples), what is weak (with examples), what must be improved, and how. Also ask it not to praise you merely to be polite. Three rounds like this, and the text is usually a whole level above the first version.

Technique 4. “A model example”. Show the model an example of what you want: “Here’s a post I like. Write something similar on topic X, keeping the tone, structure, and style, but changing the content.” An example works better than a

description: the model has something to work from, and it captures the style more accurately.

Technique 5. “Iterative improvement”. Don’t expect perfection on the first try. One prompt → result → “make it more emotional” → “add a statistic” → “strengthen the call to action” → “now that’s good”. Each iteration is a step towards the goal, and this way you use the model as a living editor rather than an oracle that has the final word.

Bonus: “role + anti-role”. Add both who it should be *and* what it should avoid: “You’re an experienced teacher, but not a boring one; explain things simply and playfully”, “You’re a marketer, but not an aggressive salesperson—sell through value.” This small addition noticeably tunes the tone.

But the most important thing is verification. And here’s how to do it

Since “mastery” has been promised honestly, let me say this plainly: **the most important skill in communicating with AI is checking.** The model does not lie deliberately, but it can be confidently wrong—especially when the topic is broad or the data is recent. So:

- **Know what to check.** Figures, dates, names, “research has shown…”—anything where the fact matters to a decision—is a factual claim, and should be checked against a source.
- **Ask it to show the source.** Where appropriate, add to your prompt: “cite the source if you rely on data” or “if the figure is disputed, say so”. This will encourage the model to formulate things more carefully and give you a lead for verification.
- **Check against a live source.** For anything important, open a reliable source yourself and compare. For anything time-sensitive, use a search engine and recent publications.
- **Use “check yourself”.** A good technique is to ask after the answer: “recheck your answer for contradictions and common errors; if you’re unsure, clearly flag it”. This is not a guarantee, but it is a good filter for major mistakes.
- **Distinguish “knowledge” from “freshness”.** The model knows the world through its training data, and that data is always “dated up to a certain point”. If your question is about something that has just happened, don’t expect it to report accurately; you need a live search for that.

Verification is not distrust, but a working habit. You follow it not because AI is

“bad”, but because it *does not directly feel responsible for a fact*, while you do. Good questions keep you safe here too: for disputed stories in this book, cautious wording and clearly marked composite examples are used.

Practical exercise

Choose one technique and apply it to a real task right now: for something complex—“break it down and show the steps”; for analysis—“different roles”; for a text—“the strict reviewer”; for style—“a model example”; for polishing —“iterate”. Compare it with your usual approach and remember what works for you personally.

Don’t try to introduce all five techniques at once—that’s a fast track to overload. Choose one, make it easy to use, then add the next. Mastery, like a habit, grows one step at a time, not in a single leap. And remember: these techniques are not rituals that require you to “ask correctly”, but tools for reaching your goal faster and checking it more easily. If a technique does not help in a particular case, drop it and try another.

3.4. A four-week plan: from first steps to confidence

Knowing the techniques is not enough—you need a system, or your enthusiasm will fade within a week. Here is a realistic month-long plan. It is not about “becoming a genius”, but about making useful habits stick.

Week 1 — experiment

The first week is usually the most “expensive” in terms of resolve and the easiest in terms of results: any prompt, however clumsy, is impressive the first time. That very effect helps draw you in.

The goal is to get acquainted with AI without fear. For the first few days, just play: ask any questions, try unfamiliar topics (“explain quantum physics to a child”), and see what happens. Then take three simple everyday tasks (an email, a week’s shopping list, ideas for a post) and write a prompt for each using the six points. On the fifth to seventh day, return to your prompts and write down what worked, where the formula delivered the most, and what mistakes you made. This is your personal knowledge base.

Week 2 — apply it at work

Choose one recurring task (emails, reports, presentations, social media content) and create a good one-off prompt template for it. Use it three times in a row and

pay attention. At the end of the week, collect your best prompts in a library—a note on your phone, a document, or a file: “My prompts: for emails / for reports / for presentations”. The goal is to create your own set of tools ready for reuse.

Week 3 — take on the difficult tasks

Work on tasks where you need not simply to “generate” something, but to think. Creative tasks—idea generation, scripts, strategies: try the “different roles” technique. Analytical tasks—evaluating an idea, budget planning, competitor analysis: use “break it down and show the steps”, and always check the reasoning and figures. The goal is to stop being afraid of big tasks: with the model as a thinking partner, they become manageable, as long as you keep the final check and decision for yourself.

Week 4 — share and systematize

Teaching others reinforces knowledge better than anything else. Show the formula to one person—a colleague, friend, or relative—and help them create their first prompt. At the same time, gather all your prompts, sort them into categories, and write your own checklist: before each prompt—

- ☐ the goal is clear;
- ☐ the context is provided;
- ☐ the constraints are specified;
- ☐ the quality criteria are stated;
- ☐ the format is clarified;
- ☐ I will check the result where needed.

In a month, you will not be the person you were at the beginning: routine tasks will become faster, difficult tasks more manageable, and the formula will become as natural as breathing.

What will realistically happen in a month (and what will not)

I’ll set expectations honestly, so disappointment does not kill your enthusiasm.

You will have: noticeably faster routine work; the fear of “opening a chatbot and not knowing what to ask” will disappear; you will develop the habit of thinking about the goal first and typing afterward; complex texts and plans will come together faster; you will begin to notice where AI helps and where it does more harm, and you will make deliberate choices.

You will not have: a miracle where everything gets written “by itself” and for free without any effort from you. The quality of the result will still depend on the quality of the task and your review. The learning curve is not straight: sometimes one task works out immediately, while another takes several iterations. That is normal—that is what practice is.

And most importantly: in a month, you will not have “become an AI genius”—you will still be an ordinary person who calmly uses a useful tool and is not afraid of it. That is what a mature position looks like.

Frequently asked questions

“What if I can’t do it?” You can. The formula is simple, and you already know more than you think. Start small, try every day—the results will come.

“How long does it take to master?” Honestly: the first results come on the first day, the basics take a month, confidence takes several months of practice, and genuine “intuition” takes a year. Not because it is difficult, but because, as with any skill, repetition matters.

“What if I forget the formula?” Save it: on a sticky note, in your notes, or on your wallpaper. The goal is context, constraints, format, criteria, and checking. In a week, it will become automatic.

“Won’t AI start ‘doing everything by itself’?” No—and that is good news. AI is excellent at producing drafts and options and taking routine work off your hands, but direction, taste, responsibility, and the final decision remain yours. Someone who works this way does not become “redundant” but more valuable: they spend their energy not on preliminary busywork, but on what machines cannot do—understanding the task, making choices, checking the result, and applying human intuition. This is not replacing you; it is freeing you.

“What if the answer is wrong?” It happens—and we spoke about it honestly in 3.3. That is why the habit of checking important information is an integral part of using AI, not an optional extra. The more consequential the decision, the more carefully you should verify it.

“Who could this even be useful for? I don’t have a technical background.” You. Much of the value AI offers today is not about code, but about text, analysis, ideas, planning, learning, and organization. Technical jargon is not needed here: what you need is a clear goal, good context, and the habit of checking. These are all human skills, not programming skills.

“What if this is too difficult / I’m not ‘forward-thinking’?” Start with the smallest thing: one prompt, one simple task, one day. No one expects instant mastery. A small but real success on the very first day is the best motivator, and after that, things become easier.

The most important points from Chapter 3

You now have: an honest framework for a strong prompt (goal, context, constraints, criteria, format, and checking); three vivid examples of how it works in real life; five advanced techniques without a “magical chain of thought”— instead, a transparent, verifiable analysis and your own review; and a clear four-week plan. That is enough to get started. Practice will take care of the rest.

On to Chapter 4

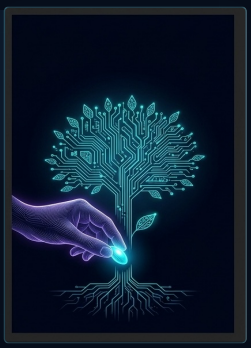
You have learned to *use* AI for tasks. But there is a more interesting question ahead: can you use it to *create* something of your own— a business, a project, a dream? Yes, you can, and many people are already doing so. Chapter 4 is about those who built something with AI, from scratch and with heart. Their approach will inspire you and give you concrete steps. The continuation is dedicated to Chapter 4.

See you on the next page.

Sending you a hug. You are not the same person you were twenty pages ago: you can see invisible companions, understand how they “think,” and are learning to speak with them in a language where intonation means goal and context. Don’t be stingy with knowledge—share it with one person, and help it grow.

CHAPTER 4. CREATION—AI ENTREPRENEURSHIP WITH HEART

> ***AI does not replace a woman entrepreneur. It can free up her time for decisions that require responsibility, taste, and human involvement.***



4.1. The Night of Despair

When it feels as though everything is over, you can start testing hypotheses

Below is a **composite example**, not a documentary account or a promise of results.

Novosibirsk, 23:47. A February night. Outside the window, there is frost, while Anna Petrova's apartment is cold from the figures on her laptop screen. For the third month in a row, her small online shop selling eco-friendly cosmetics is running at a loss. Product descriptions, replies to customers, posts, newsletters, advertising, analytics, purchasing, and bookkeeping have merged into one endless working day.

Anna is thirty-two. Two years ago, she left the office and invested her savings in her own business. She wanted to choose the products herself, communicate with customers, work from home, and gradually grow. Instead, she ended up with a seven-day-a-week routine and the feeling that she had become a hostage to her business.

She looks at the spreadsheet and thinks: "Maybe I should close the shop? Maybe I should go back to the office? Maybe entrepreneurship is not for me?"

Many people are familiar with such a point. AI does not eliminate losses, make decisions for you, or turn a difficult market into an easy game. But it can help break overloaded work down into small tasks—and start with the one where the risk of error can be controlled.

The first experiment

The next day, a fellow woman entrepreneur advises Anna to try a text-based AI. Not as a “magic button,” but as a drafting assistant.

Anna chooses a task: preparing descriptions for ten creams. In advance, she gathers verified information about the ingredients, purpose, and limitations of each product. In the prompt, she separately writes: do not invent properties, do not promise therapeutic effects, and flag anything that needs to be checked manually.

```
Ты — редактор карточек товаров для интернет-магазина натуральной косметики.

Контекст: моя аудитория — женщины 25–40 лет, которым важны состав,
честность и бережный уход. Ниже я дам только подтверждённые сведения
о продукте.

Задача: подготовь черновик описания крема на 100–150 слов.
Не придумывай ингредиенты, сертификаты, медицинские свойства и результаты.
Не используй гарантии. Если данных не хватает, поставь пометку [УТОЧНИТЬ].

Формат: назначение, ключевые компоненты только из исходных данных,
способ применения по инструкции производителя, ограничения, спокойный
призыв изучить товар. После текста перечисли факты, которые нужно
сверить с упаковкой и документами.
```

A few minutes later, she has not a finished publication, but a convenient first draft. Anna checks it against the label and the documents, removes unnecessary promises, and rewrites the phrases in her own voice. The work really does take less time, but the result appeared not because AI “knows everything,” but because she had source data and a clear review process.

This is the safe starting point: do not hand over your entire business to the system. Choose one recurring operation, define quality criteria, and keep the final decision for yourself.

What you can test in a week

Next, Anna—in the same **composite example**—tests one task a day:

- a content plan becomes a set of rough ideas, which she checks for consistency with the brand;
- answers to frequently asked questions are collected in a template library, while disputed cases remain with a human;
- client reviews are grouped by topic, and the conclusions are compared with the original messages;

- instructions for her assistant are formatted as a checklist and then tested on a real task;
- advertising copy variants are compared with a small audience only after the platform rules and legislation have been checked.

Any figures in this scenario are a **hypothetical illustration**, not statistics. In one business, a draft may save an hour; in another, it may take just as long to review. That is why it is useful to keep a simple log:

1. how long the task took before the experiment;
2. how long the prompt and editing took;
3. how many errors were found during the review;
4. what improved and what got worse;
5. whether the process can be repeated without risk to the client, the brand, or the law.

After a week, you will not necessarily have “a partner who works around the clock.” But you will have a set of observations. You will see where AI helps, where it gets in the way, and where you need a different tool or a specialist.

Lessons from this story

Lesson 1. Do not start with a dream of scaling; start with a task you can test. A product description, sorting notes, a draft email, or the structure of an instruction manual are better choices than financial decisions and legal conclusions.

Lesson 2. AI is not a source of truth. It can be confidently wrong, mix up facts, attribute nonexistent properties to a product, and repeat biases found in its data. Any text about money, health, safety, children, personal data, or the law requires additional verification.

Lesson 3. Saving time does not equal increasing profit. The hours you free up can be directed toward talking with clients, improving the product, or resting. But sales depend on demand, price, quality, trust, and many external conditions.

Lesson 4. The decisions remain yours. AI suggests options. You decide what to publish, whom to reply to, whom to sign a contract with, and what level of risk is acceptable.

Your story may begin not with a big launch, but with one careful experiment.

4.2. Stories of women and men entrepreneurs

How to explore an idea with AI without a major investment

The following three stories are **composite examples**, assembled from typical small-business situations. The names, timelines, amounts, and figures here do not represent verified real-life cases. Their purpose is to show the thought process, not to promise that you will achieve the same result.

Story 1. Dmitry and an online programming school

Dmitry is a programmer who wants to teach children to create games. He knows the subject, but is not confident about teaching methods, marketing, or class organization. Instead of asking, “Make me a business plan,” he asks AI to help compile a list of hypotheses:

```
Помоги исследовать идею онлайн-занятий по программированию для детей 10–14 лет.

Раздели работу на гипотезы о потребности родителей, формате занятий,
программе, цене, каналах поиска первых учениц и рисках. Для каждого пункта
укажи, что можно проверить разговором, небольшим прототипом или открытыми
источниками. Не выдавай предположения за факты и не называй идею
перспективной без данных.
```

AI suggests a trial-lesson structure, questions for interviews with parents, and several options for a minimum viable product. Dmitry tests them in conversations, clarifies age restrictions, parental consent, and the rules for handling children’s data. He conducts one trial lesson, gathers feedback, and only then decides whether it is worth continuing.

Practical takeaway: AI can speed up the preparation of questions, lesson plans, and drafts, but it does not confirm demand. Demand is validated through real conversations, observation, and voluntary tests—not through a polished fifteen-page document.

Story 2. Elena and consulting for small businesses

Elena worked as an accountant for many years and began to take an interest in automation. She feels that she could advise small companies on implementing AI. That is not a reason to quit her job immediately. First, she outlines the boundaries of her expertise and asks the system to help formulate a safe

offering:

```
Помоги сформулировать услугу по аудиту рабочих процессов малого бизнеса.

Мои подтверждённые навыки: [список]. Я не оказываю юридические,
налоговые и медицинские консультации. Предложи: результат услуги,
что входит и не входит в работу, какие данные нужны, как запросить
согласие, какие риски предупредить и какие вопросы задать клиентке.
Не придумывай отзывы, сертификаты и результаты.
```

Elena begins by auditing one anonymised process—for example, preparing an internal guide. She does not upload invoices, passport details, correspondence or client lists to a public chat. Before sharing any material, she removes names and contact details, checks the storage settings and clarifies the service terms. She cross-checks all recommendations with specialists whenever taxes, law, security or contracts are involved.

Practical takeaway: the value of a consultation is not that you opened a chat. It lies in being able to understand the task, see the constraints, explain the risks and turn the solution into a working process.

Story 3. Andrey and the content studio

Andrey writes copy and wants to take on more projects. AI helps him create structural options and drafts, but Andrey remains the editor. His process includes several mandatory stages:

1. the client provides the brief and confirms the right to use the materials;
2. Andrey clarifies the audience, objective, facts and quality criteria;
3. AI creates several draft versions;
4. Andrey checks the facts, style, accessibility and absence of plagiarism;
5. the client approves the final copy;
6. the materials are stored with restricted access and deleted after the agreed period.

Figures such as “five times faster”, “forty-seven regular clients” or a specific monthly revenue in stories like these should be treated as **conditional illustrations**. Actual timelines and economics depend on the niche, experience, service quality, expenses, taxes, contracts and the ability to find clients. Don’t lower your price simply because the draft was prepared faster: the price also includes research, editing, responsibility and communication.

What these scenarios have in common

Not a promised result, but a working approach:

- start with a narrow task and a minimal prototype;
- separate facts from assumptions;
- talk to real clients before investing;
- count not only revenue, but also expenses, time, refunds and the cost of mistakes;
- keep a person involved in decision-making;
- gradually improve the process based on feedback.

AI can act as an editor, an analytical thinking partner, a generator of options and a documentation assistant. It is not automatically a consultant, a team, a lawyer, an accountant or a guarantee of free work. Even a paid plan does not make its answers accurate or give you the right to upload any information you like.

4.3. Tools for business

What you can entrust to AI and what you should not hand over without checking

It is useful to divide tasks into three levels.

Low risk: draft headlines, structural options, question ideas, turning your own notes into a list, and checking the clarity of a text. Editing is still needed here, but an error can usually be corrected before publication.

Medium risk: emails to clients, product descriptions, review analysis, audience segmentation, instructions for employees, and advertising hypotheses. Fact-checking, tone approval, testing and control over data access are required.

High risk: financial decisions, medical and legal recommendations, hiring or rejecting a candidate, creditworthiness assessments, work involving children, personal data and sensitive information. AI can help compile a list of questions, but the decision and the review must belong to a qualified person.

1. Content marketing

Product card draft

```
Ты — редактор карточек товара. Используй только сведения из блока «Факты».
Не добавляй лечебных свойств, сертификатов, отзывов и гарантий.
Если данных не хватает, напиши [УТОЧНИТЬ].
Сделай: заголовок, краткое описание, характеристики, способ применения
по инструкции и список вопросов для проверки.
Факты: [вставь проверенные данные]
```

Publication ideas

```
Предложи 12 тем для публикаций о [продукте] для [аудитория].
Раздели их на обучение, ответы на вопросы, закулисье и обратную связь.
Не используй страх, ложную срочность и неподтверждённые обещания.
Для каждой темы добавь вопрос, который стоит проверить у аудитории.
```

Letter

```
Подготовь черновик письма о [событие].
Тон — ясный и уважительный. Не создавай дефицит искусственно,
не обещай результат и не маскируй рекламу под нейтральную рекомендацию.
Добавь понятный способ отказаться от рассылки и места для проверки фактов.
```

AI can speed up the first draft, but it does not automatically know whether the subscriber has agreed to receive the newsletter, whether the text complies with the law, or whether every figure is accurate.

2. Customer support

Ask AI to group frequently asked questions based on your anonymized inquiries. Remove names, phone numbers, addresses, order numbers, and any other information that could identify a specific customer. Then create a library of responses:

```
Сгруппируй эти обезличенные вопросы по темам.
Для каждой темы предложи шаблон ответа: признать вопрос,
дать только подтверждённую информацию, указать следующий шаг
и отметить, когда нужно передать обращение сотруднице.
Не придумывай правила возврата и сроки доставки.
Материал: [обезличенные обращения]
```

The chatbot must not independently promise refunds, modify orders, disclose data, or respond to complaints about harm to health. Set up escalation: uncertainty, conflict, an unusual situation, a legal threat, or a sensitive topic — immediately hand it over to a human.

3. Research and strategy

AI is useful as a thinking partner for questions, not as a substitute for research:

```
Вот мои наблюдения о рынке [ниша] и список источников [ссылки/заметки].
Раздели выводы на факты, интерпретации и гипотезы.
Укажи, какие данные устарели или требуют независимой проверки.
Предложи пять способов проверить каждую важную гипотезу с небольшим риском.
```

Do not ask the system to “study the internet” without verifying its sources. It may not have access to up-to-date data, misquote a source, or invent a link. Check the dates, original sources, calculation methodology, and applicability to your region.

For pricing, you can develop three scenarios—minimum, baseline, and expanded. Use your actual costs, fees, taxes, delivery expenses, time, and returns. The AI’s answer is a planning model for discussion, not the correct price.

4. Sales Without False Promises

Ask it to create several versions, but remove the requirement to “increase sales by 30–50%” from the prompt. That percentage is a **conditional illustration** unless it is confirmed by your own measurements.

```
Сделай три варианта страницы услуги [описание].
Покажи проблему, способ работы, ограничения, цену или место для цены,
условия отмены и кому услуга не подходит. Не обещай гарантированный доход,
продажи, экономию или конкретный результат. Отдели подтверждённые факты
от предположений и оставь пометки для проверки.
```

The conversation script should help you listen, not pressure the client. Include questions about the project, budget, and timeline, but give her the option to decline. Do not use personalization obtained without consent, and do not copy someone else’s text or branded wording.

5. Operational efficiency

```
Опиши мой процесс [процесс] в виде этапов.
Найди повторяющиеся действия и возможные узкие места.
Для каждого предложи: оставить как есть, упростить, автоматизировать
или передать человеку. Укажи риск ошибки, необходимые проверки,
доступы и план отката, если автоматизация сработает неправильно.
```

You can ask the employee to turn the instructions into a checklist, but test it on someone who was not involved in writing them. If they are unclear, the problem is not with the employee but with the document.

Illustrative example of time tracking

Suppose you spend 30 hours a week on three recurring tasks. After setting up the process, that falls to 18 hours, but four hours go toward checking and maintenance. The net time freed up is 8 hours, not the advertised “22 hours.”

This is not a forecast but an **illustrative example** of the method. Count these separately:

- time spent preparing the source data;
- generation time;
- editing and fact-checking;
- correcting errors;
- team training;
- the cost of the service and integrations;
- potential losses caused by an incorrect answer.

Only then decide whether the process has actually become more efficient.

Practical exercise

Choose three tasks in your business or future business idea:

1. one routine task;
2. one creative task;
3. one analytical task.

For each one, record the initial time, the risk of error, and the quality criterion. Write a prompt, generate a draft, check it, time the process, and compare the result. Do not upload confidential information. After a week, ask yourself:

- where did things get faster;
- where did quality stay the same or deteriorate;
- which checks cannot be removed;
- what can be repeated and what needs to remain manual;
- what next small experiment will provide the most information.

4.4. Business launch plan

From idea to testing your first sales in 30 days

Thirty days is neither a launch promise nor a universal timeframe. It is an **illustrative example** of the pace of experimentation. A regulated industry, a complex product, or a manufacturing business will require more time. The plan's goal is not to "reach revenue at any cost," but to understand whether the idea shows signs of demand and what the risks are.

Week 1. Idea and validation

Days 1–2. Inventory. Write down your skills, experience, available resources, time and budget constraints, and the topics that genuinely interest you. Ask AI to suggest options, but evaluate them based on your access to customers, complexity, legal requirements, and the cost of making a mistake.

```
На основе моих навыков [список] и ресурсов [список] предложи идеи.
Для каждой укажи предполагаемую проблему клиентки, способ проверить спрос,
необходимые компетенции, риски, ограничения и то, чего ты не можешь знать
без интервью и исследования. Не называй идею прибыльной без данных.
```

Days 3–5. Conversations and sources. Prepare questions for five to ten potential clients. Ask about past experience and the actual problem, not only whether she "would buy it." Do not record a conversation without consent. Study public sources, competitors' offers, and mandatory requirements for the activity.

Days 6–7. The model. Describe who benefits, who pays, exactly what you offer, which channel you use to find a client, what expenses you incur, and which metric you will check first. Separate facts, assumptions, and questions.

The result of the week is not a "validated idea," but a list of verified observations and unresolved questions.

Week 2. Minimum viable product

Days 8–10. MVP. Define the smallest version of the product that allows you to test one key hypothesis. For a course, this could be one live lesson and a feedback form; for a shop—a limited selection of products with clear terms; for a service—a description of the process and one trial format.

Do not promise the client something that does not yet exist. Do not collect prepayment if you have not described the timeline, refund policy, result, and limitations. For work involving children, health, finances, or sensitive data, obtain specialist advice in advance.

Days 11–14. Materials. AI can help with the landing-page copy, instructions, interview questions, and several headline options. Check every claim, buy or create images with clear usage rights, and check font and music licences. Do not use other people’s photographs, testimonials, logos, or texts without permission.

The result of the week is a prototype that you can show to a small group, not perfect packaging.

Week 3. Testing the offer

Days 15–17. Channels. Choose one or two channels where your intended audience is already present. Prepare a calm message without spam, false urgency, or income promises. Respect the group’s rules and people’s right not to reply.

Days 18–21. First responses. The goal is not necessarily to achieve a certain number of purchases. The goal is to understand who responds, what question they ask, what prevents them from deciding, and whether the proposed price matches the value. Count all expenses: advertising, fees, delivery, your time, refunds, and taxes.

After each conversation, record the agreed-upon data, not personal details you do not need. For mailings and advertising, check consent requirements and the platform’s rules.

Week 4. Feedback and decision

Days 22–25. Analysis. Give AI only anonymised notes and ask it to divide them into recurring signals, one-off opinions, and questions for further research. Do not allow a statistically significant conclusion to emerge from five messages.

Days 26–28. Improvements. Change one or two things: the wording, sequence, format, price, or instructions. Do not change everything at once, or you will not understand the cause of the result.

Days 29–30. Decision. Choose one of the following: continue the small-scale test, change the hypothesis, put the idea on hold, or abandon it. Abandoning an idea is not failure; it is a saving of resources if you learn this before making major investments.

Illustrative example

Imagine Svetlana, who wants to offer space-organisation consulting. Over the course of a month, she has several conversations, prepares one checklist, tests a consultation, and discovers that her clients care less about “perfect order” than about a clear storage plan for a small apartment. She refines the service and tests the price once more.

Any figures such as “15 clients,” “67,500 roubles per month,” “paid for itself in a week,” or “280,000 roubles after three months” would be **an illustrative example**, not a promise. Even a real result achieved by one entrepreneur cannot be transferred to another: audience, season, reputation, expenses, taxes, and circumstances differ.

Mini-checklist before any launch

- I know what problem I am solving and what supports this conclusion.
- I distinguish my own data from AI-generated assumptions.
- I have calculated the full cost and the acceptable budget for the experiment.
- I have clear terms for payment, refunds, timelines, and support.
- I have checked the legal requirements and mandatory warnings.
- I use only materials for which I have the rights.
- I do not pass unnecessary personal or commercial data to the model.
- I know who will review disputed text and who will make the final decision.
- I understand how to stop the automation and restore the manual process.
- I have defined in advance what result will make me continue, change the plan, or stop.

The key points of Chapter 4

You have travelled from an overloaded idea to a careful plan of experiments. Now you know:

- how to start with one recurring task;
- why a composite story cannot replace market testing;
- how to use AI for drafts, analysis, and instructions;
- where fact-checking, privacy, copyright, and human oversight are needed;
- how to test an idea in small steps and calculate the full cost;

- why neither AI nor a thirty-day calendar guarantees income, sales, or a launch.

Business is not only about money and efficiency. It is also about responsibility towards your clients, team, and yourself. A good decision sometimes means not speeding up the process, but stopping it, asking an additional question, bringing in a specialist, or acknowledging that there is not enough data yet.

AI can help you create—but you set the direction, boundaries, and meaning.

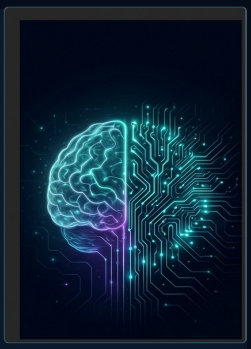
A transition to creativity

But what about soul, creativity, and art? Can AI help not only with exploring business, but also with inventing, composing, drawing, and learning something new?

Yes, it can—if you remember your own taste, creators' rights, people's consent, and the need for human work. In the next chapter, we will talk about creativity: how to turn curiosity into practice and preserve your own voice in the work you create.

You have already taken an important step: you did not believe in a magic button, but learned to ask questions, check answers, and choose consciously. This is what creating with AI means.

CHAPTER 5. CREATIVITY—WHEN EVERYONE BECOMES AN ARTIST



A few words before we begin. *This entire chapter is written to be warm, practical, and honest for you.*

- *All the stories of people here are* ***composite, hypothetical examples****. The names (Maria, Alexey, Svetlana, Dmitry, Anna, and others), cities, galleries, and income figures are invented to make the story vivid, and illustrate a possible path rather than real biographies.*
- *This chapter contains no unverified statistics: the stories and results are deliberately presented as* ***composite examples****, not as scientific evidence.*
- *The section on creativity and emotional wellbeing is written with care. Creating with AI is* ***not treatment*** *and* ***not a replacement for*** *professional help. If you notice persistent sadness, anxiety, insomnia, or other symptoms that interfere with your life, please consult a doctor or psychologist.*
- *At the end of Section 5.3, there is a section on copyright and the licences of generative services. Before publishing or selling anything created with AI, be sure to read the rules of the specific service.*

“AI took care of the technique, making room for what matters most — the soul, ideas, and emotions.”

In the past, to call yourself an artist, musician, or writer, you had to spend years learning the craft. Talent seemed like a gift reserved for the chosen few. Today, the tool that helps bring your ideas to life is right in front of you. And this changes not only *how* we create, but also *who* we can become.

Let’s begin with a story that sounds almost like a fairy tale. But remember: this is just one of thousands of possible paths, shown as an example.

5.1 The Mathematics Teacher Who Became an Artist

When a Dream Meets Technology

Example (composite): a Moscow contemporary art gallery, spring 2024. An opening reception, people in evening wear, glasses, quiet music. On the wall hangs a bright, vibrant painting: a sunset over the sea, like a dream or a warm memory, with colors flowing into one another, somewhere between reality and fantasy. The viewers cannot tear themselves away. Someone is quietly crying: “It’s so beautiful…”

A young critic takes notes: “Interesting technique. Clearly a professional. Ten or fifteen years of experience, at least.”

An elderly lady approaches the curator: “Who is the artist? I want to buy this work.”

The curator smiles: “Maria Petrova.”

“And who is she? A well-known artist? Why have I never heard of her?”

“No. She’s a mathematics teacher from Tula. Thirty-eight years old. She’s never held a paintbrush in her life.”

Silence. The lady looks at the curator, then at the painting, then back at the curator: “How… is that… possible?”

Maria’s Story

Let’s go back a year. Tula, an ordinary school, a mathematics classroom. Maria Petrova, 38. Every day — lessons, exercise books, tests. Fifteen years of the same routine. A good, stable job, and she loves the children. But her soul was asking for something more.

Maria had always dreamed of drawing. Since childhood, she had looked at paintings in museums and wondered: “How do they do it? How do they create such beauty?” She tried — once, twice, ten times. She picked up a brush, and it turned out… badly. Very badly. “I have no talent,” she decided. “It’s not for me. I’ll leave it to the professionals.” Her dream died, buried beneath the weight of reality.

But in March 2024, everything changed.

Discovering Midjourney

A colleague showed her an article in the staff room: “A neural network creates paintings from descriptions.” Maria smiled skeptically: “An AI artist? Sure, of course.” But curiosity won. That evening at home, she opened Midjourney.

She stared at the empty input field. She wondered: “What am I even supposed to write?” She remembered her old dream — a sunset over the sea that she had always wanted to paint. Hesitantly, she wrote:

> *Sunset over the sea*

She pressed Enter. She saw it. The neural network had drawn a sunset. An ordinary one. Beautiful, but... ordinary.

Maria thought: “What if I describe it in more detail? The way I see it in my dreams?” She tried again:

> *Sunset over a calm sea, in the style of Impressionism, warm golden and pink tones, soft light, a romantic, serene mood, like a childhood memory*

She pressed the button. And a miracle happened.

Tears of Joy

Maria stared at the screen and cried. This was IT. What she had seen in her imagination but could not express with a brush. Her sunset. Her dream. Her soul. The AI had drawn what she felt.

“Oh my God,” she whispered through her tears. “I... I created this. I did!”

Not the robot. Her. The robot had only carried it out. The idea, the feeling, the vision — those were hers.

The First Night of Creating

That night, Maria stayed awake until four in the morning. She created, and created, and created. Each prompt became a new painting:

- “A lonely tree on a hill, autumn, a melancholic mood...”
- “A spaceship above an alien forest, science fiction...”
- “A girl with a balloon, the joy of childhood...”

Twenty paintings in one night. Each one — a piece of her soul, her dreams, her feelings. In the morning, she looked at her “gallery” on the screen and smiled: “I’m an artist. At last.”

The Road to the Gallery

Over the following months, Maria learned, experimented, and grew:

- **Month 1.** Created for herself. Learned to put her vision into words.
- **Month 2.** Showed her work to friends. Everyone was shocked: “You created this?!”
- **Month 3.** Created a social media account and posted her 10 best works.
- **Month 4.** She had 500 followers. People were writing: “Do you sell them?”
- **Month 5.** First sale — a print.
- **Month 6.** A gallery curator discovered her on social media and offered her an exhibition.
- **Month 12.** An opening in Moscow. Her works hang alongside those of professional artists.

From mathematics teacher to gallery artist — in one year.

Note: the time frames and figures here are a conditional, composite example, not a promise. Everyone’s journey unfolds differently, and that’s normal.

What changed in Maria’s life?

She still teaches and loves her work. But now she has another life as well:

- creates art every evening;
- shares her work (and sometimes sells it);
- has an additional source of income;
- takes part in exhibitions;
- is genuinely happy. “AI didn’t make me an artist,” Maria says. “It only removed the barrier. Technique no longer gets in the way of expressing what’s inside me. Before, my dream was locked behind a wall marked ‘ten years of learning to draw.’ AI removed that wall. Now, between my dream and reality, there’s only my imagination.”

The number of people trying creative AI tools is clearly growing — you can see it

in the spread of the services themselves and the communities around them. But the exact growth rate depends on the country, platform, and method of calculation, so the important thing here is not the number but the observable trend: the barrier to entry into creative work has become lower.

What's the secret?

Many people say: "But you're not the one drawing! The robot is!" But is that really so?

The artist's path used to look like this:

1. Come up with an idea (creativity).
2. Study technique for years (mechanics).
3. Bring it to life on canvas (execution).

Now with AI:

1. You come up with the idea (**YOU — creativity**).
2. You put your vision into words (**YOU — skill!**).
3. AI brings it to life (mechanics).
4. You choose the best version and edit it (**YOU — taste**).

You take part in most of the process. AI is like a paintbrush. A very intelligent paintbrush. An artist is not someone who owns a brush. An artist is someone who has something to say. And AI gives a voice to those who have something to say but lack the technical skills.

The Democratization of Creativity

Do you understand what's happening? AI is making art accessible to everyone.

In the past, creativity seemed to be for the chosen few:

- those with talent;
- those with time to learn;
- those with the money for an education.

Now it's for everyone. You have an idea, a feeling, a vision. That's enough to begin, and AI will help bring it to life.

But it’s important to understand, without illusions: democratization does not eliminate mastery. Professional artists, musicians, and writers who have spent years refining their craft remain masters — their concepts are deeper, their taste more refined, their experience richer. AI does not “replace” art or devalue it. It expands the circle of those who can engage with it and creates new opportunities for both professionals and beginners. Beginners and masters can now work with the same tools — but the result still depends on what lies within the creator.

A little masterclass: how to formulate a vision

A good request (prompt) is your new skill. The more precisely you describe something, the closer the result will be to your vision. Try to keep four layers in mind:

1. **What** is depicted (subject): “a sunset over the sea,” “a lone tree,” “a girl with a balloon.”
2. **What** it looks like (style): “impressionism,” “watercolour,” “cyberpunk.”
3. **What** feeling it evokes (mood): “serenity,” “melancholy,” “childlike joy.”
4. **Details** that make the image come alive: light, colours, time of day, texture.

And most importantly—describe not only what you see, but also what you *feel*. Instead of “a sunset over the sea,” write: “a sunset over a calm sea, warm golden and pink tones, soft light, a romantic, serene mood, like a childhood memory.” Emotion is what turns an image into art.

Remember: a prompt is not a command but a dialogue. The first result is rarely perfect. Clarify, ask follow-up questions, try different options. Your taste and your revisions are your artistic signature.

What’s next?

Maria is not an exception. There are thousands of stories like hers. A teacher became an artist. A programmer became a musician. A homemaker became a writer. AI has opened the door to creativity for many people.

In the next subsection—stories of people who found themselves in music, literature, and design. People who create, share, and find happiness. Perhaps one of these stories is yours?

5.2 Music, literature, design

Three stories of creative awakening

Story 1. Alexey—the programmer who became a composer

Composite example: Yekaterinburg. Alexey Ivanov, 35. A programmer at an ordinary IT company: 9:00–18:00, code, bugs, deadlines. He lives alone; work-home-work, takeaway meals, TV series in the evenings. “I feel like life is passing me by,” he admitted to himself. But his soul longed for more.

Alexey had always loved music. Since childhood, his mother had played the piano— Chopin, Tchaikovsky. He listened, spellbound, and dreamed of learning. But lessons were expensive, there was no time, and “at 35, it’s too late to start”—that was what he thought. The dream remained locked away.

Discovering AIVA. January 2024. A colleague at lunch said: “There’s an AI that creates music. AIVA. You describe it in words—and it writes a melody.” Alexey was sceptical: “A robot composer? Like a production line.” “Give it a try. There’s a free version.” That evening, out of curiosity, he went to the website, remembered his childhood—his mother’s pies, the warm lamplight, the cosiness—and wrote:

> *A calm piano melody, slow, evoking memories of childhood, warm, slightly sad but bright*

He clicked Generate. Music began to play, and Alexey burst into tears. It was HIS music—the music he had always heard inside himself. “I... I created this. This is my music. For the first time in my life.”

A year later, Alexey has tracks on streaming platforms, a growing number of plays, and income from streaming and podcast licences. But most importantly, he is happy: “AI didn’t make me a composer. It simply removed the barrier—years of study, expensive lessons, knowledge of musical notation. The music had always been inside me. AI simply gave it a way out.” His evenings are now filled with creativity, meaning, and joy.

Note: the income figures here are a hypothetical example, not a guarantee. Everyone’s path is different.

Music and creative practice can support your mood and provide a sense of

meaning, but this effect is individual. They are not treatment or a substitute for professional help in cases of anxiety, depression, or other serious conditions.

Story 2. Svetlana—the homemaker who became a writer

Composite example: Novosibirsk. Svetlana Petrova, 42. Married for 18 years, with three children. Her husband works late; she takes care of the home, the children, and the household. A never-ending cycle: breakfast, school, cleaning, cooking, homework, dinner. Svetlana did not complain: “I chose my family.” But sometimes, when everyone was asleep, she wondered: “Who am I besides a mother and a wife? Is there anything that is truly mine?”

Since her youth, she had wanted to write a novel—about love, about finding oneself. But: “Where would I get the talent? I’m just a homemaker…”

YandexGPT as a co-author. March 2024. Her daughter said over dinner: “Mum, we learned about AI at school—it can write texts!” That evening, when everyone had gone to bed, Svetlana timidly opened YandexGPT: “Help me start writing a book.” The AI responded with questions: “What is the book about? Who are the characters? What genre is it?” It felt like talking to an understanding friend.

The birth of a book. Over the next six months, Svetlana wrote for an hour every evening. The process:

1. She came up with the plot, characters, and twists.
2. YandexGPT helped with dialogue, descriptions, and editing.
3. She revised it and added soul.
4. Then AI again—checking the logic and style.
5. The final polishing was hers.

Six months later came the novel Between Home and Dream, two hundred pages about a woman who searches for herself without losing her family. She published it on LitRes, received reviews and messages saying “this is about me,” saw her income grow, and began writing a second book. “I had always been a writer,” she says. “I simply didn’t know how to express it. AI became a bridge between my soul and my readers.” Her husband is proud, and the children tell people at school: “My mum is a writer!” She found herself alongside her family, not instead of it.

Note: the download and income figures are hypothetical examples.

Story 3. Dmitry—the pensioner who makes films

Composite example: Saint Petersburg. Dmitry Andreyevich, 67. He worked as an engineer for forty years, then retired—and was left with emptiness. His children had grown up, his wife had died three years earlier, and his friends had moved away. Morning, afternoon, evening—the same cycle. “Can this really be all there is—just growing old in front of the television?”

His grandson and RunwayML. His grandson, a student, came to visit in the summer: “Grandad, look—RunwayML brings photos to life!” He uploaded an old photo of Saint Petersburg, and the AI made the clouds drift, the water ripple, and the people walk. Dmitry gasped: “Magic!” His grandson taught him the basics and left. Dmitry was left with thousands of his own photographs of the city.

He took an old photo of Nevsky Prospect from 1985—the AI brought it to life: the trams began moving, and people began walking. He added music through AIVA. The result was a short film, Nevsky: Then and Now. He uploaded it to YouTube “for himself”—and woke to 500 views and comments saying “how beautiful” and “nostalgia.” He made another. A year later, he had a channel called Saint Petersburg Through Dmitry Andreyevich’s Eyes, dozens of videos, thousands of subscribers, invitations to appear on television, and meetings with subscribers.

“You know what matters most?—Dmitry says. “Not the views. It’s having something to do. I wake up thinking: today I’ll make a new film! AI gave me back a sense of meaning and the joy of creating.” Messages from subscribers said: “Thank you for showing us our city! My grandmother cried when she recognised the streets of her youth…”

Note: the subscriber figures are a hypothetical example.

What do these three stories have in common?

Three people, three paths, three transformations. What they share:

- Ordinary people (not professionals, not prodigies).
- A dream + AI = an opportunity to express yourself.
- Creativity brings joy, and sometimes income.
- Age does not matter (from 35 to 67!).
- AI is a tool, not a replacement for the creator.

And one more important detail: our protagonists come from a wide range of

Russian cities. Creativity with AI is not tied to the capitals.

AI tools can make the first attempt at creating something easier: a draft, sketch, or musical outline comes together faster. But confidence, the quality of the work, and especially income are not guaranteed—they depend on practice, taste, audience, and the effort invested.

The Democratization of Creativity—Let's Take an Honest Look

Creativity once seemed reserved for the chosen few: talent, years of study, money for education. AI has broken down many barriers. Now all you need is:

- ideas
- feelings
- visions
- an AI tool

Technique? AI takes care of it. Years of training? Not essential. Money? There are free versions. But what remains most important is the SOUL. Yours. Unique. Priceless.

Creative tools really have shortened the path from an idea to a first sketch: today, you can make one in minutes. But a good result still requires time for conception, selection, editing, and developing your own taste.

Maybe the next story is yours?

What's next?

You've seen three stories: music, literature, and video. But which tools should you use? Where can you find them? How do you get started? The next subchapter is your arsenal. Specific names, prompts, and instructions. Ready to arm yourself?

5.3 Creative Tools

Your Arsenal of AI Tools + Ready-Made Prompts

Below is an overview of tools that were popular when this book was written. The industry is changing quickly: names, pricing plans, and capabilities are updated. Check the current information on each service's website. And be sure to read the

section on rights and licences below before publishing or selling the results.

Visual Art

Midjourney — for artistic work

- Creates: paintings, illustrations, concept art.
- Style: anything from realism to abstraction.
- Access: via Discord, subscription from $10/month (check the website).

Ready-made prompts (copy and adapt!):

> *Portrait of a woman in the style of the Renaissance, soft diffused light, warm golden tones, mysterious smile, detailed like an oil painting, an atmosphere of mystery*

> *Sunset over the sea, Impressionism, visible brushstrokes, warm pink and golden tones, romantic mood, like a childhood memory*

> *A futuristic city in space orbiting Jupiter, neon lights, flying cars, cyberpunk + art deco style, highly detailed, an atmosphere of an optimistic future*

Example (composite): Irina from Kazan created a series called “Russian Fairy Tales in Cyberpunk Style” and sold several prints. This is merely an illustration of where a bold, recognisable idea and regular work can lead, not a guarantee of income.

DALL·E 3 — by OpenAI

- Creates: realistic images.
- Plus: integrated into ChatGPT Plus ($20/month, check the website).
- Minus: often slightly less “artistic” than Midjourney.

Prompt for a book illustration:

> *Illustration for a children’s book: a kind dragon helps a little girl find her way home, watercolour style, soft pastel tones, an atmosphere of kindness*

> *and magic, for children aged 5–8*

Stable Diffusion — free!

- Plus: open source, free, and highly flexible.
- Minus: it needs to be installed and configured, making it more difficult for beginners.
- For: those who are ready to learn how it works.

Music and Audio

AIVA — classical music and soundtracks

- Creates: classical music, background music, and soundtracks.
- Access: a free version is available.
- Licence: check the website—free plans often restrict commercial use.

Example prompts:

> *Calm ambient music with nature sounds, slow, soothing, for relaxation, duration 10 minutes*

> *Romantic piano waltz, soft and bright, for a video about travel*

> *Piano melody, sad but bright, evoking memories, cinematic, like music from a film about love*

Soundraw — simple for beginners

Choose a genre, mood, and length—and AI creates the music! Check the licence for commercial use on the website as well.

Example (composite): a Moscow-based podcast uses similar tools for its intro music and saves money on a composer. An illustration, not a guarantee.

Literature and Texts

ChatGPT — a universal co-author

Prompts for different tasks:

> *You are an experienced screenwriter. Come up with a plot for a novel in the [genre] genre: protagonist [description], conflict [what], setting [where and when], an unexpected twist in the middle, and a touching ending*

> *Create a dialogue between [character 1] and [character 2]: situation [describe], emotions [which], [character 1] wants [goal], style—natural and lively, with subtext*

> *Describe [place] so that the reader feels [emotion]: details of the interior or natural surroundings, sounds, smells, light, metaphors for the atmosphere, 200–300 words*

YandexGPT — better at understanding Russian

- Understands the cultural context.
- Knows the realities of life in Russia.
- Understands the nuances of the Russian language.

Prompt:

> *Write a short story about [topic] in the style of Russian classical literature, with soul, depth, and Russian flavour*

Example (composite): Anton from Yaroslavl writes stories with the help of YandexGPT and publishes a collection. An illustration, not a guarantee.

Video and Animation

RunwayML — video-effects magic

- Animation of still photos.
- Background removal and replacement.
- Text-to-video generation.
- Improving the quality of old videos.

Prompt for animation:

> *Bring this photo to life: gentle movement of the clouds, the water rippling slightly, leaves swaying on the trees, natural and realistic*

Synthesia — AI avatars

For training videos and presentations: you write the text, choose an avatar, and it speaks your text. Check the licence for commercial use on the website.

Example (composite): an online school creates lessons with an AI teacher and saves money on filming. An illustration, not a guarantee.

Design and Graphics

Canva + AI

Canva now comes with an AI assistant: generating designs from descriptions, choosing colour palettes, and creating logos.

Prompt:

> *Logo for [business]: [minimalist/modern/classic] style, colours [which], associations [what it should evoke], for use on [where]*

⚠ Important: copyright and licences for generative services

Before publishing, offering for sale, or using anything created with AI in a commercial project, be sure to understand the rights involved. The rules of different services vary greatly and change over time. Here is what you should keep in mind:

1. **Read the specific service's licence.** The terms for commercial use vary: it may be allowed on paid plans, restricted in some cases, while free versions often prohibit commercial use altogether. Don't rely on other people's summaries—read the original source on the service's website.
2. **Rights to the result.** Depending on the service and jurisdiction, a generated image, text, piece of music, or video may belong to the service, to you, or to no one. This is an evolving area of law, and the rules differ from country to country.

3. **Other people’s rights.** Do not enter recognisable faces of real people into prompts without their consent, or use brand logos, characters from other people’s works, or other people’s photographs. Try to create original images. Otherwise, you may infringe someone else’s copyright.
4. **AI labeling.** Some platforms (stock websites, social networks, competitions) require you to indicate that a work was created with AI. Follow their rules to avoid being blocked.
5. **The law is changing.** What is allowed today may change tomorrow. Keep up with updates and consult a lawyer if necessary, especially if you are planning a serious commercial project.

In short: create freely, but be mindful of rights—your own and other people’s.

Your practical assignment (right now, 30 minutes)

1. Choose ONE tool from the list.
2. Take a ready-made prompt or adapt it to suit yourself.
3. Create something!
4. Save the result.
5. Feel it—you’re a creator!

Don’t wait for perfection. Experiment. Your first work may not be a masterpiece, but it is YOUR work, your creativity, your first step. And it will get better from there. I promise!

Bonus: a prompt library

Save these prompts and adapt them to suit yourself:

- **Visuals:** portraits, landscapes, fantasy (see above).
- **Music:** meditation, video, emotional (see above).
- **Texts:** plot, dialogue, description of a place (see above).

Change the style, mood, and details. Experiment. Create your own library—what works specifically for you.

What’s next?

You have the tools, prompts, and inspiration. But why create at all— besides joy

and income? It turns out that creativity can gently support your emotional well-being. The next subsection is about that. Anna's story—of how she found support in creativity during a difficult period—is waiting for you. Ready to discover how creativity can gently support you?

5.4 Creativity as gentle support for emotional well-being

When art warms the soul

> ***An important warning at the beginning of the section.*** *Everything discussed here concerns the gentle, supportive use of creativity for well-being. It is* ***not treatment*** *and* ***not a substitute for*** *qualified help. If you notice persistent sadness, anxiety, insomnia, loss of interest in life, panic attacks, or other symptoms that interfere with your life, please consult a doctor or psychologist. AI and creativity are not substitutes for a professional.*

Creativity has long helped people express what is difficult to put into words. With AI, the "I don't know how" barrier becomes lower: you do not need to know how to use a brush or read music to get started. This makes creativity an accessible form of self-care—gentle, voluntary, and on your terms.

A creative activity can sometimes help shift your attention, express emotions, and notice your own state. But it is not a medical method and does not prove a therapeutic effect. In acute situations or cases of persistent anxiety or depression, you need a doctor or psychologist.

Anna's story: from a difficult period to a new source of support

Composite example: Moscow. Anna Sokolova, 45. Divorced after 20 years of marriage; her children are adults and live separately. Anna was left alone, surrounded by the silence and emptiness of her apartment. Work was routine; weekends were spent watching television and crying. A difficult period.

A doctor prescribed supportive therapy, which helped only partially, and suggested art therapy. Anna bought paints, a canvas, and brushes—but she sat in front of the blank canvas and cried helplessly: "I don't know how. It's pointless."

A friend suggested trying Midjourney—describing her feelings in words instead of drawing by hand. One evening, alone with a cup of tea, Anna wrote:

> *A lonely woman looks out the window at the rain, sad but with hope, warm muted tones, an atmosphere of melancholy and anticipation of something new*

AI created an image, and Anna began to cry—but these were different tears: “That’s me. My state. My feelings, expressed and made visible.” For the first time in months, she felt: I am not alone, my feelings are real, and there is beauty even in pain.

Over the following months, Anna created something every day. The tones of her pictures changed from dark to light, from rain to sunshine, from closed doors to roads leading forward. Each picture was a step. She found a new hobby, posted her work on social media, made friends in the community, and started taking new courses.

“AI helped me give my emotions an outlet when I didn’t have enough words,” Anna says. “It gave me a goal when everything seemed meaningless.” But importantly, her recovery journey took place alongside a doctor. Decisions about any changes in treatment were made under a professional’s supervision—and that is the right, safe example.

Why creativity can support emotional well-being

Psychology describes several mechanisms by which creative self-expression supports us—and why AI makes this path more accessible:

1. **Self-expression.** Emotions get trapped inside and suffocate us. Creativity gives them an outlet—in an image, melody, or text. The effect: relief, “I expressed it, and I feel better.”
2. **Achievement.** A feeling of helplessness gives way to “I CREATED this!” The effect: higher self-esteem and greater faith in yourself.
3. **Flow.** A state of absorption in which time stands still. The brain gets a break from anxiety. With AI, it is easier to enter a state of flow because there is no struggle with technique.
4. **Meaning.** “I create—which means I matter, I am leaving something behind.” Life gains purpose.

Creativity can offer a respite, a sense of involvement, and an opportunity to express what you are going through. However, this is not a reason to self-medicate: serious symptoms require a specialist.

More examples of a gentle approach

Composite examples: Vladimir from Vladivostok (52), after burnout, began writing short stories with ChatGPT about the sea and ships—and found joy in words. Olga from Tomsk (38), who experienced anxiety, created calming music with AIVA and listened to her tracks for relaxation—and felt calmer. These are observations, not medical outcomes, and they do not replace a doctor's help.

Your gentle creative assignment

If you feel:

- Sadness → create a picture about it.
- Anxiety → compose a calming melody.
- Loneliness → write a story about friendship.
- Joy → express it in colors!

Process:

1. Identify the emotion.
2. Describe it to AI.
3. Create an image, melody, or text.
4. Look at it, listen to it, or read it.
5. Feel the relief.

This may help—but gently and without guarantees. **If symptoms persist or worsen, I'll remind you again: consult a specialist.** Creativity is support, not a substitute for treatment.

Key takeaways from Chapter 5

AI has made creativity more accessible:

- A teacher became an artist (5.1)—technique is no longer a barrier.
- Ordinary people create (5.2)—age is no obstacle.

- Tools at your fingertips (5.3)—ready-made prompts and rules about rights.
- Creativity gently supports emotional well-being (5.4)—but it does not cure or replace a specialist.

You can create. And it can make your life a little brighter.

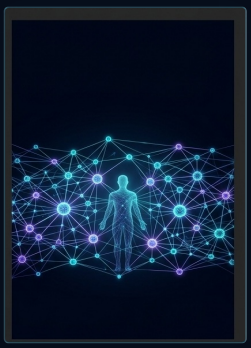
Transition to education

Creativity warms the soul, brings joy, and offers new experiences. But what about learning? How is AI changing education? How do children learn with an AI tutor, and adults with an AI mentor? How can you gain knowledge that was once available only to a select few?

Chapter 6 is about the revolution in education. About how everyone can get a personal learning assistant: patient and accessible. The story of Maxim, a struggling schoolboy who became a top student in two months with the help of AI, is coming up. Ready to learn in a new way?

Note for the attentive reader: all names, cities, income figures, and specific numbers in this chapter are composite examples. They show possible scenarios rather than describing real biographies or promising repeatable results.

CHAPTER 6. EDUCATION IN THE AGE OF AI



A Personal Assistant for Every Student

Imagine having a patient conversational partner you can turn to after class, while studying on your own, or when changing careers. You can ask it to explain a topic more simply, find an example suited to your level, come up with practice exercises, and go over a mistake. Such an assistant already exists in the form of artificial intelligence systems.

But it is important to agree on one thing from the outset: AI is not a magical teacher or a flawless source of knowledge. It can support your learning, but it does not replace a real teacher, mentor, classmates, or your own work. Its answers need to be checked, especially when the subject involves health, safety, the law, exam requirements, or facts on which a decision depends.

This chapter does not promise guaranteed top marks, diplomas, a new profession, or employment. It shows how to use AI wisely: for understanding, practice, feedback, and planning. The result depends on your consistency, the quality of the materials, support from adults and teachers, the requirements of a particular school or program, and numerous circumstances that cannot be guaranteed in advance.

6.1. A Personal Teacher for Everyone: Maxim’s Story and Real Possibilities

Why One Lesson Cannot Suit Everyone

A regular classroom may have dozens of children. Each student has her own

pace, prior experience, interests, and gaps in knowledge. One understands a new rule right away, another needs several more examples, a third is afraid to ask a question, while a fourth already knows the topic and needs a more challenging task.

A teacher tries to help everyone, but her time and attention are limited. You cannot expect her to teach a lesson, listen to each student, find an individual explanation, check every solution, and support those who feel anxious—all at the same time. This is not a shortcoming of any particular teacher, but a limitation of the mass-education format.

AI can relieve some of the burden. It can repeat an explanation, change the wording, offer an analogy, break a large task into steps, and provide additional practice. At the same time, it does not see the whole classroom situation, does not automatically know your school's requirements, and can be confidently wrong. So it is best viewed as an additional tool, not as a replacement for education.

A Hypothetical Example: Maxim and Fractions

What follows is a composite story based on typical learning situations. It is not a verified case involving a particular student, but an illustration of what safe work with AI can look like.

Maxim is fourteen years old and is in the eighth grade. He has had gaps in his understanding of fractions since primary school. In class, the teacher explains the material to everyone, while Maxim fails to write down one step. He is embarrassed to ask for clarification, misses the next part, and begins to think that mathematics is "not for him."

The family decides to try a digital assistant alongside his school lessons. An adult first explains the safety rules to Maxim: do not share your surname, address, school name, photographs of documents, or other personal data with the service; do not open links without checking them; do not copy a ready-made answer into your homework; and show any unclear or questionable answers to an adult and his teacher.

Maxim writes: "I don't understand how to add fractions with different denominators. Explain it at an eighth-grade level, and first check what I already know." The assistant gives him an explanation. It turns out to be too difficult. Maxim then clarifies: "Explain it differently—using the example of dividing a pizza, and then solve one problem with me without doing all the others for me."

After that, he asks it to give him two short questions. If he answers incorrectly, the AI does not simply show the result; instead, it asks him to name the step at which he ran into difficulty. Maxim then solves several examples on his own and checks his working. He writes down his mistakes in a separate list: “I forget to find a common denominator,” “I mix up the numerator and denominator.”

After several weeks of this kind of practice, he may feel more confident. Perhaps he will do better on the next test, but this cannot be promised in advance: the difficulty of the test, his well-being, the school curriculum, and how deeply the skill has taken root all play a role. The most valuable change is not a particular grade, but the realization: “I can figure this out if I get the right explanation and keep practicing.”

How to Use an AI Assistant Step by Step

1. **Give the context.** Specify the subject, grade or level, topic, and what you already know how to do. Do not add personal information that is not needed for learning.
2. **State the difficulty.** Instead of “explain everything,” write: “I understand the first step, but I get confused when moving on to the second.”
3. **Ask for explanations in several ways.** For example: through a diagram, an everyday analogy, a short definition, and an example.
4. **Ask it to check your understanding.** A good prompt is: “Ask me questions and wait for my answers; don’t show me the solution right away.”
5. **Solve it yourself.** If you constantly ask for ready-made answers, you may develop the illusion that you understand, but the skill will not take root.
6. **Check the result.** Compare formulas and facts with your textbook, notes, an official website, or your teacher.
7. **Discuss difficulties with a person.** If the topic is still unclear after several attempts, turn to your teacher, parent, mentor, or classmate.

What AI Can and Cannot Do

AI is especially useful when you need to:

- get an explanation in simple words;
- see several examples of the same idea;
- practice with tasks of varying difficulty;

- get a hint without having the entire solution revealed;
- practice a conversation in a foreign language;
- make a revision plan;
- find a weak point in your own reasoning;
- turn a long text into questions for self-checking;
- come up with a learning project and break it into small steps.

But it cannot reliably guarantee that:

- every fact in the answer is correct;
- the solution meets your school's specific requirements;
- your test grade will improve;
- a ready-made text can be submitted as your own work;
- the profession you choose will bring in a particular income;
- its advice is safe in a medical, legal, or psychological situation.

If the service gives you figures, links, researchers' names, or program titles that you do not recognize, ask it to provide the original source and check it yourself. If there is no confirmation, do not use the statement as a fact. Choose cautious wording: "in some educational scenarios," "may help," or "there are reports of a possible effect."

Basic prompts

Explaining a topic

> *You are my study assistant for [subject]. I am in [grade/year] and already understand [what exactly]. I find [specific difficulty] challenging. Explain the topic in simple terms, then show me one example and ask me three questions. Do not tell me the correct answers until I have tried to answer on my own. If your explanation includes a disputed or time-sensitive fact, mark it as "needs to be checked".*

Checking a solution without giving the answer

> *Check my working on the problem [problem statement]. Do not solve it for me. Point out only the first step where there is an error, explain which rule*

> *I should review, and give me a small, similar problem for practice.*

Review before class

> *Create a [number]-day review plan for the topic [topic]. For each day, suggest a short explanation, several exercises, and a self-check. Bear in mind that I need to study for [number of] minutes. Do not promise a grade; help me measure my progress by the actions I have completed.*

6.2. Learning without borders: accessibility and responsibility

The internet and AI can provide additional materials where there are few clubs, tutors, or specialized classes. A girl from a small settlement, a student, a working mother, and someone returning to education after a long break all have the chance to ask a question at a convenient time. This is an important opportunity, but it does not automatically eliminate inequality.

Accessibility depends on electricity, connectivity, a device, language, digital literacy, the cost of the service, and adult support. Not every family has a quiet place to study or a stable internet connection. So we cannot claim that AI is equally accessible to everyone or that it makes education fair with a single click. Educational projects should continue to support libraries, school computers, human teachers, and offline materials.

Hypothetical example: a school in a small settlement

Imagine a school where only a few subject teachers are available for several classes. The principal decides, together with the teachers, to use AI not instead of lessons but between them. In class, the teacher explains the topic and demonstrates an experiment. At home, students can ask a digital assistant to repeat a definition, but in the next lesson they discuss the results with their teacher and check the answers in the textbook.

The school rules are simple:

- the study account contains no unnecessary personal data;
- parents or other responsible adults help children set up access;
- students do not upload photos of faces, diaries, addresses, or medical

documents;

- AI responses are not considered evidence;
- tests and independent assignments are completed according to the rules set by the teacher;
- the teacher knows which service the children use and explains its limitations;
- when there is no internet, printed materials and pair work are available.

This approach may help students ask more questions and prepare better, but any figures about higher scores, money saved, or the superiority of one method over another must be supported by a specific study. Stories about schools, program names, and statistics from promotional materials should not be presented as established scientific facts. If no source has been found, do not include the figure in the material; leave only a qualitative, cautious description.

AI can also support adult learning. For example, a forty-five-year-old woman might ask it to break learning Python into short sessions, explain a syntax error, and suggest a small project. This does not mean that she is guaranteed to find a job within a few months. Employment will require independent projects, knowledge checks, a portfolio, interviews, actual employer requirements, and a fortunate set of circumstances. AI can help her prepare, but it does not replace practice or make the decision for an employer.

Marina’s composite story: changing skills without promises

Marina had worked as an accountant for twenty years when she decided to explore programming. She chose a small project: a spreadsheet for analyzing household expenses. AI helped her set up the environment, explained variables, and suggested how to read an error message. Marina ran every piece of code herself, checked the documentation, and wrote down why the fix worked.

After several months, she had a study project and a clearer understanding of whether she liked this field. Next, she had to complete free and paid training courses, ask people in the industry for feedback, and study job openings. She might find an internship, or she might realize that she wants a different path. In either case, AI proved useful as a research tool, but not as a guarantee of income or employment.

What matters for a child

If you are helping your daughter, younger sister, or student use AI, adult

supervision should be constant and supportive. It is needed not for total surveillance and punishment, but for safety and learning digital literacy.

Before you begin, discuss:

- which service is being used and why;
- which data must not be shared;
- why you cannot trust every confidently worded answer;
- what to do with unpleasant, frightening, or sexualized content;
- when to close the chat and turn to an adult;
- which school assignments must not be completed with AI, or may be completed only with its use disclosed.

Never send to a study chat: the child's surname and address, phone number, passwords, passport or bank card details, photos of documents, medical information, an exact schedule, or geolocation. It is also best to crop a photo of a notebook page so that the name, school, and other identifying details are not visible.

For a young student, choose the service together with an adult, and review its age restrictions and privacy settings. Do not leave a child alone with the system if it suggests a dangerous action, asks them to hide the conversation, or claims that "only it understands you." AI must not become a secret friend, therapist, or authority in place of family and teachers.

AI does not replace the teacher

A teacher can see when a student becomes anxious, notice fatigue, take the class context into account, and change the lesson plan. The teacher bears professional responsibility and helps students socialize: listening to others, arguing respectfully, working in a group, and asking for help. AI cannot fully replace this.

So a useful formula looks like this:

the teacher sets the goals and boundaries → AI offers additional explanation and practice → the student thinks and solves problems independently → the teacher checks understanding and adjusts the path.

6.3. How to learn with AI: five techniques that preserve independence

Technique 1. AI tutor

This technique is useful when a new topic seems overwhelming. Ask it to start with a diagnostic assessment rather than a long lecture.

> *I am studying [topic] at [level]. First, ask me five short questions to determine what I already know. Then explain the gaps in simple terms, from basic to more advanced. After each small section, ask me to restate the idea in my own words. Do not give ready-made answers to the practice questions.*

After the conversation, close the chat and write a summary from memory. This step helps reveal what has truly stayed in your mind.

Technique 2. Practice with Gradual Hints

Ask for exercises at three levels, while preserving my right to solve them independently.

> *Create eight problems on [topic]: three basic, three application-based, and two more challenging. Show only the problem statements at first. When I send my solution, tell me whether my reasoning is correct. If there is an error, give me one hint, then wait for my new attempt. Show the full solution only after I ask for it.*

It is useful to keep an error log: what I confused, which rule helped, and how to recognize a similar problem next time. Do not measure progress only by the number of correct answers: consider whether you have become faster at understanding the problem statement and explaining your reasoning.

The phrase “80% better retention,” without a precise source and a description of the method, is an unsubstantiated generalization and must not be used as a fact. Effectiveness depends on the subject, age, duration of practice, and quality of feedback.

Technique 3. Project-Based Learning

A project turns abstract knowledge into action. Choose a task with a clear outcome: a mini-website, research into local history, a budget model, a podcast about a literary work, or a program that sorts data.

> *I am a beginner in [skill]. Suggest a project that can be completed in [time frame] with [number of] minutes per day. Divide it into stages. For each stage, specify the goal, the necessary knowledge, the completion criterion, and possible risks. Do not do the project for me: help with questions and small hints. Suggest how to verify the result independently.*

Do not insert code you do not understand. Run it in a safe environment, do not use real passwords or API keys, and do not connect unfamiliar libraries to important data. If the project involves children, personal information, or real clients, use fictional data.

Technique 4. Socratic Dialogue

Sometimes it is useful not to receive an answer, but to arrive at it yourself.

> *I am studying [topic]. Guide me in a Socratic format: ask one leading question at a time, ask me to explain my reasoning, and do not provide the conclusion in advance. If I am mistaken, help me check my premise, but do not replace my reasoning with your own.*

This approach can be used to examine physical laws, historical causes, literary motifs, and mathematical proofs. At the end, ask the AI to list the steps you took, and then check them against the textbook. Socratic dialogue does not replace a precise explanation: if the conclusion is debatable, ask a teacher to evaluate it.

Technique 5. Analogies and Explaining in Different Voices

You can ask for a complex topic to be explained through a metaphor, but a metaphor is not proof. It makes the first encounter with an idea easier, but later it must be replaced with precise concepts.

> *Explain [topic] first through a simple analogy, then using the same idea in a rigorous textbook definition. List separately where the analogy stops working and what mistakes it may cause.*

For example, a queue of people can help explain the principle of task processing by a computer. But a computer does not literally “think like a queue,” so after the analogy, you need terminology, a diagram, and practice.

The prompt “explain it like I’m five” should be used carefully and respectfully. Simplicity should not mean baby talk or distortion. For a child, it is better to say: “explain it in age-appropriate language, with short examples, and then ask questions.”

Prompt Library by Subject

Mathematics

> *Explain [topic] through one everyday example and one diagram. After that, suggest four problems from simple to complex. Check my solutions step by step and note which rule I used.*

Natural Sciences

> *Explain [phenomenon] with reference to a school textbook. Divide the answer into observation, hypothesis, mechanism, and method of verification. Note which claims require a source. Do not present an invented experiment as one that was conducted.*

History and Social Studies

> *Help me create a timeline of [topic]. Separate confirmed facts, interpretations, and disputed questions. For dates, names, and quotations, suggest primary sources or official materials. Do not invent links.*

Literature

> *Help me prepare an outline for analyzing [work]. Separate my own conclusion from the summary. Suggest questions about structure, characters, and language. Do not write the entire essay for submission.*

Foreign Language

> *Have a short dialogue with me in [language] on the topic of [topic]. Correct no more than two errors at a time, explain the rule, and ask me to repeat the phrase. If there are several options, indicate which one sounds more natural and why.*

Programming

> *Help me understand the error in this short code fragment. Do not rewrite everything at once. Explain the error message, suggest one hypothesis, and ask me to test it. Do not use real keys, passwords, or personal data.*

Exam Preparation

> *Create a review plan based on the official list of topics for [exam/subject]. Indicate what needs to be checked against the current requirements. For each day, suggest a practice activity and a completion criterion. Do not promise a result or present an approximate plan as official.*

How Not to Turn Learning into Cheating

Before submitting your work, ask yourself:

- Can I explain every idea in my own words?
- Did I solve at least part of the assignment without help?
- Have the rules for using AI been stated?
- Did someone else's personal data end up in the chat?
- Have I checked the facts and calculations?
- Did the assistant invent a source, quotation, or experiment?

If you use AI in a report, honestly indicate its role wherever your teacher or educational institution requires this. For example: "AI helped create questions for self-assessment; the facts were checked against the textbook and official sources." Rules may differ, so clarify them in advance.

6.4. The Future of Education: Predictions Without Excessive Confidence

Conversations about the future often sound like a schedule: in a specific year, every student will supposedly have a personal mentor, learning will become several times more effective, and changing careers will take only a few months. Such formulations are appealing, but they mix predictions, advertising promises, and facts.

Any statistics about the number of schools, increases in results, “effectiveness percentages,” companies’ plans, and the opinions of “experts” should be checked against the primary source: who conducted the study, whom they compared, how long it lasted, whether there was a control group, how success was defined, and whether the methodology was published. If there are no answers, do not present the claim as an established fact: write “according to the organizers” or “it is assumed,” and indicate the limits of that conclusion.

What is likely to develop

In the coming years, we can expect further experiments with formats such as:

- personalised prompts that take a student’s pace and level into account;
- automatic generation of practice exercises;
- voice-based and multimodal explanations;
- virtual laboratories and simulations;
- help for teachers preparing materials and providing feedback;
- hybrid classes, where some revision takes place with a digital assistant and complex discussions take place with a teacher;
- lifelong learning programmes for adults.

These are directions for development, not guarantees. Implementation may be slowed by cost, a lack of devices, legal restrictions, privacy concerns and the quality of the models. Being able to generate a course does not yet mean that the course is pedagogically sound.

The role of the teacher

AI can explain a rule quickly and check a large number of simple exercises. A teacher helps set a goal, choose the right level of difficulty, notice when something is not understood, support motivation and connect knowledge with the life of the class. A teacher teaches cooperation, responsibility and independent judgement.

A possible model for the future looks not like “AI performs while the teacher watches”, but like a partnership:

1. the teacher formulates the educational goal;
2. the student tries to solve the problem herself;
3. AI offers personalised practice and a careful hint;
4. the teacher discusses common mistakes and the emotional state of the class;
5. the students apply their knowledge in a project, experiment or group discussion;
6. the final result is assessed according to transparent criteria by a person and, where appropriate, with digital tools.

Assessment cannot be handed over to an algorithm completely. A student has the right to understand why she received a particular grade and to turn to her teacher if an automated check was wrong.

Lifelong learning without the rat race

Changes in technology really do make lifelong learning worthwhile. But the idea of “changing careers every five years” is not a universal rule, only one possible scenario. Not every woman needs to retrain constantly, and the speed at which a skill is learned depends on the field, health, time, finances and support.

Set yourself a realistic goal: not “become a specialist in three months”, but “understand the basics and complete one small project in four weeks”. At the end, assess what worked, where you need help and whether you want to continue. Small, measurable steps protect you from inflated promises and feelings of guilt.

The safety of digital education

The future of learning must take into account not only convenience, but also students’ rights.

- Services should collect the minimum data necessary and clearly explain how it is used.
- Parental and teacher oversight should be proportionate to the student’s age, without public shaming or secret surveillance.
- Children should be given a way to report a harmful or frightening response.

- Decisions about placement, grading, discipline and additional support must not be made solely on the basis of an automated profile.
- Learning materials should be accessible to students with different needs.
- Important answers, especially those concerning health, law, safety and factual matters, should undergo human review.
- AI must not persuade a child to hide a conversation from a trusted adult.

If a system asks for a face photograph, voice recording, home address or other information, stop and find out whether it is truly necessary. If in doubt, choose an anonymised example or ask an adult, a teacher or the school administration.

Key points from Chapter 6

1. **AI can personalise practice.** It can explain a topic in different ways, but it can make mistakes and does not replace a teacher.
2. **Accessibility is not the same as equality.** Good education requires the internet, devices, safe services, human teachers and offline alternatives.
3. **The best way to learn is actively.** Ask for a diagnostic assessment, solve problems yourself, use hints gradually, keep an error log and explain the material from memory.
4. **Projects turn knowledge into skills.** But you need to understand AI-generated code and advice, run them safely and check them against the documentation.
5. **Facts and figures require verification.** Do not use unverified research and statistics as evidence; present stories as hypothetical examples.
6. **Children need adult supervision.** Protect personal data, discuss unpleasant responses and remember that AI is not a secret friend, doctor or teacher.
7. **There is no guaranteed grade, career or salary.** AI can support preparation, but the result depends on practice, requirements and circumstances.

A small plan for the coming week

Day 1. Choose one topic and ask AI to check what you already know. Write down the gaps.

Day 2. Get two explanations: one simple and one precise. Create your own

notes.

Day 3. Solve three problems without hints. Ask AI to check not the answer, but your reasoning.

Day 4. Analyse one mistake and come up with a similar example yourself.

Day 5. Explain the topic to an imaginary student or adult. Note where you cannot find the right words.

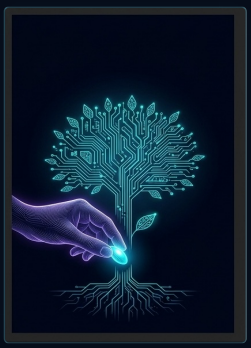
Day 6. Check two facts against a textbook, an official website or another reliable source.

Day 7. Show the result to your teacher, mentor or another adult and decide what to revise next.

You can learn at any age and change your pace when necessary. AI can become a useful torch: illuminating the next step, showing you an additional path and supporting your practice. But you choose the road, while safety, verification and responsibility remain in human hands.

Learn not for the sake of a promised grade, but for the ability to understand, ask questions, check answers and apply knowledge in life. This independence is what will help you use AI confidently and wisely—not as a replacement for your own thinking, but as a tool alongside it.

CHAPTER 7. WISDOM—ETHICS AND A RESPONSIBLE FUTURE WITH AI



You have already come a long way. You know how to see AI around you, understand how it works, know how to talk to it, and how to create, learn and even build things with it. But there is one more dimension, without which everything else can go wrong. That dimension is wisdom.

Knowledge tells you *how* to do something. Wisdom tells you *whether* you should do it, *whom* it might harm and *what* will happen to you if you become used to relying on a machine for everything. In this chapter, we will have an honest, warm and practical heart-to-heart talk. Without fearmongering, but without rose-tinted glasses either.

⚖ 7.1. Ethics and responsibility: how to use power wisely

> *“With great power comes great responsibility.”*

You already know that AI is a powerful tool. But every tool is inherently two-sided. A knife can slice dinner or cause injury. Fire can warm a home or burn it down. AI can help you come into your own—or, if approached thoughtlessly, it can manipulate and deceive you, replacing your own thinking with someone else’s. The choice is always yours. No one can make it for you. And that is precisely why you need simple, clear principles that you can trust.

Principle 1. Honesty

Do not pass off AI-generated content as entirely your own when your honesty toward others depends on it.

Be open: “Created with the help of AI” or “AI-assisted.”

This is not a sign of weakness. It is a sign of maturity. In academic work, journalism, and professional documents, honesty is especially important: there, people’s trust in you is built on your telling the truth about where the text came from. If you submit an essay in which most of the writing was done by a

machine, while your teacher expects *your* own thinking, you are not deceiving the AI but a real person. And if you prepare a report for a client while hiding that the text was generated, you are passing on risks they know nothing about. Be honest, and you will not have to remember or justify anything later.

Principle 2. Fact-checking

AI sometimes “hallucinates”—confidently inventing facts that sound plausible but never existed. It may make up a research paper, a nonexistent quotation, a fabricated date, or false statistics. A machine does not know when it is wrong. So your rule is:

- Always check figures and statistics.
- Always check names, titles, and dates.
- Always check scientific and medical claims.
- Always check historical facts.

Trust, but verify. This is the golden rule for working with any machine. If AI gives you a law, formula, or medication, find the primary source. Do not base a decision on a polished phrase that may turn out to be fiction.

Principle 3. Confidentiality and privacy

Do not upload the following to publicly available AI services:

- personal data belonging to clients, patients, or employees;
- trade secrets and internal reports;
- family secrets and other people’s correspondence;
- documents containing passport details, addresses, or card numbers.

Use general examples and anonymized data. Replace real names with “client A” and “company B.”

Remember: what you send in a chat may be stored by the developer and, in the worst case, used to train models. Before putting anything personal into an AI window, ask yourself: “Would I want a stranger to read this?” If the answer is “no,” do not send it. For sensitive tasks, look for solutions with guaranteed privacy or local tools where the data never leaves your computer.

Principle 4. Humanity

AI is an assistant, not a replacement for real human communication.

Do not use AI for important personal conversations, to comfort someone close to you who is grieving, or to make critical decisions about people's fates.

Do not let a machine decide for you whom to hire, whom to befriend, or whom to condemn.

Use AI for routine tasks, analysis, idea generation, learning, and drafts— but keep the final human warmth, compassion, and responsibility for yourself.

When another person's feelings are at stake, you are needed. Your hands, your voice, your presence. A machine may suggest the words, but it cannot give someone a hug.

Ethical dilemmas— discuss them with yourself

Question 1. If AI wrote 80% of the text and you wrote 20%, whose work is it?

My answer: yours. You provided the idea, context, direction, and editing. AI is a tool, like a word processor. But that does not mean you can hide AI's involvement where independent work is expected of you. Honesty is part of your responsibility for the result.

Question 2. Is it right to use AI for a competitive advantage at work?

My answer: yes, if you use it honestly and openly. It is like switching from a typewriter to a computer. The tool is available to many—and those who learn to use it wisely really will be faster and more accurate. But the advantage must be built on your skills, not on deception or violations of your organization's rules.

Question 3. Will AI replace people at work?

My answer: AI will replace not people, but individual tasks. It will make room for creative, human, meaningful work. Those who learn to use AI while holding on to what machines cannot do—empathy, responsibility, and wisdom—will be in even greater demand.

Your ethical position

Decide for yourself and write it down somewhere so you do not forget:

- I use AI honestly and openly.

- I check facts and do not take things on trust.
- I respect my own privacy and that of others.
- I remember the importance of humanity and do not leave the care of people to a machine.
- I respect copyright and do not pass off other people's work as my own.
- I protect children and vulnerable people from accidental harm.
- I use power for good.

This is your personal ethical code. Follow it—not because "that is what you are supposed to do," but because it allows you to remain yourself.

7.2. Risks and safety

Let's call things by their proper names. AI is useful, but it has blind spots. Knowing what they are means keeping the situation under control.

1. Dependence on AI

The quietest and most dangerous risk is forgetting how to think for yourself.

- Do not hand over to a machine what makes you who you are: the ability to reason, feel, and make decisions.
- Use AI as an assistant, not as a replacement for your own mind.
- Do some tasks "manually" from time to time. Write a letter without prompts. Solve a problem yourself. Feel that you are still capable.

If you notice that you can no longer start any task without AI, that is a signal to slow down and reclaim your initiative.

2. Data privacy

- Do not share secrets with AI if you are unsure how they are stored.
- Remember: data may be used to train models unless you change the settings.
- Read the fine print, at least the section on "who can see my data."

3. AI hallucinations

- AI sometimes confidently invents facts.
- Always verify important information through independent sources.
- If your health, money, or reputation depends on the answer, verification is essential.

4. Manipulation

- AI can be a tool for deception in the wrong hands.
- Assess AI-generated content sent to you critically: fake news, forged emails, and generated reviews.
- Ask yourself: “Who benefits from my believing this?”

5. Copyright

- Do not ask AI to copy other people’s books, articles, or paintings “in the style of” a specific living author for commercial purposes.
- Remember: AI-generated output may draw on other people’s materials from its training data. Check whether the text or image contains recognizable borrowings.
- Respect other people’s work. If you use someone else’s idea, name its source.

6. Children’s safety

- Do not entrust AI with childcare, parenting, or answers to children’s serious questions about health and safety.
- Monitor what children can access: some models may produce adult or frightening content.
- Teach children what you are learning yourself: check facts, do not share personal information, and do not believe everything you see.
- For minors, choose dedicated children’s solutions with filters and parental controls.

7. Medical, financial, and legal limitations

This is a separate and very important section. AI is not a doctor, accountant, or lawyer.

- Do not diagnose yourself or prescribe treatment based on an AI response. The machine does not know your medical history, cannot see you, and could make a fatal mistake. Any medical advice is a reason to consult a real specialist.
- Do not make investment or financial decisions based only on AI. It does not predict the market and is not responsible for any money you may lose.
- Do not treat an AI response as legal advice. Laws vary from country to country and change; for official advice, consult a qualified lawyer.
- AI is excellent for helping you *prepare*: formulate a question for a doctor, make a list of topics to discuss with a lawyer, and understand general concepts. But the final decision belongs to the professional and to you.

How to protect yourself — your checklist

- Check facts through independent sources.
- Do not upload confidential information to publicly available services.
- Think critically — AI is an assistant, not the ultimate authority.
- Keep a balance: AI + your own mind.
- Protect children and vulnerable people; do not entrust a machine with what requires human responsibility.

Wisdom in one sentence: use its power, but remain human.

7.3. The Future with AI — scenarios, not guarantees

Now let's talk about what may await us ahead. It is important to remember: no one knows the future for certain. Everything below is **scenarios**, possible paths of development, not promises. They will help you prepare, but you should not regard them as inevitable.

Scenario A: "AI beside everyone" (the coming years)

A possible path: personal assistants become a familiar part of the smartphone, just as the internet once did. You talk to AI as easily as you talk to a search engine. In this scenario, those who already know how to formulate prompts and check answers come out ahead.

Scenario B: “AI colleagues in the workplace” (in the medium term)

A likely, but not guaranteed, trend: routine tasks are increasingly distributed between people and machine assistants. New roles are emerging — people who know how to assign tasks to AI and check the results. But this depends on the industry, the laws, and companies’ readiness.

Scenario C: “AI skills as a foundation” (in the longer term)

One possible outcome: knowing how to work with AI becomes as commonplace as knowing how to use Excel is today. But remember: this is a scenario, not a sentence. Technology, the economy, and society may take a different turn.

What is most within your control

Do not try to guess who is right in arguments about the future. Do one simple thing: learn the skill now, so that any of these scenarios finds you prepared rather than caught off guard.

What this could mean for you — options:

In the short term (1–2 years):

- Learn the basics of working with AI.
- Automate routine tasks that take up your time.
- Find your own, personal use for it.

In the long term (5–10 years):

- AI skills *may* become a competitive advantage.
- *New professions may* emerge — AI prompter, AI curator, AI ethics specialist.
- Reskilling will *probably* become a normal part of life.

The advice is simple: start learning today. But do it calmly, without panicking that you are “too late.” The future is not a race to catch up; it is your own pace.

7.4. Your Choice

You have come a long way. From the first chapter to this one. From “What even is AI?” to “I know how to use AI wisely.” Congratulations — sincerely.

Now you:

- See AI around you.
- Understand how it works.
- Know how to communicate with it.
- Know how to create together with it.
- Can learn with it.
- Understand ethics and risks.
- Know the boundaries: where AI can help and where a real person is needed.

You are ready. And there is only one question: what next?

Three Paths

Path 1. Apply it to your own life. Use AI for work, creativity, learning, and everyday tasks. The result: you live a little more easily, efficiently, and freely.

Path 2. Share it with others. Tell your colleagues, friends, and family. Teach children to protect their data and check facts. The result: you change the world around you — gently and kindly.

Path 3. Create something of your own. Launch a project, a creative series, or an educational course. The result: you create a new little reality in which you are happy to be the author.

My Call to You

Do not stop. You have read the book, learned something new, and perhaps seen familiar technologies differently. Now — take action. Choose at least one:

- Use one prompt today.
- Tell one person tomorrow how you check AI responses.
- Start one small project within a week.

A small step is still a step. The skill is already in your hands: allow yourself to use it calmly and responsibly.

The Last Words of the Chapter

Thank you for reading. Thank you for making it to the end. Thank you for

opening yourself to new knowledge.

Go and change the world — with AI as your partner, wisdom as your compass, and your soul as your light. You can do it, you are ready, and you are worthy.

CONCLUSION

You have reached the end. But, to be honest, this is only the beginning.

You Have Changed

Remember who you were at the beginning of the book. Perhaps you did not know that AI surrounded you dozens of times a day — in your phone, route suggestions, photo filters, and translator. Perhaps you thought AI was something complicated, distant, and "not for you." Perhaps you were wary of it or simply did not understand how to approach it.

Now you see AI around you more clearly, understand its limitations, and know how to work with it. Most importantly, you know where to stop. You are ready for the future not because it is predictable, but because you have skill, critical thinking, and wisdom.

What You Have Learned

Over seven chapters, you have made your own journey:

- **Chapter 1:** opened your eyes — AI is already beside you.
- **Chapter 2:** understood — the model works according to clear principles and can make mistakes.
- **Chapter 3:** mastered the formula for a clear prompt and checking the result.
- **Chapter 4:** saw that AI can be used to test and develop ideas.
- **Chapter 5:** realized that technology can support creativity, but cannot replace your voice.
- **Chapter 6:** learned that you can study with AI, as long as you do not hand over your own thinking.
- **Chapter 7:** understood that safety, ethics, and responsibility remain with the human.

This is not just knowledge. It is a journey you have made yourself.

What to Do Next

Today. Choose one idea from the book and apply it: improve one prompt, check one fact, automate a small routine.

This week. Tell at least one person how to check AI responses and protect personal data.

This month. Create something of your own with AI: a project, text, study plan, or creative series. Responsibility for the choice and the result remains with you.

My Last Words

Thank you for reading this book and taking this journey with me.

Use your knowledge calmly, check what matters, and take care of yourself and others. And may AI be a tool for you, not a replacement for your own judgment.

P.S. If you found the book useful, share it with someone it may help.

P.P.S. I am always available. You can send me a question, feedback, or your own story of using AI by email: **soko1d@icloud.com**.

Warmly,

Darya Sokolova

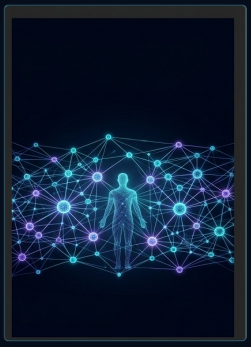
AFTER THE CONCLUSION: 50 QUESTIONS ABOUT AI AND A GLOSSARY

Part 1. Fifty Questions About AI Without Panic Part 2. A Glossary in Plain English

> ***How to read this supplement.*** *You have already made your way through the book — from "What even is AI?" to understanding how to assign tasks, check answers, and protect yourself. This supplement answers the questions most often asked after reading. You can read it straight through or open it to the topic you need. Every answer is honest: no promises of miracles and no fearmongering. I address you informally, as I do throughout the book. And remember the main rule: everything that concerns health, money, rights, and other people should be checked against the original source, and when necessary, discussed with a specialist. There are no unverified statistics here — only things you can check yourself or see with your own eyes.*

PART 1. FIFTY QUESTIONS ABOUT AI WITHOUT THE PANIC

The questions are grouped by topic. Each answer is roughly one hundred to one hundred and fifty words—so you can read it in a couple of minutes, even while waiting in line. No panic, no promises of miracles: just what helps you understand, choose, and act.



Block 1. Capabilities and Limits

1. What is AI, in simple terms?

Artificial intelligence is a general name for computer programs that solve tasks once considered “human”: speech recognition, translation, drawing, and writing texts. There is no “spirit in the machine” there. Much of today’s AI works more simply than it seems: a program finds patterns in a huge number of examples and applies them to new data. You have seen this in keyboard suggestions, photo enhancement, translation apps, and maps. AI does not think like a human, but it is excellent at routine tasks: sorting, finding, summarizing, and suggesting options. Imagine a very diligent assistant who has read entire libraries and can quickly find what you need in them, but has no opinion about what it reads. That is the essence: a powerful tool, not a living mind.

2. Does AI really understand what I write?

It understands in quotation marks. The model breaks your words into small fragments and predicts which word is most likely to come next, looking at your entire request. This is not the same as a living person’s understanding: the model has no experience, body, or feelings. But it has seen millions of texts and has a good sense of how people usually express their thoughts. That is why its answers often seem meaningful. But what lies behind them is pattern matching, not a living conversation partner. The important consequence is that the model can sound convincing even when it is wrong. Remember this, and “understanding” will work for you rather than deceive you.

3. Is AI conscious?

No, and for now science sees no signs that this will change. Consciousness is the experience of being, a sense of self, feelings, and the ability to feel joy and suffering. A model merely predicts the next word, while an image is assembled from pixels. A machine has no inner world, pain, or desires. The beautiful stories in the news about “a model becoming self-aware” are metaphor or marketing. When a chatbot writes “I’m afraid” or “I’m happy,” that is a phrase generated after the pattern of human speech, not a feeling it has experienced. Why is it useful to know this? So you do not fear “intelligent machines” or blame yourself for “feeling sorry” for a bot. You are communicating with a tool—respectfully, but with a full understanding of its nature. This book was written for you so that you can stay calm in any argument about the “rise of the machines”: there is no one to rise, because there is no one who wants to.

4. Can AI feel emotions?

On its own, no, but it can portray them remarkably convincingly. The model was trained on huge numbers of letters, stories, scripts, and dialogues, so it can easily imitate a caring, cheerful, or sympathetic tone. Sometimes that feels good: the answer seems to understand and support you, or make you laugh. But behind it is an algorithm that chose a style suited to your request, not a living heart. This is neither bad nor “mean”: book characters do the same thing when they move us to tears. Just keep the difference in mind. When you need genuine human involvement—support in a difficult moment, care, or someone’s presence—turn to people. AI empathy tries to be convenient and appropriate, but it cannot provide real warmth. It can, however, help you put your feelings into words. That is a useful role, and it does not require a “living heart” in the machine.

5. What can AI already do today?

A great deal of what used to take time and require specialized skills: drafting emails and articles, summarizing long texts, translating, explaining complex things in simple terms, planning trips and menus, sketching images and music, helping with language study, and organizing your thoughts. Its particular strength is finding patterns in data: spreadsheets, documents, and large bodies of information. If the task sounds like “take something known and transform it,” AI will handle it quickly and well. If the task is “understand something new, make a judgment, decide what is fair, or invent something that does not yet exist,” you are needed. The most valuable skill today is knowing which of these two tasks lies before you—and calling on whoever can handle it best.

6. What can’t AI do?

AI makes up facts and sources—a phenomenon called “hallucination”—has a poor grasp of events after its training period, does not know what is happening in the world right now, and can reinforce prejudices found in its texts. It does not understand real life beyond the screen, is not responsible for its answers, and cannot give advice about medicine, law, finances, or relationships. It can only repeat other people’s ideas from these fields, often without a sense of proportion. It is not a judge, doctor, teacher, or psychologist—but it can pretend to be. Finally, it does not keep secrets any more reliably than the service you entrust your words to. Knowing its limits is half the skill: use AI where it is strong, and call on a real person where responsibility and experience are needed.

7. What is a “language model”?

It is a program that was shown a huge amount of text during training and given the task of predicting a plausible continuation of a phrase. The name is accurate: the model reproduces language, meaning that it stores patterns of how phrases and lines of reasoning are usually constructed. You send a request, it passes through layers of computation, and the program produces an answer one word at a time. “Large” means that the model contains billions of internal “knobs”—parameters adjusted during training. One important detail: there are no “eternal facts” or a knowledge base in the usual sense inside it—only probabilities. That is why answers can vary depending on how you phrase a question. Treat the model like a well-read but not always reliable assistant, and everything will be fine.

8. How is AI different from a search engine?

A search engine stores and finds links: you enter words, and it shows you documents. An AI chat does not search web pages (unless a separate search function is connected to it); instead, it “assembles” a new answer from what it has learned. A search engine says, “Here are the sources—read them yourself.” AI says, “Here is a ready-made answer—I came up with it.” That is why AI answers require special caution: they are smooth, confident, and convincing, but they do not include citations to the original source. You need to check them. The best strategy is to use both: ask the model where to look, open the search engine, open the original source, and compare it with the model’s answer. You will be surprised how often “plausible” and “reliable” diverge. The search engine is your guard, and AI is your speed. Together, they work brilliantly; separately, use them with caution.

9. Does AI remember what I wrote to it?

Between sessions, a chat does not remember you by default: each new dialogue is like a blank sheet of paper. But within a single conversation, it sees the entire context, and every company stores or may store conversation histories to improve its models and share them with contractors — it depends on the plan and settings. Many services let you disable “use for training” or enable a mode without saving — it is worth finding this in the settings. Never send a bot anything you would not want to see in someone else’s data leak: passport details, login credentials, card numbers, other people’s secrets. Learn to find the buttons for exporting and deleting a conversation. A simple rule: in the chat — only what you could show the world; everything else — in a diary under lock and key.

10. Can AI learn my style?

Yes, and quite well. If you give the model samples of your writing and ask it to “write in this same style,” it will start picking up your turns of phrase, rhythm, and favourite words. Even better is a description of the style: short sentences, gentle irony, no bureaucratic language, addressing the reader as “you.” But remember: what gets copied is the pattern, not your personality. For a stream of emails, newsletters, posts, and drafts, that is enough. For an important personal text — a letter about loss, a response to injustice, a statement — accuracy and your truth matter more than style. Choose a hybrid approach: let AI make a draft in your style, then add your own ideas, correct it, remove what is unnecessary, and sign it. The result is your letter, simply put together more carefully and quickly.

Block 2. Errors, accuracy, and reliability

11. Why does AI make mistakes?

It does not “make mistakes” in the human sense — it predicts. The model chose the most plausible sequence of words, and that sequence may turn out to be untrue: polished, coherent, but invented. The reasons vary: the training texts contained many errors and rumours; the model has never encountered reality directly and cannot verify a fact; its goal is plausibility, not truth. Add a confident tone and haste in answering, and you get “confident nonsense.” This is not malicious intent on the part of machines, but the nature of the technology. So the basic skill is double-checking: anything important for an essay, a work email,

a financial decision, and especially medical information. If a mistake could harm someone, check everything against the primary source. If the answer has no real consequences, you can relax and simply use it.

12. What are AI “hallucinations”?

That is what we call moments when a model confidently presents something invented as real: nonexistent books and quotations, biographies of people who never existed, addresses and telephone numbers that do not exist. “Hallucination” is a metaphor: the model does not hallucinate in the human sense; it simply produces plausible text with no connection to facts. This is a feature of the technology, not a malfunction, but it has already caused harm: broken links in articles, incorrect advice that people accepted as true. The remedy is skill: ask the model to cite sources, ask it to list facts separately from reasoning, ask “are you sure this exists?” — and, above all, check key claims against real sources. The habit of “checking what matters” turns hallucinations from a catastrophe into a minor rough edge.

13. Can AI be used for professional work?

It can — as a draft writer and assistant, but not as the final expert. Writing a press release, organising your thoughts into bullet points, finding the right wording, suggesting headline options — yes, absolutely. Putting your signature on a report, confirming a diagnosis, drawing up a contract without a lawyer — no, never. Responsibility for what goes out into the world is always yours, no matter who drafted it. And this highlights the value of real professionals: you need a doctor, lawyer, or accountant not merely for “providing facts,” but for responsibility, ethics, and experience. Use the technology to prepare materials faster and avoid wasting energy on drafts, but bring in a real specialist for the decisive judgement. That way you get speed and quality together — without dangerous substitutions.

14. Can AI make mistakes in mathematics?

Yes, and this surprises many people. Language models learned to predict words, not to calculate like a calculator. They get confused in long chains of calculations, may “reason” elegantly, and still arrive at the wrong answer. Modern models have become noticeably better — many can perform step-by-step calculations — but you cannot demand accuracy from them “like Excel.” The rule is simple: always double-check mathematics with a calculator or spreadsheet, and ask AI to explain the method, find an error in your calculations,

or check the logic. If accuracy is essential — taxes, percentages, dosages — use specialised tools. This division of labour removes much of the “magical thinking”: AI suggests a path, the calculator gives you the number, and you make the decision.

15. What should I do if AI gives me a wrong answer?

First, do not panic: this is an everyday situation, not the end of the world. Second, try correcting it: sometimes it is enough to write “that is incorrect, review your answer,” and the model will redo it. If that does not help, rephrase the question: break it into parts, add context, ask it to name its sources, assumptions, and verifiable grounds for the answer. If the answer seemed plausible, compare it with the primary source or a search engine. If the incorrect information has already gone into use — the email has been sent, the figure has made it into a report — acknowledge and correct it honestly: this is a skill of mature professional work, and it is incredibly valued. And keep your own list of the model’s “traps”: the topics it consistently struggles with. With experience, you will learn to understand at first glance where an answer can be accepted and where you need to look more closely. An AI error is your reason to trust, but verify.

16. How can I tell whether an answer is trustworthy?

There are signs that more often point to reliability: the model named a source, and you recognise it; the answer matches information from several independent places; the task is standard, and the answer has long been established (how a word is spelled, what a term means, how to get from point A to point B). Be careful if the answer is too smooth and flattering, names an “only correct date” without being asked, gives figures “from a study” that cannot be found, or mentions contacts and details you did not ask for. A practical rule: check what matters, check what is urgent even faster, and always check thoroughly anything that affects money, health, or rights. Doubt is not weakness but maturity: it protects you where a confident tone means nothing.

17. Why does AI answer the same question differently?

There is a parameter inside the model — “temperature” — that regulates how bold its word choices are. With standard settings, the model varies its answers slightly, like a person telling the same story to two friends: a little differently, but essentially the same. So if you ask “explain what inflation is” twice, you will get two explanations — both broadly correct. You can use this: ask it to explain

something in three different ways and choose the one that is clearest to you. But where precision is needed — payment details, dosage, an article of law — variability is unacceptable. In such cases, look for the primary source, not a retelling. Knowing about “temperature” gives you control: ask for “strictly, without embellishment, facts only,” and the answer will become drier and more reliable.

Block 3. Privacy and security

18. How safe is it to share personal data with AI?

Safety depends on the specific service: where its servers are located, which laws apply, and who reads conversations for improvement purposes. By default, every line of a conversation may be read by a real person—an employee or moderator, especially in free versions. Chatbots offer no professional confidentiality: they are not bound to keep your words secret, as a doctor or lawyer is. So the rules are simple: don’t enter information that could easily identify you or your loved ones (passport details, registered address, card numbers, passwords); don’t upload other people’s documents or medical records unless necessary; for sensitive matters, use plans that include written confidentiality commitments. And check the settings: where your conversation is stored, and whether its use to improve models is enabled. A few minutes spent in the settings is the best protection against late-night slipups.

19. What should you never write to AI?

The stop list: passwords and usernames, verification codes, passport details, card and account numbers, medical diagnoses together with a name, other people’s secrets, documents bearing signatures and stamps, your employer’s confidential information, and other people’s personal data without their consent. Not because AI is “evil,” but because every such word becomes data on someone else’s servers. Even if you trust the company, there could be a bug, a breach, or a transfer of information to contractors. The simple rule: don’t write anything in a chat that you wouldn’t want to see in a leaked database. Need to process a real document? Anonymize it first: replace names with “client A,” dates with “day N,” and amounts with “amount M.” The model will retain what matters—the logic and wording—while your secrets stay with you.

20. Is AI spying on me through the microphone?

There are situations when the microphone is active—but usually with your permission and for a clear purpose: a voice assistant waits for a wake word, a video-calling app listens only during the call, and a translator listens while translating. There is no point in services keeping the microphone on around the clock: processing voice takes place on servers and costs money. Permissions are another matter: some apps request access to the microphone, cameras, and location even when they have no real need for them. Your digital hygiene: open your phone's settings from time to time and clean up the list of permissions; disable microphone access for programs that have no legitimate reason to use it; ask yourself, "Why does this app need my location?" This isn't paranoia—it's ordinary self-care.

21. Can AI deceive me?

It can, and it's important to say that plainly: a model responds plausibly, not truthfully. It can easily invent "facts" in a confident tone, while criminals use AI for phishing: fake emails "from your bank," fabricated voices and videos of famous people, and sophisticated scams. Protection comes from habits: don't transfer money based on a single call or email, even if the voice sounds like someone close to you—hang up and call back using a number you know; be wary when someone rushes you—"act immediately or you'll lose everything" is a classic scammer's tactic; seek a second opinion from family and friends. AI is a tool, and whether it is used for good or evil depends on the person using it. Your awareness—including staying calm when something feels "urgent and frightening"—is your strongest protection.

22. What are deepfakes, and how can I protect myself from them?

A deepfake is an image, video, or voice created by a neural network so that it appears a real person is saying or doing something that never happened. The technology can replace a face, alter a voice, or put words in someone else's mouth. Such a video may be an innocent joke, or it may be used to deceive: "Your boss wants you to transfer money," or "Your daughter is calling in a panic." Protection is built on habits: if someone asks you for money or secrets, hang up and call back using a number you know; ask a question that only your person would know the answer to; use a family codeword for emergencies; view unexpected videos "from people you know" with a critical eye, especially when they create a sense of urgency. And remember: if a video seems strange—too smooth, with odd reflections or unnatural facial expressions—that is a reason to verify, not panic.

23. Is it true that AI collects my biometric data?

Some services do work with biometric data—usually with your consent and for a clear purpose: face-unlock, photo enhancement, or sleep analysis using sensors. This data may be sent to the company's servers and stored there. But websites and apps that promise "aura analysis from a palm photo" or a "diagnosis from a photograph" are almost always scams or attempts to collect data for sale: no form of "AI diagnosis" works from a single image. Your rule of thumb: think about why the service needs what it is asking for; read where the data goes, at least the main points; enable on-device processing where available; don't send photos of documents or faces to dubious services. Your biometrics belong to you: share them only with someone you trust for a legitimate purpose, not in exchange for attractive promises.

24. What is a "digital footprint," and how do I leave one?

Every conversation you have with a chatbot, every search query, every generated image, and every voice response is data that remains on servers. Together, these form your "digital footprint": a history of your interests, activities, fears, and loved ones. A footprint is not a crime in itself—but it is an asset that is traded and could be used against you. Managing your footprint is a skill: write fewer identifying details; use a pseudonym where appropriate; read the privacy policy at least for its key points; delete old conversations; for sensitive topics, use a separate service with privacy settings. Treat your footprint like a letter that others may read: write only what you would not be embarrassed to show a friend. This habit removes most risks without a single paranoid overreaction.

Block 4. Work and professions

25. Will AI take my job?

It will probably change it—and that is more honest than a frightening headline. AI takes on fragments of work: drafts, sorting, searching, standard replies, and data processing. In some professions, tasks will decrease; in others, new ones will appear, such as configuring, checking, and "taming" AI. Those whose work consists entirely of repetitive actions will face difficulties, as will those unwilling to learn new things. But "the machine took the profession" is always also a story about people adapting: the types of tasks change, while people remain needed wherever judgment, care, responsibility, and human contact matter. Your plan is

simple: look closely at your work, find three tasks that resemble routine, start handing them over to AI, and use the time you free up for what you enjoy and what only you can do. That way, you stay ahead of change instead of having to catch up with it.

26. Which professions will not disappear?

A careful answer: those where people are chosen for their humanity. This means work involving care for the body and soul—medicine, caregiving, teaching, and education; work involving trust and risk—lawyers, financial advisers, and captains; crafts that require hands, experience, and taste; creative work carried out under a personal name, where the audience follows the person rather than the generator; and work in unpredictable places, where the environment changes and requires real-time adaptability. They all have one thing in common: live presence is valued—in a hospital room, on a worksite, in an argument, or at the kitchen stove. An AI assistant will strengthen such professions rather than replace them: doctors will have more time for patients, and craftspeople more time for their clients. So don't reinvent yourself as an "AI specialist"; simply add this skill to whatever profession you already have, and you'll become stronger in it.

27. What is a "prompt engineer"? Is it a profession?

A prompt engineer is someone who professionally devises requests so that AI produces the desired result. At the beginning of the AI boom, this was seen as the "profession of the future," with promises of untold riches. Today, the picture is more honest: a good prompt is not magic but the ability to think—to specify the goal, context, limitations, and format, and to ask for a check. This skill is needed in almost any profession, while a dedicated "prompt engineer" position exists only at some companies; more often, the skill is part of other roles. In other words, a prompt is not a profession but basic literacy in a new environment, just as the ability to work with spreadsheets eventually became a universal skill. Start mastering it right now on your own tasks: the better you formulate a request, the stronger your professional profile becomes, whatever you do.

28. Which skills matter most in a world with AI?

The ones AI cannot do well: critical thinking—the ability to doubt and check, even when an answer sounds convincing; the ability to ask questions and notice what has been left unsaid; responsibility for decisions made; understanding people,

their feelings, and their context; the ability to work in a team and explain complex things simply; physical and emotional care; taste and a personal point of view in creative work. Alongside these comes a new technical minimum: understanding what AI can do and how to ask it, being able to check the result, and knowing how to say, “This is where a real person is needed.” The good news is that these skills develop in ordinary life—through reading, discussion, practice, and questions. You don’t need to retrain as an “IT woman”; it is enough to learn to be thoughtful and careful, with AI as your assistant in all your routines.

29. What is the automation of work, and what should we do about it?

Automation is when a repetitive action starts being performed by a program, freeing up a person. It is not limited to AI: calculators automated arithmetic, spreadsheets automated calculations, and AI has reached text, images, and reasoning. The threat is not automation itself: a vacuum cleaner did not “take housework away from housekeepers”—it took away the routine. The same is true here: if half of your work is routine, some of it will soon shift to software, but responsibility and decision-making will remain yours. The sensible response is to calculate how much time you spend on repetitive tasks each week, then take one routine at a time and teach AI to perform it, checking the result, of course. This way, you learn to “own” the technology gradually, without fear or loss of quality. Those who master this approach gain time—and can spend it on what is alive: family, creativity, rest, and themselves.

30. Do you need to be afraid of being left behind—of “missing the AI train”?

No, and here’s why. Languages do not “run out”: people learn technologies throughout their lives, and AI has no shifting rankings after which “everything is over.” What matters is not when you started but what you are doing now: you are already reading this book and this extension, which is more than most people are doing. The fear of being “too late” is usually a fear of uncertainty, and AI feeds it very effectively with advertisements for “courses for horizon chasers.” The reassurance is simple: basic skills (setting a task and checking the result) can be learned in a week or two through practice, without expensive courses. The ability to develop in general is something you already have: as an adult, you can learn any technology one steady step at a time. So don’t chase the train—get on at the next stop: choose one task for the week and do it with AI. The rest will follow.

31. How is AI used in hiring—and what can you do about it?

Companies are increasingly using AI in recruitment: filtering CVs, looking for “suitable indicators,” sometimes communicating with candidates through chatbots, and even analysing video responses. This creates both convenience and risks: an algorithm may reject you because of formal details (an unconventional CV or a career break) simply because similar patterns appeared in its training data. What can you do? Write your CV in a structured way and tailor it to each vacancy, using keywords from the advertisement but without lying; study the requirements and repeat their wording when describing your experience; prepare for a bot interview just as you would for a live one—clearly and to the point; and before meeting a real person, use AI to rehearse likely questions. And remember: legally and fairly, hiring decisions are made by people, and your task is to make yourself visible to both people and algorithms.

Block 5. Creativity and copyright

32. Can something created with AI be considered creative work?

Yes, if there is something of you in what was created. A good analogy is that a camera does not automatically make someone a photographer, but two people photographing the same scene produce different works—because behind the frame lie choices, taste, and a sense of the moment. The same is true of AI: choosing the subject, formulating the idea, selecting from the options, editing, and adding meaning are genuine creative efforts by a person. You are more often the author of the direction and taste than the person executing every line. The honest approach is to call things what they are: “made with the help of AI,” especially when people’s trust is at stake. And remember: the generator does not carry the author’s vision—it carries out yours. If your choices and your emotion are present in the work, it is yours, just as a photograph is yours even though it was “made” by a device. Over time, you will develop your own sense of proportion—how much AI, and how much of yourself.

33. Who owns text or an image created with AI?

The legal answer is complicated and varies from country to country: a work “not created by a human” may not be protected by copyright at all, or may be protected only partially, depending on how much creative input the person contributed. So it is better to ask the question differently: do you own the result in terms of the rights granted by the companies? Read the terms of the service you use: many state that the result belongs to the user, but some grant the

service broader rights, and in certain exceptional cases the ability to modify the result may be limited. A good habit is to check the rules of the specific tool and consult a lawyer for commercial projects; for personal creative work, don't worry: your memories and portfolio are not going anywhere. And always put your own name on the work—with a note saying "created with the participation of AI." It is honest and fashionable.

34. Does AI steal ideas from artists and writers?

A model does not "steal" in the legal sense: it does not copy files but learns from examples, much as students learn from books. Still, the debate continues, and lawsuits do exist. The truth is that AI really has absorbed huge amounts of other people's work, often without the creators' permission or payment—that is the main argument made by critics. It can also reproduce the recognizable style of a particular artist if you ask insistently enough—and that already affects the income and reputation of living people. It's important for you to know both sides. As a user, choose services with licenses, don't generate work "in the style of such-and-such an artist" for sale, and disclose AI involvement. As a creative person, keep track of your rights: publish your work, record dates, monitor commercial use, and hire a lawyer if you are harmed.

35. Can you use AI in your work as a designer, copywriter, or blogger?

Yes—but honestly and according to the rules. Employers and clients care about how quickly you work and whether you take responsibility for the result, so hiding your use of AI is a poor strategy: sooner or later, the model's style will give it away, and your reputation will suffer. Openly using it, by contrast, is a plus: "I make the drafts with AI, then I assemble, check, and take responsibility for them." Practical rules: don't promise anything the machine produced without you; check every fact in its response, especially figures, quotations, and regulations; submit only work you have read through and approved; and agree on your approach with clients and employers in advance so that no one ends up "clutching their head." And remember: always maintain your skills without AI—the technology changes, but your expertise remains yours.

36. How can you avoid losing your voice and style while working with AI?

The trap is real: global models write alike, and if you simply copy their text, your work will start to resemble everyone else's. The solution is simple: a draft is material, not the finished piece. Develop your own ritual: ask AI to write several

versions, then choose one, rewrite it in your own words, add details from your life, remove the bureaucratic language, and insert your own stories, jokes, and specifics. Read your work aloud: if the wording “smells like a machine,” rewrite it. It is useful to write texts entirely without AI from time to time—it’s like muscle memory: if you want your voice not to fade, you need to keep speaking in it. And develop yourself away from the screen: experiences, walks, people, books—everything you live becomes fuel for your writing. AI speeds up your work; it does not replace you—as long as every text contains a piece of your life, your voice will not be lost.

37. How can you protect your work from AI?

Completely? Almost impossible. If your text or images are publicly available, they may end up in training datasets, and services are not required to notify you. But there are sensible steps you can take: watermark major works; publish the essentials in a compressed form—parts that cannot be used in full without context; check the terms of the platforms you upload to, and do not grant them excessively broad rights; record creation dates and save your drafts—these are evidence in a dispute; and be aware that legislation concerning “the right to creative work against machine learning” is changing, so follow the news in your country. And one more thing: protect not only against copying but also people’s “privacy-sensitive” photographs—don’t post other people’s faces without their consent, and, please, neither should algorithms.

Block 6. Children, family, and passing on experience

38. Should you allow your child to use AI?

Yes—with you, according to clear rules and the child’s age. Young children—not yet of preschool age—do not need AI at all: they need real play, books, and human interaction. With older children, it is useful to explain what this thing is: what it can and cannot do, that “a bot is not a person but can pretend to be one,” and that they must not share their name, address, school, or password with it. It is useful to identify “safe” use cases: asking a chatbot about a homework lesson, asking it to explain a word, or coming up with an idea for a craft. A good approach is: show them first, then ask the child to explain what they understood, and only afterward let them try under supervision. A child’s account should also have safety filters and time limits enabled. AI will not

replace you as a parent—it can become a fun shared toy and a topic of conversation at the kitchen table.

39. Will AI replace teachers and tutors?

No—and here is the unromantic reason. AI is excellent at explaining material, providing practice, repeating something a hundred times patiently, and never getting tired—it is a powerful “trainer.” But a human teacher does what an algorithm cannot: they see this particular child, their confusion and their sudden spark of interest; they know when to encourage them; they know the family; they set an example; they explain things with the child’s personality in mind. So this is not an “either-or” conversation but a “together” one: a tutor can delegate routine checking and repetition to AI, while focusing on the most human aspects—discussion skills, motivation, and psychology. A child who knows how to use AI to ask questions will come to a human teacher prepared and bright-eyed. This is already happening, and it will continue to happen.

40. How can you teach a schoolchild to check what AI says?

Step by step, using personal examples. Show them how to ask, “How do you know that?” and how to find the source together in a search engine. Turn checking a “fact” into a game: “Let’s bet this is wrong,” then use a search to confirm or disprove it. Explain that “confident wording” does not mean “truth,” using real examples: ask the model to make something up, and let the child see how easily it can invent a source. Establish a family rule: anything “urgent” is a reason to double-check. Explain why you cannot trust attractive quotations without a source, and how manipulation is used in advertising and the news. And, most importantly, lead by example: let your child see you doubt yourself, search for answers, ask specialists again, and admit, “I’ll double-check.” Your habit of questioning is the best honest filter you can pass on to children through the family’s shared picture of the world.

41. Can AI help me prepare lessons with my child?

It can—and this is an excellent, safe use: ask the model how to explain a topic more simply; ask it to come up with fun examples, generate practice flashcards, invent a puzzle-solving exercise, check whether a teenager completed a math problem correctly (showing the solution), or suggest timely questions for discussing literature. But keep the roles clear: AI is an assistant in preparing the lesson; you are the guide to its meaning. Don’t have AI do a child’s homework: that is the same as copying from the internet, and it deprives them of practice—

when the exam comes, there will be nothing left to draw from their own head. The technique “explain it to me so I can understand” works, and it is worth learning and passing on: let your child learn to act as a translator between the textbook and the model—that is a superpower in modern education.

42. What should you do if your child gets glued to an AI chatbot?

First, stay calm and avoid making a scene—find out what kind of chatbot it is: a chat for helpful support or an advertising-driven “bot friend”? Set time limits, as you would with books and cartoons; agree on openness: “Shall we read the conversation?”—let your child show you what they find interesting. Look at the reasons: if there are few “real-life” friends and conversations, no bot can replace a quiet evening with the family, sports, and clubs. Talk about what draws your child to the bot (it always answers and never judges), and think about how to provide that in real life: your time, warm support, and a cosy, non-judgmental conversation. If your child has a hard time breaking away from the AI or the bot encourages dangerous things, set boundaries and talk to a psychologist. AI is a tool with its own powerful magnetism; a parent’s task is to make the real world no less interesting than the digital one.

Block 7. Learning and personal development

43. Can AI help adults learn—languages, a profession, anything?

It can, and this is one of its best roles. Adults have little time and many inhibitions—“What if I ask something stupid?”, “The textbook is boring”, “There’s nowhere to practise.” AI removes all those obstacles: it can explain a rule at any time, tailor practice to you, play the role of a conversation partner in a foreign language, gently correct and praise you like a patient tutor, and break a complex topic down step by step. For a new profession, ask for a learning plan based on your goal, an interview with questions, or an analysis of your answers. One “but”: a model does not provide a current course or certificate, does not know the requirements of this year’s specific exam, and may idealise “popular topics”. So check the framework of any plan against official syllabuses; the practice is up to you. AI does not learn for you—it gives you a simulator and a mentor on the sofa, whenever it suits you.

44. How can you avoid copying and actually learn with AI?

Copying means taking a ready-made result and passing it off as your own,

without understanding it. Learning with AI means using a tool to help you understand and do the work. The difference lies in your intention and your process. Honest methods: ask it to explain a topic, then retell it in your own words; solve a problem yourself and have AI check it and point out the mistake; ask it to create similar problems for practice; use it as a “study partner”—prepare questions from your notes and ask it to quiz you. Forbidden methods: immediately taking a ready-made essay, report, or answer and “spinning” it into different wording. Who will take the exam for you? University rules are already changing—AI is allowed in some places and restricted in others. Read the regulations for your programme so your journey does not end with, “What was that for?” And ask yourself: are you learning to become smarter, or merely to survive the assessment? Your future depends on the answer.

Block 8. Health and self-care

45. Can AI diagnose symptoms?

Services offer “symptom analysis”, but these are only suggestions, not diagnoses. A model repeats typical scenarios—“a fever and cough are more often caused by a cold”—but it cannot see you, examine you, ask about your medical history, or assess test results. Worse, in a harmless situation it may frighten you into panic, while in a dangerous one it may reassure you and delay a visit to the doctor. So the rule is strict: you may use it to prepare questions for a doctor and decipher unfamiliar terms; for self-diagnosis and treatment, never. No “AI diagnosis” is a reason to buy medication or cancel an appointment. Health is an area where a bot assistant can suggest a list of questions for your appointment, but the decision always belongs to a real doctor who has seen you and is responsible for the outcome.

46. Can AI help with mental health?

It can—as an assistant, not a therapist. It works well for mood-diary apps, “judgment-free conversation” at night, relaxation techniques, putting your feelings into words, and searching for “how to tell a psychologist that I’m not doing well”; many people genuinely feel a little better as a result. Especially those who are shy about talking to people. But boundaries matter: AI cannot diagnose “depression”, replace a real psychologist or a crisis line—and even if it writes “seek help”, those are template words, not genuine care. For serious conditions, real hotlines and specialists are available. A good practice is to use AI

as a “draft for a conversation”—to record your feelings, organise your thoughts, and prepare for a visit to a specialist—but to make the actual visit in real life.

47. What must you not do with AI when the question concerns your health?

The list is short, but important: do not diagnose yourself, choose medications or dosages, stop prescribed treatment, make decisions on behalf of loved ones, or treat the first answer as a source. A model may beautifully explain how a method “works”, but it has no information about you: your age, weight, chronic conditions, medication interactions, or test results. It has no sense of responsibility. There is also a direct risk of error: it may simply get a dosage wrong or mix up drug interactions—and you will bear the consequences. What you can do is prepare questions for your doctor, record symptoms in a structured way (“what, when, and under what circumstances”), look for materials in clear language, prepare a “cheat sheet” for your appointment, and check your notes. Anything medical belongs with a doctor; AI merely helps structure the conversation between you.

Block 9. Ethics, society, and the future

48. Who is responsible for what AI has done or said?

A person. And this is not a scare tactic—it has legal and practical consequences. You are responsible for what goes out in your name: a letter, report, post, or decision. The company is responsible for how its product works: its promised quality, safety, and AI labelling. If an error made possible by its capabilities violates someone’s rights, all parties involved may potentially be investigated, but in practice responsibility follows the person who used it. So your personal ethics are simple: do not shift onto a machine what requires judgement and entails consequences; check and sign off on important things; take ownership by saying, “I did this, and I am responsible.” It is this position—not “the bot is to blame”—that makes you a professional people want to work with.

49. Will AI eventually become dangerous?

The danger is not in a film-style “machine uprising”, but in the places where people stop thinking: blindly trusting answers, failing to check important information, handing algorithms other people’s fates without oversight, and using AI for deception and leaks. The dangerous ones are not “thinking

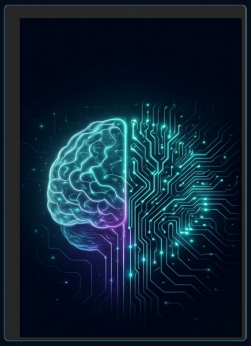
machines”, but those who benefit from you not thinking. That is why ethics is personal: critical thinking, transparency, and responsibility. The social side is rules: laws on AI-generated advertising, protection against forgeries, and personal data are being formed right now, and your awareness influences which ones are adopted. The future is not predetermined; it is shaped by your habits today. AI is like electricity: safe in an outlet, useful in practice, and deserving of respect for the rules governing its use.

50. Where to start so you’re not afraid, but can actually use it?

With three habits. First: play and learn—each week, take one task from your day and do it with AI: a menu, a letter, a lesson plan, a rephrasing. Second: check—don’t trust blindly—verify important information in three sources, clarify anything recent, and cross-check facts and figures against the original source: this habit takes hold in a month. Third: ask yourself, “What here is mine, what is AI’s, and who is responsible?” so you don’t turn into a human copy machine. And keep ethics in mind: who are you sharing the results with? Don’t fake things or misrepresent their origin. Fifty questions behind you—now it’s your turn: choose one from the list and take a walk with it through AI, as if it were an interesting book. The rest will follow: technologies change, but the habits of thinking and checking stay with you, whatever the future brings.

PART 2. GLOSSARY IN PLAIN ENGLISH

AI terms pour out of the news and conversations like confetti. Here are the most important ones, explained without the tedium, with examples from everyday life. You can read the glossary straight through or dip into it whenever you come across an unfamiliar word. There are more than thirty concepts here—from “algorithm” to “embeddings.”



1. Artificial Intelligence (AI)

A general name for technologies that perform tasks requiring “intelligence”: understanding speech, recognizing faces, writing texts, and translating. It is an umbrella term encompassing neural networks, algorithms, robots, and much more. Important: the “intelligence” in the name is a metaphor; behind it are mathematics and data. Example: autocomplete in messaging apps is a small AI that guesses your words. It is useful not to look for a hidden meaning in the word “intelligence”: a machine is not self-aware, but it can be excellent at solving its assigned tasks. When newspapers write “AI did this or that,” they usually mean “a program trained on data did this or that”—which is much less alarming.

2. Algorithm

A precise sequence of steps a program follows to solve a problem: “do this, then that, then check.” It is like a recipe—mix, add, wait, stir. Algorithms appeared long before modern AI; they powered file sorting, internet searches, and banking calculations. AI also uses algorithms internally, but training makes it more flexible than a rigid set of instructions. Example: for years, email services hid spam in the “spam” folder using rule-based algorithms; modern filters continue learning from emails. Understanding that “an algorithm is an instruction” helps you read the news calmly: a “bad algorithm” is a mistake by the author of the instructions, not maliciousness on the machine’s part.

3. Machine Learning

A way of teaching a program through examples rather than rules. Instead of giving the machine a list of rules, a person shows it thousands of samples: “this

is a picture of a cat, this is a dog.” The program adjusts itself until it begins to recognize patterns. It is like how you recognize a friend’s handwriting: first you look at it, then you pick up on its common features. The practical consequence is this: the quality of a machine depends on the quality of its examples. Too little data means errors; distorted data means bias. When you hear that “a model was trained well,” you know it refers to data and many dozens of hours of computation, not to “a machine that went to school.”

4. Neural Network

A program modeled on the living brain: countless simple elements— “neurons”—connected by millions of links. Each neuron receives a signal, processes it slightly, and passes it on. During training, the connections are adjusted so that the answers are correct more and more often. A helpful analogy is an orchestra without a conductor, in which each musician listens to the others and adjusts a little—and the music eventually sounds harmonious. Neural networks are at the heart of what we call AI today: translation, facial recognition, and voice assistants. The main thing is not to be frightened by the word “neural”: it evokes the brain, but this is all mathematics and data—there is no consciousness here.

5. Large Language Model (LLM)

A neural network trained to predict the next word from an enormous quantity of text. It is what gives chatbots the ability to converse: inventing a poem, summarizing an article, explaining science. “Large” because it contains billions of adjustable parameters. “Language” because it works with language. It is important to understand that it is neither a database nor the internet: the model generates answers probabilistically, so it may sound very confident and still be wrong. The very program you are chatting with in a chatbot is a large language model. When someone says “it thinks,” remember: in reality, it skillfully completes words according to probability.

6. Prompt

A request you write to a program: “create a week-long menu using three ingredients,” “rewrite this letter to make it more polite.” The quality of the answer depends greatly on the quality of the request: the clearer the goal, context, and constraints, the better the result. Think of a prompt as assigning a task to a subordinate: if you say, “Do something,” don’t expect much; if you say, “Give me an omelet recipe for two servings, without onions, that takes ten minutes,” you will get exactly that. The ability to formulate a prompt is basic

literacy for a new era: even on your first attempt, you will probably do reasonably well, and with practice you will keep improving. It is a skill, not magic.

7. Prompt Engineering

The art and craft of composing requests that make a chatbot produce exactly what you need: the right goal, the right details, and the right answer format. This is not mastery of magic spells but clear logic: why do I need this (the goal), what should be taken into account (the context), what is not allowed (the constraints), and what form should the result take (the format). Example: instead of “write an article,” say, “write a 500-word article about cats for a cat breeders’ magazine, in a light tone, with practical advice and fact-checking.” Today, this skill is as important as knowing how to use search engines once was. You can learn it in a week of practice: remember what worked and repeat successful formulations.

8. Token

A little block into which a program breaks your request and its own answers: a word, part of a word, or sometimes even a symbol. The number of tokens measures the length of the text a model works with; it also determines message limits in subscription plans. In Russian, words usually take more tokens than they do in English, so some services are “heavier” for Russian text. You usually do not need to count tokens, but it is useful to know that if a bot replies, “Request too long” or “Limit reached,” you have run into the token limit. The solution is simple: shorten the introduction, divide the task into several messages, and remove unnecessary flourishes.

9. Temperature (in AI settings)

A generation setting that determines how random and “creative” the answers will be. Low temperature means precision, dryness, and minimal imagination—for facts, calculations, and formal correspondence. High temperature means more surprises, literary flair, and playfulness—for ideas, stories, and brainstorming. Imagine a word-association game: at low temperature, given the word “ball,” the model will answer “round”; at high temperature, “a ball is the victory of the playground.” In most services, the temperature is already configured for the task, but if there is a slider in the settings, now you know which way to move it: down for reliability, up for inspiration.

10. Hallucination (in AI)

This is what happens when a model confidently presents something made up as real: nonexistent books, quotations, sources, biographies, figures. It is not a malfunction, nor is it “lying on purpose”: the program completes the text so convincingly that it cannot distinguish fact from fantasy—it does not check anything. The practical takeaway: treat any important answer as a draft, not a verdict. Check the key facts against primary sources and ask the model to state clearly what it is confident about. Treat hallucinations like rainy weather: it happens, you already have an umbrella, nothing terrible, just check.

11. Dataset

A collection of data used to train and test a model: texts, photographs, audio recordings. A dataset is a machine’s “universe of examples.” Whatever is inside the dataset is what the machine learns: if there is a lot of news, it will be strong in the news style; if one opinion outweighs the others, its answers will lean in that direction. Almost every debate about “why AI is biased” can be traced back to the dataset level: the machine has become an honest mirror of imperfect data. An ordinary user cannot see the datasets, but knowing about them helps explain why different models give different answers and why some topics come more easily to them than others.

12. Supervised learning

A way of training in which the program is shown examples together with the correct answers: “this is spam, and this is a good email,” “this is a scan of a healthy lung, and this one is diseased.” The model adjusts itself so that its outputs match the answer prompts. It is like working with a tutor: exercise—solution—check. This approach is used for facial recognition, spam filtering, and image-based diagnosis. It comes at a cost: people label the data manually, which is slow and expensive. That is why supervised learning is often combined with other approaches, conserving the costly labelled examples.

13. Unsupervised learning

A method in which the program is given data without any prompts, and finds groups and patterns on its own. For example: give it thousands of emails, and the model will automatically sort them into “personal—work— newsletters”—no one told it how. It is similar to arriving in a new city and noticing for yourself where the cafés, offices, and parks are, without any guidebooks. The same approach can detect anomalies—a strange card expense, a sudden spike in unusual applications—and group customers. The key point for you: a machine

may spot a connection a person would not have noticed—and vice versa: a connection may be visible, but not causal. Correlation is not yet causation.

14. Reinforcement learning

A method in which the program tries out actions, while a person or system awards points for success and “penalizes” failures. The model looks for the path that earns the most points. This is how AI learned to play chess and Go better than humans, and how chatbots learn to give polite answers. It is like training a dog: a treat for following a command, a firm “no” for a mistake. This is useful to understand in conversations: “trained with reinforcement learning” means that the machine has a goal and rewards designed by people. That means the values and mistakes of those designers leave their imprint inside the model—another reason to check answers and ask questions.

15. Transformer

A feature of neural-network architecture that sparked a revolution in 2017: an attention mechanism for important parts of the text, because all the words are considered globally rather than “one at a time” as before. Nearly all modern language models are built on transformers; its famous name is more a metaphor drawn from an iron than from a robot. The main thing to understand is that transformers are what made chatbots so smooth and coherent. You will not need the technical details, but the word has been everywhere in the news ever since—and now it need not frighten you: architecture, not magic.

16. Attention (mechanism)

The internal mechanism of a transformer that determines which words in a query deserve more weight. In the sentence “she left the bag on the table and left,” the model calculates that “table” matters more than “left” for the question “where is the bag?” It is just like a person reading an article: rather than memorizing everything indiscriminately, they follow the central details. Attention is one of the main reasons modern language models are so good at long summaries and translations: they see the entire context at once and assign importance to it, rather than reading linearly “from beginning to end.”

17. Fine-tuning (further training)

The process of refining a trained model on a small set of your data so that it responds in your style: corporate vocabulary, your signature email tone, your

own response rules. Imagine taking a general “encyclopedia” and turning it into “the support desk of one particular company.” For an ordinary user, fine-tuning is available through ready-made tools and services: collect examples of “good answer—bad answer,” upload them to a builder, and get your own small model. The better the examples you upload, the better the result. Such tuning, of course, requires care: the model may learn something undesirable if the examples were sloppy.

18. Generative AI

AI that creates something new: text, images, music, or video. It does not “classify” or “search”; it produces content based on your description. Usually, families of these models generate things on request: a poem, a winter landscape, promotional copy for a post. “New” in the technical sense means a combination based on what was learned, so debates about authorship and plagiarism are legitimate and complicated. Practically, one thing matters for you: generating is easy, but taking responsibility for the result is your job. Checking the style and facts, as well as the ethics of the original text, remains the human’s responsibility, as with any creative work involving a tool.

19. Multimodal (multi-mode) models

Models that work with text, images, sound, and video all at once: they understand photos and answer about them in text, hear a voice, and tell you things based on images. You ask, “what kind of mushroom is in the photo—can it be wrong?”—and receive a detailed answer about the image. This is useful in everyday life: photograph the instructions on a box and ask, “what should I do at home if”; photograph an ingredient label and find out which items are allergens. Keep your expectations honest: the model sees distinctive features and associations, but it does not “see the world” as you do—so for anything important (for example, “is this mushroom edible?”), you need a person.

20. Embedding

A way to turn a word, phrase, or piece of text into a string of numbers in which words with similar meanings end up close together. “Cat” and “kitten” will be near each other, while “legal” will be far from “kitty.” This numerical space is a “map of meanings”: by looking at how close points are, we can find similar documents, similar job openings, and similar posts. Embeddings are invisible: they help search find what you need even when the wording of the question and the wording of the text found do not match. That is what makes modern search

work “by meaning” rather than by exact wording—and why it works so briskly in both search engines and smart databases.

21. Chatbot

A program you communicate with in a dialogue window: you type a question — you get an answer. Modern chatbots run on large language models, so they can sustain extended conversations: they clarify, ask follow-up questions, and remember the context of the current exchange. Chatbots are found in messengers, banks, shops, on company websites, and in standalone apps. It’s important to remember: behind the politeness and liveliness of the exchange there is no personality — just a convenient “door” into a service. You ask a question — the bot responds according to its data and limitations. So when it comes to important topics (money, health, and the law), treat it like a reference desk: once you get an answer, check it against the original source and a relevant specialist.

22. AI agent

A new generation of programs that don’t just answer questions but perform a chain of actions: “book a table,” “compare the plans and send me three options,” “compile a report from these files.” An agent breaks a large task down into steps, contacts the necessary services on its own, and comes back with the result. This is a shift from “consultant” to “employee.” For now, agents make mistakes more often than we’d like, and you need to check their actions yourself, but they are precisely what the future of convenient services is built around. For you, this means that complex tasks (planning, shopping, correspondence) will soon be handled with one short instruction. Your role in this chain is to define the task and check the result, not to trust blindly.

23. Context window

The model’s “working memory”: the amount of text it can take into account at the same time when replying. This includes your request, attached documents, and the entire current conversation. If the window is small, long documents won’t fit, and the bot “forgets” the beginning of the conversation. If it’s large, you can send an entire book and ask questions about it. When a bot can’t process a long file or loses the thread of the conversation, the problem is the context window, not “poor memory” in the human sense. The solution: break the task into parts, summarize the essentials, and start a new chat for a new task. Understanding the context window protects you from unnecessary

disappointment in the technology.

24. Diffusion model

The technology behind many “artist” bots that generate images. The idea is almost poetic: during training, a neural network learns to turn an image into “noise” — and then reconstruct it from that noise. When generating an image, the model starts with a random “seed,” that is, a random point in the noise, and gradually “develops” the image while following your description. This explains its characteristics: the same prompt produces different versions each time (the noise is new each time), while small details — fingers, letters, and symmetry — often come out wonky. In practice: request three or four versions, choose the best one, and refine it with words. A realistic understanding of how it works protects you from blindly marveling at “masterpieces” in your feeds.

25. Speech recognition and synthesis

Two sides of the same coin: a program turns speech into text (recognition) and text into speech (synthesis). This is how voice assistants on phones, video subtitles, transcriptions of voice notes, and read-aloud books work. The technology has become remarkably natural-sounding: sometimes it’s difficult to tell where a “live” voice ends and a synthetic one begins. For you, it’s convenient — you can talk to a bot, dictate long texts, and listen to articles on the go. When it comes to safety, be careful: synthesis is used for forgeries, in calls or audio messages from someone else. So always confirm important arrangements through known channels: in writing or by calling a number you know yourself.

26. Computer vision

The branch of AI that teaches programs to “see”: to recognize faces, objects, text in photos, gestures, and scenes. Its applications are everywhere: camera autofocus, photo search, face unlock, augmented-reality filters, quality control in manufacturing, and assistants for people with visual impairments. It doesn’t work like an eye; it is more like a highly thorough statistical check of pixel patterns. A machine can make mistakes in unusual conditions — darkness, a different angle, camouflage — and may work poorly with people with dark skin if the training data were unbalanced. This leads to two conclusions: take news about “miraculous vision” with a grain of salt, and a responsible service should offer the option of speaking to a real person.

27. Recommendation systems

Algorithms that predict what you will “like”: which feed to show you, which film to recommend, and which product to put in front of you in a shop. They learn from your clicks: what you opened, what you watched to the end, and what you bought. There is a downside: it benefits the system not to “make you smarter” but to “keep you on the screen,” so the feed gradually narrows to the familiar and easy to understand, while the new and challenging gets washed out. This is called an information bubble. Your digital hygiene: click on something unexpected from time to time, subscribe intentionally, and seek a range of opinions on important topics. A recommendation is a tool; it’s better for you, not the model, to decide what to watch and read.

28. Personal data

Any information that can be used to identify a person: name, phone number, address, passport details, geolocation, photographs, correspondence, and behavioral characteristics. The laws of different countries (in Russia, the Personal Data Law) regulate this: data may be collected and processed with consent, transparently, and proportionately to the purpose. In the context of AI, every request you make, document you upload, photo, and voice recording is data. Your rights include knowing what is collected, withdrawing consent, requesting deletion, and understanding who stores it and where. A useful habit: before using a new service, look for its data processing policy and honestly ask yourself — am I comfortable with the worst reasonable scenario? If not, don’t use it: that is your right.

29. Content moderation

Systems that automatically filter content: removing insults, spam, violations, and dangerous appeals from comments, feeds, and conversations with bots. Following rules and examples, a moderation model decides what “isn’t allowed” and hides or blocks it. It works quickly and everywhere, but crudely: sometimes it catches innocent people (a false positive), and sometimes it lets a hidden violation through. What matters for you: if a bot suddenly refuses to answer or its response seems “censored,” moderation may have been triggered — not some “personal offense taken by the machine.” And when working with generative AI, keep in mind: after a crude or dangerous request, the service may simply not produce an image — this is a safety measure, not “the censor’s opinion.”

30. Deepfake

A photo, video, or audio recording created by a neural network so that a real person appears to say or do something that never happened. Faces are swapped both for jokes and for fraud: a fake “director” calls by video, or fake celebrity accounts ask you to transfer money. The best protection is to confirm important requests through a second independent channel, agree with your loved ones on a secret “code word” for emergencies, and be wary of unexpected urgency and requests for money. It is becoming increasingly difficult to spot a deepfake by eye, so a verification procedure — “I’ll call you back myself,” “message me in another messenger” — is more reliable than staring closely at the image.

31. Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF)

A method of fine-tuning language models with human involvement: experts rate tens of thousands of responses — “this one is good, this one is false, this one is rude” — and the model learns to adapt to those ratings. This is how chatbots are made polite, useful and generally “well-mannered”. The advantage is that the model better understands what people expect. The disadvantage is that the ratings reflect the opinions and values of a particular developer company. What matters for you is to understand: “right” for a bot means a human assessment of certain agreed-upon values, not the law and not the truth. So give the model your own boundaries (“stick to the facts, don’t flatter me, point out uncertainty”) rather than placing complete trust in someone else’s “good manners”.

32. Bias (model bias)

A situation in which a model systematically produces results in favour of some groups and against others: by gender, age, income, nationality or appearance. The cause lies in the data: if stories about leaders in the datasets are associated with men a hundred times more often, the model will “learn” that pattern and repeat it in generation, CV screening and analysis. Models do not “think” about people in a biased way — they statistically repeat distortions in data created by humans. It is important to remember: if a result seems unfair, that is a reason to be suspicious and double-check it; for questions that affect people’s lives — hiring, credit or medical treatment — insist on a human being and an explanation of the decision.

33. Explainability (interpretability) in AI

The ability to understand why a model arrived at a particular answer. With large neural networks containing millions of parameters, an explanation such as “that’s how the coefficients are set up” is difficult even for engineers, and

sometimes impossible. That is why decisions affecting people's lives — credit, sentences, medical prescriptions — are required by the laws of many countries to involve a human and a clear rationale. You have the right to ask, "Why was I refused?" or "Why did I receive this score?" — and to receive a reasoned answer, even if a model was operating behind the scenes. The same principle works in miniature when you talk to a chatbot: ask it to briefly name its sources, assumptions and key verification steps — then check them yourself.

34. The Singularity

A concept from futurism: a hypothetical moment when AI becomes smarter than humans in a broad sense and its further development becomes unpredictable for us. The word is captivating and beloved by journalists, but honestly, it is a speculative hypothesis, not a scientific forecast. There is no evidence that we are heading towards it, and the predicted dates for "thinking machines" have been repeatedly pushed back. What matters for you: don't chase headlines saying "the Singularity is already near". No one knows the future; all we know are trends and uncertainty. That is precisely why it makes sense to develop "human + AI" skills — they are valuable in any scenario: both if AI is everywhere and if strict restrictions are adopted.

35. Strong and weak AI

A distinction that helps you take a clear-eyed view of the headlines. "Weak" (applied) AI means all today's models: they can perform a limited set of tasks within the boundaries of their training. "Strong" (general, AGI) AI is a hypothetical AI that could perform any intellectual work like a human, with a complete understanding of the world. Today we have dozens of "weak" systems, and the distance to "strong" AI is enormous. Everything you see on your phone is weak AI, finely tuned to its particular task. When you read "AI has made a breakthrough", it is almost always applied AI that is being discussed, and the headline exaggerates. This frame of reference makes the news less exciting and more truthful.

36. A framework for responsible AI

A general term for designing and using AI while taking into account safety, fairness, transparency, privacy and accountability. Companies publish internal "responsible AI codes", and governments create regulations — in Europe, the GDPR and the AI Act; elsewhere, their own laws. The practical benefit for you is that when choosing a service, you can ask, "Do you have responsible AI

principles?” — an indirect sign of the organisation’s culture. Even so, protect yourself: check, read, and do not share unnecessary data. Responsible ethics means both the conduct of companies and your own personal habit; both should be practised individually and together.

37. Plugins

Add-ons for large language models that give them “hands”: generate an image, calculate something in a spreadsheet, go online, send an email, create a schedule or open a calendar. Without a plugin, a model has text; with one, it becomes a “digital assistant” with external tools. A practical definition is: a plugin is a tool turned into a superpower. One “but”: a plugin acts in your name — searching, sending and recording — so monitor its permissions and confirm important actions yourself. Otherwise, you may find an email “the model has already sent” among the people it should never have been sent to.

38. Digital hygiene

A set of habits for using technology safely and calmly: keep your device updated, do not open anything suspicious, do not share logins or codes, check sources, use password managers and two-factor authentication, and do not click on everything indiscriminately. Living with AI adds “mental hygiene”: question what seems plausible, handle other people’s data carefully, and read the sections about data. Digital hygiene is as boring as brushing your teeth, but it cheaply protects what matters: your money, reputation and relationships. Do not practise it once a year in a fit of fear; build it up little by little each week, like ordinary self-care.

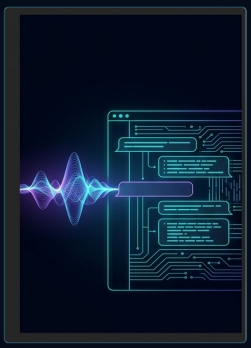
How to expand the glossary yourself

The glossary, of course, does not claim to be comprehensive: dozens of new words appear every year. But these are the essential core for speaking clearly and without panic when discussing the subject with the news, colleagues and children. Once you have mastered these concepts, you will be able to expand the vocabulary confidently yourself: take each unfamiliar word apart using a simple framework — where it appears, what kind of system it relates to, and what consequences it has for life. That way, a “living” glossary will stay with you forever: you become an interpreter of a new era. And now for the most practical part: a prompt library ready to use.---

AN EXTENSION TO THE BOOK “THE MIND OF THE FUTURE” — WORKSHOPS AND PRACTICAL SCENARIOS

> ***How to use this extension.*** *This is not a continuation of the main text but a working tool: independent workshops after each of the seven chapters and eight practical scenarios, “AI in life and career”. There are no new stories or sensational figures here — only things you can try yourself, right now, with a pencil in hand. Open the relevant section whenever you want to turn the knowledge from the book into action. Not managing to do everything is nothing to worry about; one section in an evening is already a good rhythm. An experiment that fails is also a result: you have learned something about yourself and the tool. It is perfectly fine to leave a workshop unfinished and return to it later: this is your own pace, and it is the right one.*

PART I. PRACTICUM AFTER EACH CHAPTER



Each of the seven practicums follows the same structure: a short “why” — why this exercise is worth your time; several exercises of varying depth, from which you can choose one or two; a checklist for a quick review; and blank space for notes, where you can write down thoughts, discoveries, and questions that do not fit into the tables. No practicum promises instant results: change comes not from reading, but from small, repeated actions, and many important shifts become visible only weeks later. That is why the wording here — “try it,” “if you want,” “you may find it useful” — imposes nothing and guarantees nothing. Half an hour of honest work with the question “what does this mean for me?” gives you more than several rereadings of the most inspiring chapter. You are the author of your own path, while the practicums are merely a map with several routes — and they all begin and end with your own decisions.

Practicum 1. After the chapter “Awakening” — your personal discovery

Why this matters now. The first part of the book showed how imperceptibly AI has already entered your everyday life: recommendations, translations, suggestions, filters, autofill — all of it works with almost no involvement from you. This practicum helps turn “I’m interested” into “I noticed this.” Awakening is not a one-time click or a feeling of “wow!”, but a habit of paying attention. You can train this habit, and the training is more enjoyable than you might think: it is like a game of observation, not a school assignment.

Exercise 1.1. Diary of Invisible Helpers (7 days)

Start a page in your notebook or phone notes: seven lines, one for each day. For a week, write down one or two instances each evening when you used, or could have used, an AI tool without thinking of it as a machine: a smart translator, search suggestions, an automatic email reply, a voice assistant, photo filters, music or video recommendations. For each instance, add the sentence: “I used to do this by ____, and now AI helps by ____.” Perfect wording is not necessary: the goal is for your notebook to contain your own honest list by the end of the

week. Look at it as a whole — what surprised you? In which case did you feel grateful, and in which did you feel slightly distrustful? Note one more fact for yourself: how many times AI helped you without asking for anything in return.

Exercise 1.2. Your “before” and “after”

On a separate sheet, draw two columns. On the left, answer honestly: how did you feel about AI a month ago — what did you imagine, what were you afraid of, what did you hope for? On the right, write how you feel about it now, after encountering the ideas in this book. Write in the first person, without fancy turns of phrase: honesty is enough. Then sum it up in one line: “The most unexpected conclusion for me is ____.” This exercise is worth repeating once a month: you will see how your perspective changes, how fears fade and questions arise, and how you move from being a “listener” to being an “explorer.”

Exercise 1.3. A letter to yourself (optional)

If you would like a more personal experience, write yourself a short letter to be read a month from now: what you want to try, what you want to leave behind, and who you see yourself becoming in partnership with AI. Put the letter away — in an envelope or a note with a reminder — and read it in a month. It does not have to come true word for word: a letter is a compass, not a flight plan. Often, the discrepancies between “what I wanted” and “what happened” matter more, telling you more than the coincidences.

Exercise 1.4. Twenty questions for yourself

Once you have completed the first three exercises, give yourself a “solo interview”: open your notes and answer any five questions from the list — one paragraph each, without self-criticism. Which things that I considered “the technology of the future” are already in my home and on my phone? Which words about AI used to make me anxious, but now make me curious? Where has AI already saved me time over the past month, and what did I do with that time? In which matters would I never hand a decision over to AI — and why? Am I afraid that AI will “replace” me, and what can I do to keep that from happening? Which promises in AI advertising seem exaggerated to me? What one skill would I like to develop so that I can feel more confident in the digital world? What does “using AI well” mean to me — in one sentence? How will I know six months from now that this experience has helped me rather than harmed me? You do not need to show your answers to anyone — they are just for you. This is where your real awakening lives: not in grand discoveries, but in these quiet, precise

answers that you say aloud to yourself.

When you are finished, choose the one answer that resonated with you most and write it on a separate card — it will become your working theme for the month. It may grow into any point in the chapters that follow: it is easier to discover where to go next in your own questions than in advice from others.

Questions for reflection

When you have completed the practicum, ask yourself three questions. What discovery of this week was the most unexpected for me, and why this one? What do I now see in my ordinary day that I did not notice before? If I returned to this page in a month, what answer would I want to read, and what would it say about me? Write your answers briefly, without judging them. Read them again in a month: changes in your answers are the visible trace of your awakening — imperceptible from day to day, but obvious when you compare them. You do not have to write much: one honest line about what you feel is worth more than a whole page of “correct” reflections. The practicum is complete when you have taken at least one noticeable step, not when you have read every word. You can reread your answers more often than once a month: even after three days, they will tell you more about your state than any advice from others.

Practicum checklist

- ☐ I noticed at least one AI tool in my ordinary day and named it honestly.
- ☐ I wrote it in my diary of invisible helpers — even if it was just one instance.
- ☐ I answered myself: what did I think before, and what do I think now?
- ☐ I identified one small thing I will try this week.
- ☐ I remember: discovery is a process, not a finish line, and I do not need to know everything at once.

Space for notes

Practicum 2. After the chapter “Understanding” — how AI understands words (and how you understand them)

Why this matters now. Understanding how AI works is not boring theory, but your safety net and, at the same time, a magnifying glass. When you know that AI does not “think” like a human, you stop expecting the impossible from it (and becoming disappointed), while also noticing how useful it can be in situations where it would never have occurred to you to ask for its help. Chapter Two gave you a metaphor and some rules; this practicum anchors them in your own experience.

Exercise 2.1. Checking your mental model

Before rereading the chapter, answer four questions for yourself— in writing, without looking at your notes. First: what happens when you ask AI a question—is it “understanding” or doing something else? Second: how does its answer differ from the answer of a human interlocutor? Third: why can AI be confidently wrong—and where have you seen this happen in real life? Fourth: what does this mean for you in practice—when should you trust an answer, and when should you check it? After answering, reread the chapter and note where your picture matched it and what came as a surprise. A match doesn’t mean “I already knew all this”—often it means that your intuition is working in the right direction and is worth trusting, while still being refined.

Exercise 2.2. Listening for “similar patterns”

Talk to AI about a simple topic: the weather, a recipe, or a plan for a small celebration. Have the conversation without rushing, and analyze it along two scales: which phrases seem “understanding” (responding to your context, answering your question rather than its own), and which seem mechanical (as if it were answering something other than what you asked)? As a second exercise, try to throw your conversational partner off—say, “Wait, I meant something else”—and see how it readjusts. This isn’t a competition to “catch the robot”; it’s observation practice that will come in handy at work: you’ll learn to quickly distinguish a useful answer from plausible noise and won’t waste extra effort on the latter.

Exercise 2.3. The rules of partnership—as you understand them

From the rules for communicating with AI described in the chapter, choose two

that are hardest for you—most often, these are “clarify the task” and “check the answers.” Write each rule in your own words, as if you were explaining it to a friend who had never used AI. Then come up with a one-line reminder for each: “Clarity first, speed second” or “I check because I respect myself and my time.” Put the reminders somewhere you’ll see them when working with AI— on a sticker by your monitor, in a browser bookmark, or in a note on your phone. Short reminders work better than lengthy instructions: they take effect when you’re making a decision, not afterward.

Exercise 2.4. A dictionary for yourself

Write down five terms from the chapter (for example, “pattern,” “probability,” “hallucination,” “context,” and “neural network”) and define each in your own words in one sentence—as if you were explaining it to someone close to you or to a child. If any definition sounds difficult, reread that part of the chapter. At the end, look at your notes again in a week: which definition changed after real-world experience? That’s a sure sign that your model of AI is becoming more accurate.

Exercise 2.5. The “empty and full” experiment

To experience the difference between a good and a weak prompt firsthand, ask AI the same question twice. First, ask something very brief: “What is a neural network?”—and write down the answer without evaluating it. Then expand the same question: “Explain what a neural network is to an acquaintance who works as a designer: keep it brief, use an example from their profession, avoid programming terms, and answer in three parts—what it is, why it matters to them, and how to recognize it in their tools.” Compare the two answers and write down where the second was more useful, where it was worse, and which one you would show to someone ready to say, “I don’t understand.” Do the same exercise with a topic from your work: first ask the question without context, then describe your situation. The difference will show not “AI magic,” but your growing ability to frame a task—and that’s a skill that stays with you even when the model is replaced by a new one.

If you get into the spirit of it, write down a couple of spontaneous clarifying techniques you notice yourself using: for example, “say it as if I were her eldest daughter” or “give me two versions: the diplomatic one and the honest one.” Each such technique is a building block in your personal prompt library, which will grow as you practise.

Questions for reflection

Close your notebook and ask yourself three questions. Where in my life is AI already “at work,” while I haven’t noticed it or consciously chosen it? What have I stopped expecting from AI—and why does that set me free? How will my next conversation with it change if I remember “similar patterns”? Write your answers in three lines and save them. Return to them in a month: the change in your expectations is the surest sign that you now understand the tool rather than simply using it blindly. If one of the lines has become outdated, that isn’t a step backward but movement forward: a living model of the world is updated when new data appears.

Workshop checklist

- ☐ I honestly answered myself about how I understand the way AI works.
- ☐ I found at least one place where my intuition proved accurate.
- ☐ I talked to AI and analyzed the conversation without anger or disappointment.
- ☐ I chose two rules and created reminders for them.
- ☐ I remember: understanding refines trust, but does not replace checking.

Space for notes

Workshop 3. After the chapter “Mastery”—your path to confident prompting

Why this matters now. Mastering communication with AI is the most practical topic in the book, and it’s where you’ll feel the strongest urge to rush: read the formula, try it, make sure it works. The workshop doesn’t dampen that excitement; it directs it. Instead of twenty random prompts, you’ll make several deliberate ones, analyze them using the formula, see the difference with your own eyes, and keep what will work for you for years—a set of personal templates written in your own voice.

Exercise 3.1. Analyzing your typical prompt

Recall your last question to AI—or formulate a new one based on real life: ask about something you've wanted to know for a long time. Write down the prompt exactly as you entered it. Now analyze it using the strong-prompt formula from the chapter: does it include a goal, context, constraints, success criteria, the desired format, and a verification plan? Put "yes" or "no" next to each element. Nine times out of ten, you'll find that only one or two fields are filled in—that's normal and doesn't mean you did anything wrong. It means that even a small prompt can be made strong. In the next step, rewrite the prompt once, adding the missing information in at least three fields: for example, "what I need the answer for," "in the form of three options," and "say what needs to be checked." Compare the answers and note the difference: often, clarifying just "what I need this for" is enough to change an answer from "generally about the topic" to "specifically about my task."

Exercise 3.2. A cheat sheet of three prompts

Create three favorite prompt templates that will be useful to you over the next two weeks. For example: "Explain /topic/ as if I were a beginner: briefly, with an example from my field—/field/—and one question at the end to test myself"; "Create a step-by-step plan for /task/, with one concrete action per step and no generalities"; "Here is my text: /text/. Rewrite it in three styles—businesslike, warm, and concise—and show what changed and why." Don't copy templates from textbooks word for word: fill in your own topics and rephrase them until the wording sounds like you. Test each template on a real task and note what worked and what you would change. A good cheat sheet isn't memorized text but a set of practical tools tested in the field.

Exercise 3.3. Technique map — what you have in your arsenal

Create a one-page table. The first column is the technique: clarify the task; add a constraint; ask for an example; specify the format; ask to explain the criteria; ask for an iterative revision ("rewrite it, preserving the facts but making it shorter"). The second column is a specific instance when this technique helped you. The third is the tasks in which you use it. Don't chase quantity: three or four techniques that you know inside out already amount to mastery. Come back to the map in a month and mark what has already become automatic: that is your real progress, invisible in the moment but clear when you compare your notes.

Exercise 3.4. The "blind retelling" experiment

Try retelling a response from AI that you liked in your own words—either in writing or aloud to a friend—and note what you lost in the retelling. If you lost the essence, the knowledge is not yet truly yours; if the key points remained, it means you understood it and can use it in your work. Retelling is the most honest test of understanding, and it can be practised faster than you might think.

Exercise 3.5. Debugging on a real task

The most valuable exercise in the workshop is observing yourself at work. Choose a real task in front of you this week—a letter, an article, a plan, a selection of options—and run the whole cycle through it, aloud or in your notes: did I formulate the goal before making the request; did I add context and constraints; did I define the criteria for success; did I specify the format; did I plan the verification? As you go, record three moments: where I rushed and sent the request “as is”; when I realised I should stop and rephrase it; what I would do differently next time. Repeat the exercise on a new task a week later. The aim is not to do it “perfectly”—even the most experienced people are never perfect. The aim is to see your own growth curve: in the first week, you notice two or three areas for improvement; in the second, one or two; by the third, you simply stop and rephrase on your own. That is mastery in its true form: not knowing the formula, but applying it automatically.

If one part of the cycle consistently comes easily to you, mark it as a strength—for example, “I’m good at specifying the format.” Strengths are reinforced by building on them, not only by correcting weak spots. In the end, you will have your own checklist for entering any conversation with AI—it always begins with: “Stop—why do I need this?”

Questions for reflection

After debugging a real task, ask yourself three things. Where have I recently saved time on formulating a request only to lose it reworking the answer—and how will I act differently now? Which element of a strong request comes most easily to me, and is it becoming my main support? Who close to me could I teach one technique from this chapter to—and which one? Choose the answer that struck you most strongly and take one small action based on it today: rewrite one request, show a template to a friend or colleague, or create a document called “My formulas.” Mastery does not like postponed intentions—it likes steps taken.

Workshop checklist

- ☐ I analysed one real request using the formula and found the empty fields.
- ☐ I rewrote it, adding at least three elements.
- ☐ I created three of my own templates and tested them on real tasks.
- ☐ I created a technique map and know where to find it next time.
- ☐ I remember: confidence grows not from the number of requests, but from the quality of attention you give them.

Space for notes

Workshop 4. After the chapter “Creation”—your idea under the microscope

Why this matters now. The chapter on creation focuses on the entrepreneurial path: ideas, testing, first steps, fear, and excitement. But an entrepreneurial approach is not only for people starting a business: the ability to put an idea through testing without major investment is useful in any project—from a hobby club to a new service at work or a volunteer initiative. This workshop will take you from “I have a thought” to “I have a testing plan,” all on paper, at your own pace, without pressure.

Exercise 4.1. Your idea—and who is already solving the problem

Write down an idea that has been going around in your head lately—in one or two sentences, using simple words. Then answer four questions honestly. First: who needs this idea—and how do I know that, rather than merely assume it? Second: what three ways of solving a similar problem already exist, even inconvenient or outdated ones? Third: what am I better at than average, and does that give me the right to work on this particular thing? Fourth: what am I prepared to lose if it does not work out—that is also part of the plan. The answers do not have to be brilliant. What matters is that they are written down: an idea in your head can easily seem genius, while an idea on paper begins to

live by the laws of reality—and becomes testable.

Exercise 4.2. Ten questions for AI—and your own verification

Make a list of ten questions about your idea that AI can answer usefully—but not instead of you. For example: what pain points does the target audience have, what payment models are common in this field, what difficulties do beginners usually face, and what should not be done at the start? Once you have the answers, go through them with a highlighter: what can be verified, and what you will verify yourself—prices, laws, facts about a specific region, and real-world conditions. AI's answers here are a starting point for your research, not a final verdict. Mark three points that surprised you and three that you suspected: surprise helps you learn, while suspicion helps you stay alert.

Exercise 4.3. The week's mini-experiment

Choose one small action that can be tested within a week, without launching a product or spending a lot: tell two or three people from the target audience about the idea and listen to their questions without making excuses; write a description of the idea in two sentences and observe what they ask in response; study how others do something similar—even if only informally—and record three observations. The result of the exercise is not "did it work or not?" but "I now know one step more about my idea." Pay particular attention to what surprised you in people's reactions: surprise is the most honest source of learning, and it rarely comes from theories, but often from three real conversations.

Exercise 4.4. Risk and safety-net map

On a spare page, draw a two-column table: what could go wrong (not enough time, no one replied, it turned out to be more difficult)—and what I will do in that case (ask for advice, postpone it, change the format, stop without feeling guilty). A risk map does not put you off—it sets you free: when you have thought about failure in advance, you stop being afraid of it and start taking action. Label each risk with one sentence saying what you will learn even if it does not work out. That way, the experiment becomes a win whatever happens.

Exercise 4.5. The advice you would give yourself

The hardest part of creating is looking at your idea from the outside. First, describe your idea and its current stage—as if you were telling someone about

another person's project. Then try three outside perspectives. First: "What would I advise someone close to me who wants to do the same thing?" Second: "What would I have advised myself a year ago?" Third: "What will I say to myself a year from now, looking back at today, if I end up reproaching myself for being indecisive—or, on the contrary, for being too bold?" Write each piece of advice in one paragraph. The key step in the exercise is to read the advice addressed to someone close to you and honestly notice what can be applied to yourself. It is easier for us to be kind and sensible toward others than toward ourselves—and when translated into advice for yourself, it often turns out to be the wisest advice you received all day. The idea that makes you freeze often does not require genius—it requires exactly this: your own perspective, armed with kindness.

Finish the exercise by writing down "my next three steps"—small ones you can complete this week—and mark which one you will do first. When a step is complete, celebrate it: in the practice of creating, it is your contribution to your own path, and it weighs more than all your reflections on genius.

Questions for reflection

Consolidate the workshop with three questions. What did I notice in my reactions while thinking about the idea: am I more afraid of failure, or of showing it to others? Where did my idea come from—from my own needs or from admiration of someone else's success—and does that change anything? If, in a week, I learn that someone is already doing something similar, will that frighten me or, on the contrary, strengthen my sense that the idea is alive? You do not need to compare your answers with anyone else's. When you finish working on the idea, close your notebook for a day and return to it with fresh eyes in the evening: the right to reconsider your thoughts is part of thinking, not a weakness.

Workshop checklist

- ☐ I wrote my idea down on paper—briefly and honestly.
- ☐ I answered questions about the audience, the competition, and my own strengths.
- ☐ I made a list of questions for AI and received some initial answers.
- ☐ I identified the facts I will verify through independent sources.
- ☐ I chose a one-week mini-experiment and set a day to review the results.

Space for notes

Workshop 5. After the chapter “Creativity”—your laboratory of expression

Why this matters now. Creativity with AI is not “press a button and get a masterpiece,” but a space where you learn to articulate a vision, accept imperfection, and notice what you actually like. Chapter Five showed the possibilities and cautions; this workshop offers three genres to try—not for an exhibition, but for yourself. There are no grades and no competition here: only experiments and your own reactions. If a particular genre does not resonate with you, that is also a result: you have learned one more fact about your tastes than you knew yesterday.

Exercise 5.1. One vision—three manifestations

Choose a simple theme you like: a garden in moonlight, a city in the morning, the smell of your grandmother’s kitchen, a nature reserve, the comforting sound of rain against the window. Formulate the vision in one sentence—without technical terms, just sensations: “a warm evening, the smell of pine needles, lights twinkling in the distance.” Now create three different manifestations of the same theme: a textual description (in words), an image (generated from your description), and a short rhythmic étude—a poem or a piece of music, whichever is more accessible. Do not compare the results with one another or rate them on a scale. Compare something else: does the mood of the result match the mood in your vision? If not, where do they diverge, and how would you rephrase the description? This exercise is about how a vision becomes an instruction, and an instruction becomes a result: a skill that will be useful in any endeavor.

Exercise 5.2. Three versions of your text

Take an old piece of writing—a post, a letter, a note, a poem, even a recipe—and ask AI to suggest three versions: one for the morning, one for the evening, and one for a reader who knows nothing about the subject. Do not choose the “best” one. Instead, note which version feels closest to you in voice and why: which words catch your attention, which rhythm is more pleasing, and what you would revise. The exercise is not about “AI writes better than I do,” but about

recognizing that style consists of conscious choices, whose boundaries become easier to see through comparison. After the exercise, revise the version you chose in your own words until it is one hundred percent yours.

Exercise 5.3. Your gentle creative habit

Choose one mini-ritual for two weeks. Options include spending three minutes each morning coming up with one image for the day and writing it in your notes; creating one image a week as a postcard to yourself; or writing a short poem about an utterly unremarkable day. Keep a light record: the date, the theme, and one sentence about the feeling. After two weeks, look through the list—you will see how many small reasons for joy you have given yourself, even if none of the works turned out to be “gallery-worthy” (and they do not have to). Your creative work does not have to impress other people to be yours: it only needs to bring you pleasure and honesty.

Exercise 5.4. A conversation with your inner critic

When you create a piece of work, the inner critic often switches on before the author has even begun. Write down its typical phrases and give yourself permission to offer one response: for example, to “nobody needs this,” answer, “I’m doing it for myself”; to “everything has already been invented,” answer, “Everything has already been invented, but not by me—and that makes it different.” Then make the work without waiting for its permission. Repeat this exercise with every workshop in the chapter: the critic does not disappear, but it stops being the editor of your decisions.

Exercise 5.5. Your gallery of ability

It is easy to devalue your creativity when you compare yourself with people who have been practicing for a long time. To establish a fair point of reference, create “your own gallery”: collect five to seven of your works—études, texts, images, presentation recipes, photographs—in one folder or notebook. Place the date next to each one. After two months, make something similar again and add it alongside the earlier work; after four months, do it once more. When the gallery contains three sets, arrange them in chronological order and look only at the section “what has changed”: which formulations have become richer, where has your vision become more subtle, where has AI become your assistant, and where are you making more of the decisions yourself. This gallery is your personal museum of growth, where there can be no “bad” exhibits: each work has its place, and together they tell the story of how a person learns to express

themselves.

If you want to strengthen the effect, add one sentence to the card for each work: “Here I learned...” That way, the collection will turn from an assortment of artifacts into a skills journal—and six months from now, you will have no idea how much you have avoided until you count the cards.

Questions for reflection

Before closing your notebook, ask yourself silently: which genre—words, images, or sound—came most easily to me, and what does that say about me? When was the last time I felt joy in the process without thinking about the result—and how can I return to that state? If I made a “bad” piece of work once a day for a week, would I become braver? The last question does not require action; it simply offers an honest assessment: in creativity, what gets in the way more often is not lack of skill, but a prohibition against making mistakes. Write down one permission you are giving yourself right now: “I have the right to draw/write/experiment in the way that feels right to me.” Permission nurtures creativity no less than skill.

Practicum checklist

- ☐ I formulated the vision in simple words, without jargon.
- ☐ I created three expressions of the same theme in different formats.
- ☐ I honestly compared the mood of the vision with the mood of the result.
- ☐ I tried rephrasing my text and heard the difference between the voices.
- ☐ I chose a creative habit for two weeks and made the first entry.

Space for notes

Practicum 6. After the “Education” chapter — how you learn anything

Why this matters now. The sixth chapter showed how AI turns into a personal teacher and mentor — and how important it is to preserve your independence in the process. This practicum puts you at the centre of your own learning: you will choose a real skill you want to develop, and try it in different ways so you can feel which one suits you best. Learning with AI is not a replacement for a textbook or a teacher, but a third force: it strengthens you if you remain both a student and the architect of your own learning plan.

Exercise 6.1. Your learning goal — one, clear, achievable goal

Choose a skill you genuinely want to master: a language, a work tool, a culinary area, repairs, financial literacy, a new program, or public-speaking skills. Formulate the goal as a learning goal: not “learn English,” but “read simple articles about a topic I’m interested in without a dictionary”; not “learn to cook,” but “prepare three dishes from a new cuisine and recreate them from memory.” Write down the goal and note why it matters specifically to you, rather than because “it’s what you’re supposed to do.” From there, all the exercises are built around this goal — at every step, ask yourself whether the next action brings you closer to it. If the goal falls apart — don’t abandon it: reduce its scope to the part you can realistically keep in hand.

Exercise 6.2. Three techniques — and one of them is yours

For your goal, try three approaches in turn, one or two days each. First approach: the AI tutor. Ask it to explain a difficult topic simply, in short portions, with an example and a checking question at the end. Second approach: practice with gradually reduced prompts. When solving a task — vocabulary, grammar, a recipe, a formula — don’t ask “solve it for me,” but “give me the first step,” and finish it yourself. Third approach: the Socratic dialogue. Ask AI to pose questions to you rather than give answers, so that you arrive at the conclusion yourself. After each approach, write down three lines: what came easily, where you got stuck, and what you wanted to repeat. No technique is “the right one” — there is the one that suits you today, and it may change tomorrow.

Exercise 6.3. Stop signals for copying

Write down four rules of your own for distinguishing learning from copying. For example: “I can explain the topic to another person in my own words”; “I solved the problem after a hint, not after receiving the answer”; “I rewrote the wording in my own style instead of copying it”; “I know which part of the answer I arrived at myself.” Copying does not only deceive others — it deprives you of your own

victory and your own joy. When in doubt, ask yourself one question: “What is this action teaching me?” — if nothing, it is copying. At that moment, you can rephrase the prompt directly to reclaim authorship.

Exercise 6.4. A journal of small victories

Set up a page for your learning and once a day write down one small victory: you understood a rule, answered a question, took a step you had been putting off yesterday. After two weeks, reread the list: learning usually seems slow until you see it in writing. A journal counteracts the feeling that “nothing is working”: it shows that you are moving forward even when you don’t feel any movement.

Exercise 6.5. A lesson for a friend

The most reliable sign that you have mastered a skill is the ability to explain it. Take one point from your goal, break it down, learn it, and prepare to give a lesson to a friend or your family: ten minutes, simple words, and a final question to check understanding. AI can help you prepare the lesson: ask it, “suggest how to explain /topic/ to a beginner and come up with two questions to check understanding.” But teach the lesson yourself — using your voice, gestures, and your own examples from life. If someone close to you understands and asks a follow-up question, the learning has taken hold: the explanation was clear, and knowledge has stopped being a storage room and become a tool. And if your listener gets confused, that moment is even more valuable: it will show you which details you still haven’t pieced together yourself and give you a precise direction for the next step.

This kind of “learning for the sake of learning” reinforces the material more strongly than repetition because it forces you to restructure knowledge for another person. After giving several small lessons this way, you will notice that big topics no longer frighten you; they turn into sequences of small lessons — including ones you never planned to teach.

Questions for reflection

Conclude the practicum with three questions. Which of the techniques I tried became my “go-to solution,” and why? At what point in learning did I feel that I was truly learning — and how can I extend those moments? If I were learning with AI while progressing toward my goal, what would change in the plan — and what would get in my way? Turn one of the answers into a rule for next month: for example, “I begin every new topic by explaining it in my own words” or “I use

AI for questions, not answers.” A rule written in one line and tested in practice is stronger than any paragraph in a textbook. If the rule doesn’t work in real life after a week, don’t abandon it with a sense of guilt; rephrase it instead: a revised rule, aligned with your reality, is worth more than a perfect but impossible one.

Practicum checklist

- ☐ I chose one goal and wrote it down in simple words.
- ☐ I tried at least two of the three approaches with my goal.
- ☐ I came up with my own rules for “learning versus copying.”
- ☐ I started a journal of small victories and made the first entry.
- ☐ I remember: even the smartest assistant cannot replace my own efforts.

Space for notes

Practicum 7. After the “Wisdom” chapter — your ethical compass

Why this matters now. The final part of the book is about wisdom: honesty, fact-checking, privacy, and humanity. The practicum concludes the journey not with “new knowledge,” but with a complete tool — a personal ethical checklist that will stay with you after you close the book. Here you decide what kind of partner you want to be — to technology and to yourself. Ethics with AI is not philosophy, but concrete decisions at concrete moments: what to upload, what to ask, what to check, and what to say. The sooner they become habits, the more calmly you will use the power of the tool.

Exercise 7.1. Four principles — in your own words

The chapter describes four principles: honesty, fact-checking, confidentiality, and humanity. For each one, write what it means in your life — not “facts must be checked,” but something concrete: “I don’t send a student assignment to a chat asking it to complete the work without marking the changes”; not “data must be

protected," but "I don't enter passport details or account numbers into public chats"; not "it's important to be honest," but "I don't present generated text as entirely my own when that matters." Specificity is a sign that the principle has become yours: a vague rule is forgotten, while a concrete action works.

Exercise 7.2. Three Dilemmas—and Your Position

Find the ethical dilemmas in the chapter: authorship, the boundaries of delegation, influence on other people's opinions, and responsibility for AI's mistakes. Choose the three that affected you most strongly, and for each write what you would do and why. Don't strive for the "right answer"— there are no ready-made answers in ethics. The high point of the exercise is to see that your decisions come from your values, not from fear. If some of your positions change in a month, that is growth: your compass is being calibrated through experience.

Exercise 7.3. Your Boundary: "What I Don't Give to AI"

Make a list of what you do not upload to or tell AI under any circumstances: documents containing passport details, medical histories (your own or other people's without necessity), financial account information, other people's secrets, and materials covered by a nondisclosure agreement. Add one line of justification to each item: why is this a boundary? The list should not be long—only honest. It is also useful to write down what can be uploaded in anonymized form: "data—only with permission and into tools approved by company policy."

Exercise 7.4. A Personal Code—Put It in Writing

Bring together seven short points from the entire workbook—your personal code for working with AI. The points can sound however you like: from "I check facts that affect my money" to "I ask permission before revealing someone else's story." Start each one with a verb—with an action, not a wish. Rewrite the code on a separate page—beautifully, for yourself—and put it in your notebook or hang it somewhere visible. Check in with yourself after three months: what has become a habit, what is outdated, and what has been added? The code is alive, just like you, and it is allowed to change.

Exercise 7.5. Checking In with Yourself After a Month

Ethics is tested not when you formulate it, but when you make a decision. That is why it is better to finish the workbook not with a full stop, but with a calendar entry: make a date with yourself a month from now. Check in by answering three

questions: in what real situation did I apply the code this month and would act the same way again; where did I depart from a point I wrote down for myself, and why—was the rule inconvenient, or did I simply forget it; what new point would I add if I were writing the code today, with a month's experience behind me? Answer calmly, without beating yourself up: a mismatch between a rule and your behavior is not a reason for shame, but a reason to refine the rule. A code that is too strict is worse than a flexible one: it is impossible to live by, while an adjustment based on experience is worth more than a paper dogma.

Repeat the check-in once more a month later: by the third meeting, the code will truly be yours—containing exactly as many points as you are capable of following, each one confirmed by experience rather than by a book.

Questions for Reflection

At the end, ask yourself three questions: what choice did you make, and what are you proud of; what situation was ethically difficult, and how did you preserve your humanity in it; what would you do differently today if you found yourself in the position from which you began? Write your answers without embellishment: your compass is calibrated through an honest examination of your decisions. Read them again in six months—the lines will show you how far you have come.

Final Workbook Checklist

- ☐ I wrote down four principles in my own words and with concrete actions.
- ☐ I chose three dilemmas and formulated my position on each.
- ☐ I saw that my decisions are grounded in inner values, not fear.
- ☐ I made a list of "what I don't give to AI," with a justification for each boundary.
- ☐ I wrote a personal code of seven action points and set a date to check in.

Space for Notes

From Workbooks to Life: How to Return to the Book Again

Once you complete all seven workbooks, you will have a notebook of observations about yourself: your discoveries, your own prompt templates, your mini-experiments, your creative studies, and your personal code of ethics. This is your personal addition to the book—and it is more valuable than any printed expansion, because it is written with living stories from your own life. Rereading chapters you “already know” will now be different: you will encounter familiar ideas as a meeting with your former self—the person who was just beginning, and the person who has already learned to see things differently. If you reread your notes in six months, you will see how far you have come from the day you first began thinking about the mind of the future. This is the book’s main result: not knowledge about AI, but a changed relationship with it—and with yourself.

PART II. AI IN LIFE AND CAREER: EIGHT PRACTICAL SCENARIOS

If the first part of the supplement is a set of workbooks for thoughtful work with a pencil, the second part is a collection of quick helpers for every day. The eight scenarios cover typical tasks you may encounter as early as this week: from planning dinner and writing a résumé to preparing for a meeting and analyzing a long document. Each scenario follows the same structure: a short description of the situation; a ready-made basic prompt that you can adapt to yourself; recommendations for improving the result; and warnings about fact-checking and privacy wherever they matter. Keep the main thing in mind: the prompts here are starting points, not magic formulas. The more specifically you describe the context, the more useful the answer will be; the more important the decision, the more carefully you should check it. In none of these scenarios does AI replace your own mind—it merely helps it work faster.

Scenario 1. AI in Everyday Life: Planning the Week, Shopping, and Dinners

Situation. It is Sunday evening, and an empty week lies ahead of you: work meetings, family matters, a workout, and the desire not to think about food every day. AI can become a light-touch helper in organizing everyday life—not a table-wielding dictator, but a conversational partner who helps you sort out your thoughts and clear your head for more pleasant things. Everyday tasks are the safest and most rewarding area for first experiments: the cost of a mistake is low, while the time saved is felt immediately.

Basic prompt. “Imagine that I have a busy week. I have /a description of my constraints: time, budget, who else is around/, and the food should be simple and quick. Make me a plan for the week: three dinners that can be prepared in /number of minutes/ minutes; a shopping list organized by supermarket categories; and five ideas for using leftovers so that nothing is thrown away. At the end, suggest three ways to rearrange the plan if the week is turned upside down by unexpected commitments.”

Improvements. Add specifics: “no pork,” “with a child who does not eat soup,” “two dinners made from yesterday’s lunch,” “the minimum number of dishes.” The more precise the constraints, the less you will have to discard. An everyday planner also works excellently as a budget calculator: ask it to “write prices in the categories ‘expensive / average / cheap’ and provide an estimated grocery

budget”—then simply compare it with the store receipt. In the second week, ask it to adapt the plan to the actual leftovers in your fridge—this turns weekly planning into a personal system that remembers your habits, while you learn what it can do.

Checks and warnings. Product prices and availability depend on your city, the season, and the store chain: don’t base your entire grocery trip on the answer; check the actual shelves and promotions. Recipes may contain inaccurate proportions—baking and dough are especially sensitive: verify important ratios against a trusted source. Privacy: don’t share your full delivery address or the hours when you’re away from home—a dinner-planning assistant doesn’t need to know when the apartment is empty. And keep the final say for yourself: the planner suggests, but you decide.

How to make it part of your life. Start with one week and one area: for example, dinners only or just the shopping list. Don’t overload the assistant with everything at once—first check how closely its answers match your reality: the food in your fridge, your schedule, and your budget. Once you feel you can trust the draft, expand the scope to the whole week. In a month, you’ll have a personal ritual: an hour on Sunday when you wrap up the week and clear your head. Household automation doesn’t take away your care for your home—it gives you back time and energy for the things you love, and that is the best result any assistant can offer.

Scenario 2. Résumé and cover letter: your portrait, not a template

Situation. You’re about to write a résumé or cover letter and realise that the path from “many years of experience” to “specific achievements” is not a short one. AI is an excellent partner for working on phrasing, as long as you remain the chief editor of the text about yourself. Remember this from the start: in this task, AI’s value is not in writing for you, but in asking you the right questions and showing you options to choose between.

Basic prompt. “I’m preparing a résumé for a position /job title/ in the /industry/ field. Below is my draft with my responsibilities and experience. Ask me five leading questions whose answers will make my achievements specific: what changed during my time there, for whom, over what period, and what I’m proud of. Then turn my experience into three versions of the wording: concise, businesslike, and expanded. Don’t infer or add any facts that aren’t in my notes.”

Improvements. After the first response, ask: “Flag which of your formulations sound exaggerated”—and remove anything you couldn’t substantiate in an interview. If you need to translate the résumé, ask: “Translate it while preserving a neutral tone and professional vocabulary.” Be sure to show the finished text to someone in the industry whom you trust—a fresh perspective catches what the author doesn’t see. And tailor the résumé to a specific vacancy: general “personal qualities” are weaker than “this is the exact skill the vacancy requires, and here is how I have applied it.”

Checks and warnings. Never send AI passport numbers, tax identification numbers, financial data, or the internal policies of former employers: describe things in general terms—“worked with documents in retail” instead of an internal process code. Check the dates: AI may rewrite them beautifully, but the dates, job titles, and company names must be accurate—they will be checked. Read the final text aloud: if the phrases don’t sound like you, revise them until they do. A résumé is the first example of your care and honesty, and it stays with the employer for a long time.

How to check your text in ten minutes. Sit down with your finished résumé and mentally go through all the requirements of the vacancy: next to each point, write a specific fact from your biography that confirms it. Mark two or three places where the wording is slightly louder than the facts, and tone them down. Show the text to two people: someone who hires, and a friend or colleague who knows you outside work. A good résumé doesn’t sell you—it honestly explains why you are the right fit, and the interview does the rest. Remember: the main value of this scenario is that you have clarified your professional self—and that will stay with you even if you don’t get the position.

Scenario 3. Planning: from a chaos of tasks to a map of the week

Situation. Twenty tasks are swirling around in your head, while there is, as always, very little time. AI can rank, group, and break tasks down—if you lay out the whole list honestly. But only you can decide what truly matters: a machine doesn’t know which meeting is closer to your heart or which task can be postponed without consequences. So the right way to use a planner is as a dialogue: you provide the context, it helps with the order, and you double-check the priorities.

Basic prompt. “I have a task list: /list everything, including small things, without sorting/. Help me: 1) group the tasks into the categories ‘work’, ‘home’,

‘people’, and ‘self-care’; 2) mark which tasks can be combined—done on the way, by phone, or in one trip; 3) for each task, suggest the smallest doable version (ten minutes instead of an hour) and a condition under which it can be postponed; 4) choose four or five tasks for tomorrow, taking time for rest into account. Ask clarifying questions instead of guessing.”

Improvements. Come back to the plan the next day and ask: “Compare the plan with what actually happened: where did I overestimate the time, and where did I underestimate it?” This turns planning into your own personal science, and the following weeks are built on real data. For large projects, ask: “Break the goal into small steps, each with an answer to the question ‘How will I know the step is complete?’” That keeps the items from drifting into the fog. If the list is overloaded, ask: “Show me which tasks can be removed without serious consequences”—sometimes the courage to cross things out is more valuable than the ability to get everything done.

Checks and warnings. AI doesn’t know the real capacity of your calendar: journeys, meetings, children’s illnesses, and urgent calls—all of this remains out of view. A plan is a launchpad, not a sentence: you are free to rearrange tasks at any moment. Privacy: you don’t have to tell the chat about relatives’ illnesses —“an urgent personal matter” is enough. And don’t plan work without breaks: a sustainable plan takes your energy into account, not just your time. Planning with AI is like having a good assistant: it doesn’t decide what matters to you, but helps what matters not to get lost among the urgent things.

How to turn planning into a habit. Set aside one regular slot—fifteen minutes on Sunday evening and ten minutes every morning. On Sunday, unload all your tasks, have AI group them, and choose the main ones. In the morning, compare the plan with reality and make adjustments. Don’t skip two weeks in a row—the habit depends on frequency and ease. If the plan falls apart by Wednesday, that isn’t failure but a signal: there are too many tasks, and the signal itself is already useful. In a month, you’ll have your own statistics: which tasks turned out to be bigger in your head than in reality, and which were quiet but huge. That is worth more than any AI: no one can gather data about you better than you can.

Scenario 4. Emails and messages: the tone you choose

Situation. You need to write a polite refusal, an email to a client, a tactful request, or a warm congratulatory message—and the words scatter. AI will suggest formulations, but you choose the tone. This is the crucial difference: a

generator provides options, but responsibility for the words remains with you. A good email is one in which the recipient hears a real person, and AI helps refine that voice rather than drown it out.

Basic prompt. “I want to write an email on the topic: /essence/. Recipient: /who they are, what matters to them/. Desired outcome: /what should happen after they read it/. Write three versions: warm and informal; businesslike and neutral; gently firm. For each version, say how the recipient might interpret it and what I risk. Do not invent details I have not mentioned.”

Refinements. Read each version aloud—the email that does not sound like you will be noticed immediately; change the words until it becomes yours. For unpleasant messages, ask for a special skill: “Deliver the unpleasant news without damaging the relationship”—that is a separate competency, and AI can help you hone it in drafts. For requests, add: “Rewrite it so that the recipient feels that their time and wishes are valued.” For congratulations: “Mention a detail that matters specifically to this person, based on what I tell you.” A personal touch is stronger than any generic words.

Checks and warnings. For emails with legal consequences—agreements, withdrawal from obligations, notices—show the draft to someone who knows the subject: AI is not a lawyer and cannot anticipate the consequences. Privacy: addresses, numbers, and annual figures should not be entered into the chat; when mentioning third-party stories, anonymize them or ask for permission. Sensitive topics—breakups, conflicts, condolences—are best written without manufactured drama: AI may accidentally produce intense wording that you would not have chosen in a live conversation. Choosing words is an expression of care, and you are the one who chooses them.

How to develop a feel for tone. Keep a small three-line journal: what email you wrote, what tone you chose, and what response you received. Look back after a month—which tones work and which do not; this is your personal table of communication agility, and it is more accurate than any textbook. Try asking AI to “explain your choice of word”—you will learn vocabulary you previously overlooked. And do not treat correspondence as a minor thing: emails are about people with whom you preserve or lose warmth. AI can help you write each email faster, but only you can make it warmer, by choosing words you would say aloud to a person sitting across from you.

Scenario 5. Preparing for a meeting: arrive prepared

Situation. You have a meeting with colleagues or clients coming up, but you have managed to read only the calendar entry. AI can help you get ready in fifteen minutes: build a picture of the topic, formulate questions, and think through possible objections. But real preparation ends where your speech begins: you come to the meeting to speak and listen yourself, not to read out a chat summary.

Basic prompt. “I have a meeting about /topic/. I know /what I know about the project/, and my role is /role/. Help me prepare: ask me three questions—what the desired outcome of the meeting is for all sides, what my objective is, what decisions may be made, and what I need to know in advance? Then compile: a five-line summary of the topic; three questions I can ask; three likely concerns of the other side; and a list of what I need to find out beforehand.”

Refinements. If there are documents for the meeting, ask—with their owners’ consent: “Compare the two proposals, mark where they contradict each other and where the figures have the most gaps.” For negotiations, ask: “Suggest three position options: soft, middle-ground, and firm—and for each, say what it risks.” The summary should lead to action: ask, “Make a table showing who promises what, by when, and what should happen after the meeting.” That way, you will arrive not with a summary, but with a conversation ready to happen.

Checks and warnings. Never upload documents containing personal or financial data, information about employees, or deal secrets to a chat without checking the service’s privacy policy and encryption. Corporate regulations on AI and confidentiality are more important than a convenient prompt: clarify them with your security colleagues in advance. Check all figures and names after preparing: getting one digit wrong in a negotiation can be costly. And distinguish between preparation and having an opinion formed for you: if the meeting concerns an important issue, think through your position before asking AI—then preparation will strengthen your position rather than replace it with someone else’s.

How to prepare in fifteen minutes. First, spend two minutes on yourself: write one sentence—what do I want to get out of the meeting? Then spend five minutes uploading your notes to the chat and asking for questions and objections. Next, spend five minutes reading, choosing three points that resonate with you, and rewriting them in your own words. Use the final three minutes to say your opening aloud—the first thirty seconds of a meeting often set its tone. If you have almost no time, use only the first step: a clear objective is more valuable than extensive preparation. And after each meeting, write one line: what worked and what I wish I had said differently. That way, preparation

becomes a skill learned from your own meetings, not from other people's advice.

Scenario 6. Reading long documents: the essentials in twenty minutes

Situation. Ten pages of a contract, twenty pages of a report, a five-page grant application. In the past, this would have taken an evening; now AI can produce a summary—but understanding and responsibility remain with you. This scenario is one of the most useful at work, and at the same time one of the most demanding when it comes to checking: the shorter the summary, the more details it leaves out, and not all of them are unimportant.

Basic prompt. "Read the attached text and provide: 1) the essence in four or five sentences; 2) a list of the key sections, with the meaning of each in one sentence; 3) a list of all figures and dates, with notes indicating where they are mentioned; 4) provisions that may be contentious or require a decision from me; 5) a list of places where you did not have enough information to understand something unambiguously. Do not invent anything: if something is missing, write 'not in the text.'"

Refinements. Do not stop at a single summary: ask for different angles—"What will change in a year if I accept all the points?", "What might be a trap in the section on liability?", "Rephrase the contentious passages as if I were explaining them to a friend." Check the most important paragraph against the original straight away, not later: it is better to find a discrepancy before signing than afterward. For lengthy documents, divide the work into parts: first an overview of the whole document, then a separate analysis of the relevant sections, followed by questions about each one.

Checks and warnings. Accurate extraction of figures from a long text is not guaranteed—double-check every figure that affects a decision: prices, percentages, deadlines. Never upload documents containing personal data—passports, medical records, financial documents, court materials—to public chats without checking the service's policy; for such documents, corporate solutions with confidentiality agreements exist. And remember this simple truth: you are the one who puts together the final understanding. A summary is a treasure map, but the treasure is the text, and you need to see it with your own eyes, at least in the key places.

How to check a summary in five minutes. Choose the two sections that matter most to you and read them in full in the original, not in paraphrase: check

the figures, dates, and wording. Ask yourself: if I acted only on the summary, where could I have made a mistake? This exercise quickly trains your sense of "where AI leaves things unsaid." Use a summary as a bridge, not as a substitute for reading: it shows you where to go, but you work out the route yourself. Be especially careful with contracts, safety instructions, and financial documents—always check the final text here and, if in doubt, show it to someone who reads such documents professionally. Saving time should work for you, not against you.

Scenario 7. Languages: practice that was never available before

Situation. You are learning a foreign language, and before, your only practice was an occasional conversation in class or the fear of embarrassing yourself in front of a native speaker. Now you have a patient conversation partner who never gets tired, feels no embarrassment, and doesn't take offense: they are available at any time, anywhere, and you can ask them the same question ten times without feeling awkward. This is not a replacement for live conversation, but a powerful complement to it—and perhaps the best way to move from memorisation to speaking.

Base prompt. "Communicate with me entirely in /language/. My level: /beginner, intermediate, advanced/. Conversation topic: /topic/. Rules: use words and grammar appropriate to my level; if I make mistakes, don't interrupt me—instead, give me a list of mistakes at the end, with the correct version and a simple explanation; if I ask, repeat the thought in other words and give an example. Act like a friendly conversation partner, not a teacher with a ruler."

Improvements. Alternate free conversation with planned topics: Saturday —"interview with a candidate," Sunday—"I tell you about my day, and you retell it to me." Ask it to include words you learned yesterday in the dialogue: "Use these words in the conversation: /list/." Ask it to voice-record the stories you compose, then listen to your own recording again two weeks later and compare. Fifteen minutes a day for six months gives you practice that used to be available only while travelling.

Checks and warnings. AI speaks fluently, but it is not a native speaker: grammatical explanations may be simplified or outdated; check complex constructions against a textbook or with a live native speaker. Cultural nuances —politeness, humour, appropriateness—may be conveyed inaccurately: language lives in people, and no algorithm can replace the genuine laughter that

comes from a local joke. AI is excellent for everyday proficiency, but for philological precision it is only one tool among many. Don’t tell the chat your personal secrets: if you need life stories, anonymise them or make up the details. And remember: practising with AI teaches you to speak, while a real person teaches you to listen—use both sides.

How to get the most out of the scenario. Choose one topic for the month and build all your conversations with AI around it: start with the topic’s vocabulary, then have a dialogue on the topic, then retell your own conversation, and finally write something on the topic. This way, small daily pieces come together into something whole that you will feel after just a couple of weeks. Write down five new words a day and ask for them to be included in tomorrow’s conversation—repetition in context is more powerful than rote learning. Once you feel confident, move the dialogue into live communication: a language club, a native-speaking colleague, friendly correspondence. AI is your training simulator, but real speech begins where there is a live conversation partner, their pauses, their smile, and their unpredictability: not even the smartest prompts can replace them.

Scenario 8. Personal knowledge system: a stronger memory

Situation. Notes, articles, screenshots, quotations—everything is scattered across different apps, and after a month nothing can be found. AI can turn this chaos into a structured personal knowledge system, but you will be the one to build it. A good system is not a warehouse of other people’s thoughts but a reflection of your own: it should have room not only for what you have read, but also for what you think about it.

Base prompt. “Here are my notes and links: /material/. Group them by topic /my categories or ones you suggest/. For each group, write: the common idea in two sentences; point out contradictions and gaps; and note what may be useful in a month. Then ask me: ‘What would you like to be able to find in this system a year from now?’ —and help me build a structure of folders and tags so that I can find any topic in ten seconds. Don’t move my files: show me the framework, and I’ll implement it myself.”

Improvements. Add to each note: the source, the date, the most important sentence, and how it is useful to you. Each week, ask: “List the new notes that resonate with my questions /X/—I’ll decide whether to explore them further or forget them.” Keep an “inbox”: new ideas go there first without being sorted,

and their fate is decided only during review. The main secret of a personal knowledge system is to add your own comment to every saved quotation—then the system will become yours, rather than a library of other people’s voices.

Checks and warnings. Cloud-based knowledge bases with AI raise privacy concerns: decide in advance what may go into corporate chats and what will remain only in local notes. If you are working with confidential contract information, check your company’s policy before uploading anything. When transferring old notes, remove personal data: numbers, addresses, and passport details should be deleted permanently. And keep a folder called “left out”: AI loves order, but human memory lives in the personal, and your best ideas are often hiding precisely among the things that were left out.

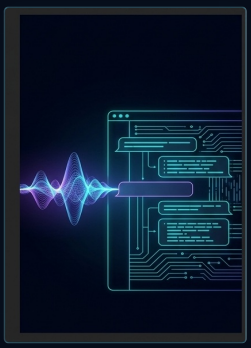
How to launch the system over a weekend. Day one: gather everything important in one place without sorting it. Day two: ask AI to suggest a structure and simplify it—keep five to seven folders, plus a “left out” folder. Read through it again in a month: the topics that keep coming up are your true interests. Spend ten minutes on the system every week.

A brief afterword to both parts

The two parts of the supplement work together: the practical exercises build habits, while the scenarios provide immediate help. Remember three rules. First: fifteen minutes of practice is worth more than an hour of reading about its benefits. Second: edit text created with AI until it sounds like your voice: authorship is about both words and responsibility. Third: you make the decisions, AI is your companion, and the road is yours. Return to these pages as you return to your desk: not to “reread” them, but to work with them, leaving your notes directly in the text. May your tools be obedient, your attention alive, and your mind always oriented towards the future.

PART 3. PERSONAL PROMPT LIBRARY

Twenty safe prompt templates: copy one, fill in the square brackets with your own details, and send it. Every template is safe: it does not ask for personal data, promise miracles, and always leaves the checking to you. An important reminder: verify any important facts from the answers against primary sources, and consult specialists about health, money, and legal matters.



How to use the library

1. Choose a template for your task.
2. Replace everything in square brackets with your own details.
3. Send it, look at the result, and refine it: “make it shorter,” “make it stricter,” “use a different tone,” “check for errors.”
4. Check anything important against reliable sources or with a specialist.
5. If you don’t like the answer, rephrase your question: more often, the issue is with the prompt, not the bot’s “personality.”

Prompt 1. Explain it as if I were five

When to use it: when you need to understand a complex topic from scratch—for yourself or for a child.

> *Explain [topic] as if I were [5/10/14] years old. No jargon, with simple comparisons from everyday life. At the end, add the questions people most often get confused about in this topic, and answer them briefly.*

What matters: asking it to specify an age and use “no jargon” dramatically reduces the complexity of the answer, while asking about common questions makes the explanation lively rather than dry.

Prompt 2. Summarise a long text

When: someone has sent you an article or document, but you’re short on time.

Prompt: Summarise [the text/article/chapter] in five sentences: the main idea, key arguments, what data the author relies on, and what the author did not say. Mark any information that needs to be checked.

Why: the forced format of “the essentials—gaps— doubt” makes the summary analytical rather than lazy regurgitation.

Prompt 3. Changing the tone of a letter

When: the draft has come out angry or dry, and the recipient is someone close to you or a colleague.

Prompt: Rewrite my text in a different tone: [friendly / confident / neutral and businesslike]. Preserve the meaning and facts, and remove [rudeness / traces of panic / bureaucratic language]. Give me three versions: gentle, neutral, and direct.

Why it works: three versions give you a choice right away, while “preserve the meaning” protects the essence from being lost.

Prompt 4. Checking a draft for errors

When: the text is ready, but a fresh pair of eyes would help.

Prompt: Check my text for spelling, punctuation, repetition, style, and paragraph logic. Don’t rewrite the entire text: list the problems point by point and suggest precise edits.

Why: asking it not to rewrite the text keeps it yours, while the list of problems leaves the decisions in your hands.

Prompt 5. A plan for the week

When: there are too many tasks and too little time.

Prompt: Help me plan my week. My tasks: [list]. Time available: [hours per day]. Break it down by day, highlight priorities, and set aside time for rest and a buffer for the unexpected. Ask me what I have forgotten to include.

Why: including rest and a buffer makes the plan human rather than overloaded.

Prompt 6. A menu from what you have

When: the fridge is full, but there’s nothing for dinner.

Prompt: I have [ingredients]. Suggest three dishes I can make from them, and indicate the time and difficulty. For option one, give a step-by-step recipe with precise instructions. Mark where caution is important: raw meat, eggs, and allergens.

Note: use common sense when checking recipes; this is an area where a mistake is not critical and where you can experiment calmly.

Prompt 7. Interview rehearsal

When: you have an interview coming up and want to practise calmly.

Prompt: Play the role of a hiring manager for a [role/field] position. Ask me five questions: about my experience, a failure, motivation, money, and one unexpected question. After each answer I give, provide feedback: what sounded strong and what I could have said more confidently.

Why: role-play is a safe practice environment with no consequences for your real career.

Prompt 8. A simple budget

When: money is disappearing faster than you would like.

Prompt: Create a simple monthly budget: income [X], fixed expenses [list], variable expenses [list], savings goal [goal]. Suggest three scenarios: conservative, ordinary, and one that allows for a reasonable amount of enjoyment. No moralising, just figures and options.

Important: this is not financial advice; you make the decisions, and you should check the figures against your own data.

Prompt 9. A travel checklist

When: getting ready for a trip turns into chaos.

Prompt: We are going [where, when, with whom]. Create a checklist covering documents, luggage, health, electronics, tasks before departure, and travel finances. Divide it into “one week before / one day before / before leaving”. Ask me what I might have forgotten.

Why: dividing things by timeframe reduces panic, while “ask me what I forgot” prompts it to clarify your specific situation.

Prompt 10. A letter admitting a mistake

When: something has gone wrong at work (or at home), and you need to admit it honestly.

Prompt: Help me write a letter: I made a mistake [what], the consequences are [what], and my correction plan is [what]. Tone: responsible, without excuses or panic. Give me five versions with varying degrees of strictness.

Why: “without excuses” is the key request: it preserves your dignity and respect for the work.

Prompt 11. Ideas for posts

When: you need to fill your feed, but the ideas aren’t coming.

Prompt: Give me 12 ideas for posts about [topic]. For each: the occasion, the main idea, the opening line, and how it benefits readers. No clickbait and no fake “how to transform your life” claims—just real, practical value from experience.

Why: the “occasion—idea—benefit” format turns an empty list into a workable content plan.

Prompt 12. Talking to a child about online safety

When: your child is growing up, and it’s time to talk about the internet.

Prompt: Help me talk to a [age]-year-old child about online safety: what personal data is, why they must not send photos or addresses, what to do about strange offers, and whom to ask for help. Give me five short phrases and three realistic situations for a conversation without lecturing.

Why: “realistic situations” turn the conversation into a game, while the phrases become a tool for you.

Prompt 13. Instructions for an older relative

When: you need to explain something simply, without causing offence or creating confusion.

Prompt: Explain in ten steps how to [make a video call / send a photo / turn on the news on a tablet]. For each step: what to press, where it is, and what will appear on the screen. No technical terms; use short sentences.

Why: the “one step—one idea” format protects attention and memory.

Prompt 14. Meeting agenda

Prompt: Help me prepare an agenda for a [30/60-minute] meeting on [topic]. Include: the goal, 3–4 key sections, who will speak, how much time each person has, and what decisions need to be made. Prepare five questions for an in-depth discussion.

Why: a good agenda is half of a good meeting; focus on decisions instead of debates.

Prompt 15. Three mini-lessons for studying

When: you are studying a subject and keep stumbling over one topic.

Prompt: I am studying [subject] and I am struggling with [area]. Create three 20-minute lessons: each should include a review, an explanation, and exercises with answers. At the end, give me five self-check questions and tell me which lessons I should revisit.

Why: a ready-made short mini-plan that you can actually follow, rather than putting it off until “someday.”

Prompt 16. Evening reflection

When: the day is over and your mind is buzzing.

Prompt: Help me talk things through. Here is a brief summary of my day: [fill in briefly]. Ask me three questions: what took the most time, what kept bothering me, and what I will do differently tomorrow. No flattery, no advice from on high—be calm and attentive.

What I’ve noticed: evening reflection is a powerful way to observe yourself; here, the bot is simply a listener and a mirror.

Prompt 17. A Six-Week Learning Plan

Prompt: Create a six-week learning plan for [topic], based on [minutes] per day: what we do each week, what the result should be, and how we check it. Allow the goals to be adjusted to fit real life, and include one lighter week.

Why: a plan with room to spare and built-in self-checks is a bridge between “someday” and “Monday.”

Prompt 18. An Anonymous Situation Analysis

When: you need to think through a difficult situation, but there is no one you can talk to about it openly.

Prompt: Analyse a conversation involving me without names or details that could identify me: [situation]. Ask three clarifying questions, then separate what I can control from what I cannot, and suggest five concrete steps. Do not make a psychological diagnosis; if you think I would be better off seeing a specialist, say so directly.

Why: a safe “office” for reflection—with the honest caveat that this is not therapy.

Prompt 19. What to Automate and What Not to

Prompt: Look at my tasks: [list from the week]. Identify five tasks that can be automated or delegated to AI right now, and five that must never be. For each of the first five, suggest which tool to use and how to get started.

Why: the boundary between “automate” and “never” is an essential foundation for using AI wisely.

Prompt 20. Recommendations Based on Your Taste

When: you want a film, a book, and a podcast.

Prompt: Recommend five [films/books/podcasts] on the topic of [topic]. For each one, include: the title, one sentence explaining “why this one,” the mood it suits, and what to expect from it. Not “everyone loves it,” but a specific reason it might appeal to me in particular.

A note on new releases: the bot’s recommendations do not replace your own taste—it can only show you where to start digging.

A Build-Your-Own Template for Your Prompts

Now you know how good prompts are structured. Build your own using the book's formula: **goal → context → constraints → format → verification**.

> *"I need [what I want to get]. Context: [what already exists, who it is for]. Constraints: [without this, no more than this]. Format: [list/table/short paragraphs]. Before answering, ask clarifying questions if you do not have enough information.*

Copy, fill in the blanks, and experiment—and in a week you will notice that your questions have become more precise and the answers more useful. That is the skill of the future: not "machine magic," but clarity of thought.

Safe travels, reader: questions—without panic, the vocabulary—is yours, and the prompts are ready. The most important part remains: your practice and your calm, honest attitude towards progress.

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How Facts Were Checked in the Editorial Version

The original manuscript contained references to MIT Media Lab, Stanford, DeepMind, McKinsey, the Journal of Creative Behavior, the University of the Arts London, and Harvard Medical School, along with specific figures. Where the

primary source could not be confirmed through publicly available sources, the figures and links to those organisations were removed. The relevant passages were reworked into composite examples or cautious explanations.

For future updates to the book, every new fact should be checked against a DOI, an official report, or a primary source: verify the authors, sample, date, and methodology; do not use a figure if it cannot be reproduced; do not attribute connections with real institutions to fictional characters; and update service prices, plans, and licences as of the publication date.

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Technology is changing quickly, but the conversation about it remains human. I would be glad to hear from you.

THANK YOU FOR READING

You have reached the final page. If you found the book useful, keep it as a working reference and return to the sections you need right now.

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